

SHOPPAGE

National Commerce Media Infrastructure

Zimbabwe National Commerce Intelligence, Media and Market Infrastructure

Shoppage Central | Shoppage Showcase | Shoppage Ads | Shoppage Creators | Shoppage Markets

Platform Framework and Ecosystem Edition v0.7 - July 2026

Central decision

Shoppage will not launch as another generic marketplace. It will launch as Zimbabwe-owned commerce media infrastructure: a mobile merchant operating system, geolocal product and short-video discovery network, local advertising exchange, creator-affiliate economy and market-in-market platform. The first three months deliver a commercially operable version across all five layers; months four to six expand geography, categories, partnerships and transaction depth.

Document purpose and decision status

This document replaces the earlier Shopscene / ShopPage naming structure and extends the Shoppage implementation blueprint. The whole project is Shoppage. Shoppage Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators and Markets are connected operating layers under one identity system, commerce graph, trust framework, data model and commercial strategy. This edition adds the non-negotiable defensibility, intelligence, international-quality, AI, daily-utility and investor requirements needed to build a national platform rather than a copyable marketplace. This edition also establishes measurable Google and Meta substitution objectives, a local advertising-value retention framework and eighty additional strategic aims tied to implementation and governance. It also integrates the validated Shoppage Commerce Intelligence Foundation v0.4 and the implementation progress report dated 10 July 2026, distinguishing technical proof, discovery candidates, verified claims and production commercial truth. Version 0.7 further establishes Shoppage as a reusable commerce operating framework for first-party products, subsidiaries, certified plugins, powered partners and white-label deployments while keeping identity, evidence, trust and intelligence unified.

Item	Decision	Operating implication
Master brand	Shoppage	All trust, demand and advertising equity compounds into one Zimbabwean brand.
Launch horizon	0-3 months	A tightly scoped but fully functional version 1 across all five layers.
Expansion horizon	4-6 months	New cities, categories, transaction tools, institutional and brand partnerships.
Primary market	Zimbabwe	Harare first, then Bulawayo and selected commercial corridors.
Secondary market	South Africa later	No dilution of Zimbabwe execution before local proof.
Business category	Commerce media infrastructure	Not merely e-commerce, classifieds, social media or advertising software.

Research integrity

The strategy synthesises the existing Shoppage baseline, prior deep-research direction, public Zimbabwe market evidence and global platform patterns. It does not fabricate a completed line-by-line audit of 1,000 companies. A traceable 1,000-entity Zimbabwe commerce register is therefore included as a mandatory field-validation workstream within the 0-3 month programme.

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Page references correspond to this implementation edition.

Part IV adds Sections 64-80: validated implementation status, evidence architecture, organisation/product/place programmes, offer acquisition, rights, AI review, production services, revised roadmap, revenue additions, investor controls and integration decisions. Part V adds Sections 81-86: locked transaction ownership, payment-provider boundary, partner-led fulfilment, Shoppage Merchant Sites, Pemosites and implementation changes. Part VI adds Sections 87-98: the Shoppage Framework, shared services, APIs, plugins, powered partners, subsidiary governance, platform economics and the 0-6 month ecosystem roadmap.

Part III adds Sections 56-63: commercial-discovery substitution, local advertising substitution, international benchmarks, eighty additional aims, scorecards and 0-6 month execution rules.

1. Executive decision

Shoppage should be built as the local operating and distribution system for Zimbabwean commerce. The platform must organise the commercial activity that is currently fragmented across Facebook pages and groups, Facebook Marketplace, WhatsApp catalogues and statuses, Google Search and Maps, short-form video, classifieds, physical markets, shopping centres, informal sellers, creators and diaspora buying networks.

The strongest strategic position is not to ask Zimbabweans to abandon Facebook or WhatsApp immediately. Shoppage should first make those channels work better by giving every merchant a structured catalogue, trackable links, shoppable videos, verified identity, fresh stock signals and measurable leads. It then progressively converts external reach into Shoppage-owned demand, data and advertising inventory.

The business succeeds when a buyer thinks "search Shoppage" before asking a Facebook group, scrolling old posts or calling multiple shops. It succeeds commercially when a merchant allocates part of the budget previously spent on Facebook boosts, Google ads, page administrators or informal influencers to Shoppage because the platform produces clearer local buyer intent and attributable outcomes.

The explicit strategic objective is to substitute a material share of commercial product discovery and performance advertising that currently flows through Google and Meta-controlled surfaces. This is a voluntary, performance-led strategy: Shoppage must win through fresher local inventory, better location intelligence, stronger trust, simpler campaign creation and more measurable Zimbabwean outcomes. Progress must be tracked through commercial-discovery share, merchant advertising-wallet share and local value-retention metrics.

Implementation status. The validated foundation contains 6,101 organisation-source records, one million unique global food product identities, a 25,210-node Zimbabwe place and market scaffold, and a tested merchant-offer ingestion contract. These are foundation milestones, not claims of complete Zimbabwe commercial coverage. The immediate priority is rights-cleared local offer acquisition and verified organisation, branch and market relationships in the launch wedge.

North-star proposition

For buyers: find what is available, where it is, who can be trusted and how to buy it. For merchants: publish once, sell everywhere and measure every lead. For Zimbabwe: retain more commerce data, advertising value, creator income and digital capability inside the country.

1.1 What "fully functional in three months" means

A fully functional version 1 means every layer can complete its primary commercial job end to end. It does not mean every long-term feature is present. The scope boundary is essential because AI-assisted development accelerates implementation, but it does not remove the need for product decisions, data quality, security, merchant onboarding, moderation, field operations and adoption.

Layer	Version 1 completion test	Deferred depth
Central	A merchant can register, verify, create a storefront, manage products, prices, stock, branches, leads and analytics.	Advanced ERP, accounting and warehouse management.
Showcase	A buyer can search, browse nearby products, watch shoppable clips, compare, save, request a quote and contact a vendor.	Full entertainment social network and complex personalisation.
Ads	A merchant can fund a campaign, choose a simple objective and audience, receive placement and see results.	Real-time programmatic exchange and external web ad network.
Creators	A creator can join, tag approved products, publish tracked content and earn from verified outcomes.	Large-scale automated payouts and live-stream commerce.
Markets	A market administrator can create a market, onboard stalls, publish a shared feed and measure demand.	Deep market ERP, rent collection and municipal systems.

2. Zimbabwe ground reality and design consequences

The model must work with actual Zimbabwean constraints rather than imported assumptions. Public evidence published in 2025-2026 describes e-commerce as largely informal, urban-centred and diaspora-driven, with Facebook Marketplace and WhatsApp central to discovery and negotiation. Cash, cash on delivery, mobile payments and direct arrangements remain more common than conventional card-first e-commerce. Internet reach is material but not universal, and data cost, trust, fragmented logistics and uneven digital capability remain binding constraints.

Observed reality	Business implication	Product response
Social media is the dominant commerce entry point.	Shoppage cannot depend on app-store installation or behaviour change at launch.	PWA, shareable links, WhatsApp handoff and social export are core.
Many sellers are informal or have no website.	Self-service software alone will underperform.	Assisted onboarding, field agents, market captains and creator support.
Product posts become stale quickly.	A large catalogue can still be commercially useless.	Price-valid-until, last-confirmed stock and automated freshness decay.
Trust is social and location-based.	A generic verified badge is insufficient.	Progressive KYC, location proof, response history and complaint records.
Payments are multi-rail and currency-sensitive.	Forced prepaid checkout will reduce conversion.	Cash, collection, mobile money, bank, card and deposit options.
Delivery is fragmented.	Owning a fleet would consume capital and management capacity.	Pickup first, partner quotes and proof-of-fulfilment workflows.

Observed reality	Business implication	Product response
Data and connectivity vary.	Heavy video and complex interfaces will exclude users.	Low-data mode, compressed media, cached pages and simple navigation.
Diaspora demand is important.	Remote buyers need trust and fulfilment evidence, not only products.	Diaspora collections, verified vendors, deposits and delivery proof.

Digital 2026 estimates indicate approximately 6.54 million individual internet users and 2.60 million social media user identities in Zimbabwe at the end of 2025, alongside 16.2 million active cellular connections. These numbers justify a mobile-first opportunity, but they also warn against designing for permanent high-speed connectivity or assuming every mobile connection represents an active internet shopper.

The correct product stance is therefore hybrid: smartphone-first but low-data; digital-first but assisted; national in ambition but city-by-city in execution; payments-enabled but not checkout-dependent; content-rich but linked to structured products; and commercially independent while partnership-ready for government, financial institutions, mobile operators, brands and local authorities.

3. National value proposition and endorsement readiness

Presidential-level or national endorsement cannot be guaranteed and should never be treated as a substitute for product-market fit. Shoppage can, however, be designed to be endorsement-ready by producing measurable public value, maintaining political neutrality, complying with law and presenting a credible national-development case.

National objective	Shoppage contribution	Proof metric
MSME digitisation	Low-cost storefronts, catalogues, leads and analytics for formal and informal sellers.	Active verified businesses and digital catalogues created.
Local value retention	Zimbabwe-owned advertising and creator revenue instead of full leakage to global platforms.	Local ad spend processed and creator/vendor income generated.
Youth employment	Creator commerce, field onboarding, content production, support and software roles.	Paid creators, agents and full-time jobs.
Devolution and local markets	Digital market pages and geo-demand intelligence for cities and districts.	Markets digitised and demand by locality.
Consumer protection	Seller verification, transparent prices, complaint workflows and auditable promotions.	Complaint rate, resolution time and repeat buyer trust.
Diaspora participation	Verified local purchasing and fulfilment evidence for remote buyers.	Diaspora leads, orders and proof-of-delivery completion.
Export and local industry	Supplier discovery, manufacturer profiles and B2B quote workflows.	Qualified B2B enquiries and export-ready suppliers.
Data sovereignty	A locally governed commerce graph and privacy-conscious national market intelligence.	Local entity ownership, compliance and controlled data access.

Endorsement principle

Shoppage should be presented as enabling infrastructure for citizens and businesses, not as a political communications platform. No political party should receive privileged commercial ranking, private user data or moderation control. National credibility requires neutral governance, transparent policies and documented consumer safeguards.

3.1 Presidential and institutional briefing package

- A two-page national impact brief with quantified jobs, MSME digitisation, local ad retention and provincial coverage.
- A live demonstration showing a market trader creating a catalogue, a buyer finding a nearby product and a creator earning from a tracked lead.
- A 100-day scorecard with independently verifiable figures rather than vanity registrations.
- A data-governance note explaining privacy, lawful access, localisation roadmap and non-partisan controls.
- A partnership menu for ministries, local authorities, ZimTrade, financial institutions, telecom operators, market associations and universities.
- A clear statement that endorsement does not confer ownership, exclusive access or procurement preference.

4. Brand and product architecture

Shoppage is the master brand. The five layers should appear as connected destinations and capabilities, not separate companies. Users may enter through any layer, but identity, catalogue, trust, analytics, billing and data remain unified.

Layer	Strategic role	Primary promise
Shoppage Central	Merchant operating system and shared platform core.	Run the business and publish a trusted digital catalogue.
Shoppage Showcase	Buyer-facing search, geo-discovery and commerce-content feed.	See it, locate it, compare it and contact the seller.
Shoppage Ads	Zimbabwean commercial advertising and campaign system.	Buy measurable local purchase intent.
Shoppage Creators	Creator, affiliate and content-production economy.	Turn influence and content skill into attributable income.
Shoppage Markets	Market-in-market layer for malls, districts, associations and clusters.	Digitise a whole commercial destination, not only one shop.

Recommended domain pattern: shoppage.co.zw as the public destination; manage.shoppage.co.zw for merchant operations; ads.shoppage.co.zw for campaign management; creators.shoppage.co.zw for creator tools; and market pages under shoppage.co.zw/markets/{slug}. During the first three months these may be routes in one application rather than separate deployments. This reduces cost and prevents duplicated authentication, analytics and user experience.

The name should undergo trademark, company-name and domain due diligence before major public investment. Brand guidelines should establish one logo system, one typography and colour system, one trust badge hierarchy and one naming rule. "Shoppage" should always refer to the ecosystem; module names are descriptors, not independent brands.

5. Shoppage Central - merchant operating system

Shoppage Central is the foundation. It must create standalone value before Shoppage has national consumer traffic. A merchant should gain an organised digital presence, a catalogue, social-ready content, lead tracking and basic business insight even when most customers still arrive from Facebook or WhatsApp.

5.1 Core merchant jobs

- Create and verify a business, seller or market-stall identity.
- Create one or more stores, branches, pickup points and delivery zones.
- Add products through manual entry, spreadsheet, assisted upload, image extraction or approved import.
- Manage price, currency, price validity, promotions, stock state and last-confirmed availability.

- Upload product images and short videos, then reuse them across Showcase and external social channels.
- Receive leads from WhatsApp, calls, quote requests, reservations and creator content.
- Assign staff roles and track who changed prices, stock or campaign settings.
- View actionable analytics rather than only impressions and likes.
- Buy advertising, invite creators and join relevant Shoppage Markets.

5.2 Merchant experience design

The merchant interface must be mobile-first. Refine or another dense admin framework can remain useful for Shoppage operations and larger merchants, but the typical vendor experience should be a simplified Next.js mobile workspace. The most common actions - confirm stock, change price, upload a clip, answer a lead and boost a product - should require no more than a few taps.

Workspace	Minimum functions	Operational control
Today	Pending leads, stale listings, campaign status and recommended actions.	Prioritise tasks that affect conversion.
Catalogue	Products, variants, media, price, stock and bulk update.	Completeness and freshness score.
Content	Short clips, posts, offers, templates and export.	Rights, moderation and product linkage.
Leads	Contact history, status, notes, reminders and source.	Response SLA and spam handling.
Promote	Ad objective, budget, area, category and creative.	Approval, spend limits and transparent labelling.
Creators	Invite, approve products, commission and performance.	Attribution and disclosure.
Store	Branches, hours, payments, delivery, policies and staff.	Verification and audit log.
Insights	Search demand, content performance, lead conversion and location.	Privacy-safe aggregation and benchmarks.

5.3 Freshness as a product system

Listing freshness is a core commercial control, not a cosmetic timestamp. Each sellable item needs a freshness state computed from merchant confirmation, price changes, enquiries, stock updates and customer reports.

Freshness state	Rule	User treatment
Confirmed	Merchant confirmed within category-specific window.	Normal ranking and visible confirmation date.
Needs confirmation	Approaching expiry or unusual price movement.	Merchant reminder and slight ranking reduction.
Stale	No confirmation after defined threshold.	Clear warning, lower ranking and limited promotion.
Suspended	Repeated inaccurate availability or unresolved complaints.	Hidden from search pending review.

Category windows should differ. Fast-moving electronics and groceries need shorter confirmation intervals than custom furniture or building services. Merchants must be able to bulk-confirm unchanged items, while high-risk mass confirmation should trigger spot checks.

6. Shoppage Showcase - geolocal discovery and commerce video

Showcase is the buyer front door. It combines high-intent search with a low-data short-video commerce feed. It should not imitate TikTok as a general entertainment network. Its advantage is that every useful piece of content resolves into a product, vendor, market, offer, service or buyer action.

6.1 Core buyer surfaces

Surface	Purpose	Version 1 requirement
Search	Resolve explicit product or supplier intent.	Typo tolerance, category, price, location, availability and trust filters.
Nearby	Show commercially relevant items around the buyer.	Permission-based location and manual area selection.
Video feed	Create discovery and demonstration.	Vertical clips linked to products and vendors.
Product page	Answer price, availability, specifications and fulfilment questions.	Freshness, seller trust, branches and clear contact actions.
Storefront	Present the seller as a durable business entity.	Catalogue, policies, hours, location and response signals.
Market page	Aggregate a physical or thematic market.	Vendor directory, feed, map, offers and shared search.
Buyer request	Capture unmet demand.	Structured RFQ and routing to matched vendors.
Saved	Support considered purchases.	Products, searches, markets and price/stock alerts.

6.2 Geolocal commerce engine

Geo should influence every major ranking and advertising decision. The system must recognise country, province, city, suburb, commercial cluster, branch, pickup point, delivery radius and market boundary. Location must never be inferred more precisely than necessary without user permission.

- Products near me, available today and open now.
- Deals within a selected distance or delivery zone.
- Branch-level availability and collection options.
- Popular products in a suburb, city or market cluster.
- Buyer requests routed by category, radius, trust and response capacity.
- Ads constrained by service area so merchants do not pay for unreachable demand.
- Geo-demand reports that help vendors choose stock, branches and campaigns.

Manual location selection is mandatory because GPS may be disabled, inaccurate or costly. Users should be able to choose a city, suburb, landmark or market. Rural and peri-urban discovery should use towns, growth points, routes and delivery corridors rather than assuming street-level addressing.

6.3 Short-form commerce video

No orphan content

Every Showcase clip must link to at least one structured object: product, service, store, market, collection, offer, campaign or buyer request. Content without a commercial destination dilutes the model and increases moderation cost.

Video type	Commercial use	Required controls
Product demo	Show operation, size, quality or installation.	Product tag, current price and stock state.
New arrival	Create urgency around fresh inventory.	Expiry and branch association.
Deal alert	Promote a time-bound offer.	Offer dates and sponsored label where applicable.
Store tour	Build location trust and discovery.	Verified branch and opening hours.
Market walk-through	Expose multiple merchants in a cluster.	Market admin approval and tagged vendors.

Video type	Commercial use	Required controls
Creator review	Explain, compare or recommend.	Affiliate disclosure and evidence policy.
How-to / guide	Educate buyers and create category demand.	Safety and claims moderation.
Proof of work	Show installation or completed service.	Customer consent and authenticity checks.

For version 1, clips should normally be 10-60 seconds, compressed and auto-captioned. Autoplay should be muted, preloading conservative and a low-data mode available. A managed video service should handle direct creator uploads, encoding, adaptive delivery, thumbnails and basic analytics. Cloudflare Stream is a practical initial choice; Mux is a credible alternative if its analytics or workflow fit is superior.

7. Shoppage Ads - Zimbabwean commercial attention and measurable demand

Shoppage Ads is the primary strategic mechanism for retaining more advertising value inside Zimbabwe. It must not copy the full complexity of Meta Ads Manager. The initial product should be simpler, locally understandable and focused on commercial outcomes that merchants can verify. Its formal target is to become the default performance-marketing channel for local product availability, nearby services, market traffic, creator commerce and buyer requests in the categories and cities Shoppage covers. Google and Meta can remain acquisition and syndication channels, but Shoppage must progressively own the product graph, buyer intent, campaign measurement, merchant relationship and repeat audience.

7.1 Advertising doctrine

- Sell purchase intent, qualified reach and measurable action - not vanity engagement.
- Only promote products or services with adequate identity, content and freshness quality.
- Label every paid placement clearly while preserving useful organic results.
- Give small merchants simple objectives and guardrails; give agencies and brands deeper controls later.
- Keep billing transparent across USD and ZWG display, with dated exchange assumptions.
- Prevent political advertising from entering the commerce system during the initial operating period.
- Protect buyers from misleading discounts, counterfeit claims and unsafe products.

7.2 Version 1 ad products

Ad product	Best use	Charging basis
Sponsored search	Capture explicit keyword and category demand.	Cost per click or fixed budget.
Promoted product	Increase exposure in relevant feeds and shelves.	Optimised impressions / clicks.
Promoted video	Drive discovery with tagged commerce content.	Video views plus action objective.
Featured store	Build merchant visibility in area or category.	Fixed period or budget.
Market sponsorship	Own a market page, event or campaign window.	Fixed sponsorship.
Lead campaign	Generate quote requests, calls or WhatsApp enquiries.	Budget with cost-per-lead reporting.
Creator campaign	Pay selected creators to produce and distribute tagged content.	Content fee plus performance pool.
Diaspora campaign	Target remote buyers with verified fulfilment.	Managed campaign fee and media spend.

7.3 Campaign workflow

1. Choose an objective: visibility, catalogue visits, WhatsApp leads, calls, quote requests, store visits or sales later.
2. Select product, store, market or video creative.
3. Select category, city/area, budget, dates and optional buyer signals.
4. Run automated checks for prohibited content, stale inventory, missing price, weak media and misleading claims.
5. Approve automatically for low-risk trusted advertisers or route to human review.
6. Deliver placements with frequency limits and organic-result safeguards.
7. Report spend, reach, clicks, leads, response and verified outcomes.
8. Provide AI-generated recommendations without silently changing budget or targeting.

Merchants with limited digital skill should be able to buy a fixed package such as "Promote this product in Harare for US\$20 over seven days". Larger merchants need account billing, campaign groups, branches, product feeds and downloadable reports. Managed campaigns should be a first-class service because they create early revenue while the self-service market matures.

7.4 Local advertising retention model

Shoppage cannot claim that every advertising dollar remains in Zimbabwe because hosting, payment processing, software and international infrastructure may create foreign costs. The credible claim is that platform revenue, merchant relationships, campaign capability, creator payouts, employment and commerce data are governed through a Zimbabwean business rather than being fully captured by global platforms.

Retention lever	Mechanism	Metric
Media revenue	Local merchants buy Shoppage inventory.	Gross ad spend and net local revenue.
Creator income	Creators are paid from campaigns and outcomes.	Creator payouts and active earners.
Agency capability	Local campaign managers and production partners.	Local service spend and jobs.
Data value	Demand and performance intelligence stays in Shoppage.	Local data assets and approved insight products.
Tax and formalisation	Revenue recorded through a compliant local entity.	Local tax and registered supplier activity.

8. Shoppage Creators - affiliate commerce and content production

Creators are not an optional marketing add-on. They are a distributed sales, education and merchant-digitisation network. Zimbabwean Facebook group administrators, WhatsApp community operators, videographers, product reviewers, campus promoters, technicians and local deal pages can all become commerce creators.

8.1 Creator roles

Role	Value created	Earning method
Affiliate creator	Tags and recommends approved products.	Verified lead or sale commission.
Content producer	Creates photos, clips, store tours and catalogues.	Fixed production fee.
Market creator	Covers a market, cluster or event.	Market campaign fee plus affiliate income.
Category expert	Produces technical guides and comparisons.	Campaign, sponsorship and lead share.

Role	Value created	Earning method
Onboarding agent	Digitises merchants and maintains listings.	Activation and retention payment.
Community distributor	Shares collections into trusted groups.	Tracked lead or campaign fee.

8.2 Creator safeguards

- Every paid or commission-bearing post must carry a standard sponsored or affiliate disclosure.
- Creators cannot publish fabricated reviews, false scarcity, undisclosed ownership or unsupported performance claims.
- High-risk categories require subject-matter review or may be excluded.
- Attribution must resist self-referrals, fake clicks, duplicate leads and collusion with vendors.
- Payouts should depend on a documented event definition and a dispute window.
- Creators need content rights, music rights, customer-consent and privacy training.
- Vendors must approve products and commission terms before creator promotion.

8.3 Attribution model

Version 1 attribution should be simple and auditable. Each creator receives a tagged product or collection link and optional campaign code. The platform records view, product open, save, WhatsApp click, call, quote request and vendor-confirmed outcome. Commission should initially favour verified leads and fixed content fees because most purchases will close outside Shoppage.

Event	Recommended treatment	Fraud control
Qualified WhatsApp lead	Pay only after minimum engagement or vendor validation.	Phone hashing, duplicate window and vendor dispute.
Quote request	Higher-value commission if request is complete and matched.	Identity check and category rules.
Store visit intent	Use as performance signal, not immediate payout.	Optional code or check-in later.
Completed sale	Enable where vendor or payment flow can verify.	Order reference and cancellation window.
Content production	Fixed fee after acceptance.	Brief, deliverables and rights record.

9. Shoppage Markets - market-in-market infrastructure

Zimbabwean commerce is clustered in malls, CBD blocks, industrial areas, flea markets, growth points, supplier streets, agricultural centres and informal trading spaces. Shoppage Markets digitises the cluster itself, creating a unit of discovery and advertising above the individual shop.

9.1 Market types

- Physical malls and shopping centres.
- CBD blocks, streets and arcades.
- Flea markets, market stalls and informal trader associations.
- Industrial and supplier clusters such as hardware, automotive or manufacturing zones.
- Thematic online markets such as Home and Power, Back to School or Made in Zimbabwe.
- Temporary event markets, expos, agricultural shows and seasonal campaigns.
- Diaspora-curated markets for home building, gifting, school and family support.

9.2 Market operating model

Actor	Responsibility	Commercial arrangement
Market owner / association	Authorises the destination, rules and shared identity.	Subscription, sponsorship or revenue share.
Market captain	Onboards stalls, confirms locations and maintains quality.	Activation fee and retention incentive.
Vendor / stall	Maintains catalogue, prices, stock and leads.	Free or paid Shoppage plan.
Creator	Produces market walk-throughs and collections.	Campaign or affiliate income.
Shoppage operations	Moderation, analytics, ads and support.	Platform fees and managed services.

9.3 Market page requirements

- Market identity, location, boundaries, hours, access and contact.
- Vendor directory with categories, verification and branch or stall position.
- Combined product and short-video feed.
- Market-wide search and buyer request routing.
- Events, campaigns, seasonal promotions and sponsorship placements.
- QR signage that opens a specific market, vendor, aisle or collection.
- Market analytics: demand, vendor activity, searches, leads and campaign results.
- Admin controls for membership, content rules and complaints.

Markets create a practical field distribution model. Instead of acquiring vendors one by one across a city, Shoppage can sign a market owner or association, train one captain and activate a dense supply cluster. Dense clusters improve buyer utility, creator content and local advertising inventory simultaneously.

10. Shared horizontal engines

The five layers depend on common engines. Building them once prevents fragmented user accounts, inconsistent data and duplicated costs.

Engine	Purpose	Non-negotiable outcome
Identity and tenancy	Users, organisations, roles and permissions.	Every vendor-owned record is tenant-scoped and audited.
Catalogue graph	Products, variants, services, attributes and relationships.	Structured data that powers search, content and ads.
Geo engine	Locations, branches, markets, delivery and demand.	Relevant local discovery without excessive tracking.
Trust engine	Verification, freshness, response, reviews and complaints.	Visible, explainable trust rather than a generic badge.
Lead engine	WhatsApp, calls, RFQs, reservations and status.	Attribution from discovery to merchant action.
Content engine	Images, clips, captions, rights and moderation.	Every content item linked to commerce data.
Ads engine	Campaigns, placements, spend, approvals and reporting.	Transparent local commercial advertising.
Affiliate engine	Links, commissions, outcomes, disputes and payouts.	Auditable creator economics.
Analytics engine	Events, funnels, cohorts and merchant reports.	Decision-useful metrics and privacy-safe aggregation.
Billing engine	Plans, credits, invoices and entitlements.	Configurable pricing and multi-currency presentation.

11. Priority users and jobs to be done

A platform that serves everyone equally at launch serves nobody well. Shoppage should prioritise users whose commercial pain is acute and whose behaviour fits the product.

Segment	Primary job	Critical adoption condition
Independent retailer	Turn stock and social posts into searchable local demand.	Fast onboarding and visible leads.
Informal seller / stall	Gain a trusted digital presence without building a website.	Assistance, low cost and mobile simplicity.
Multi-branch merchant	Expose branch inventory and measure campaigns.	Roles, imports, branch data and reporting.
Wholesaler / distributor	Reach resellers and capture structured requests.	Bulk catalogue and RFQ workflows.
Service provider	Show proof of work and receive local enquiries.	Portfolio clips, coverage area and booking/quote request.
Buyer	Find an available item without contacting many sellers.	Freshness, location, price and trust.
Diaspora buyer	Buy or arrange fulfilment for someone in Zimbabwe.	Verified seller, remote payment and proof.
Creator / affiliate	Monetise content and community influence.	Reliable attribution and fair payout.
Market operator	Digitise the whole destination and attract traffic.	Simple administration and shared campaigns.
Brand / distributor	Generate demand and understand category performance.	Campaign scale, brand safety and insight.

12. End-to-end commercial journeys

The business model should be tested through complete journeys, not isolated features.

12.1 Merchant activation journey

9. Merchant is recruited through field agent, market captain, creator, referral or self-registration.
10. Phone and identity are verified; business and location evidence are added progressively.
11. AI-assisted onboarding extracts products from approved photos, spreadsheets or merchant-provided social material.
12. Merchant confirms title, price, currency, stock, location and fulfilment.
13. Shoppage creates the storefront, QR code and shareable product links.
14. Merchant publishes a clip or exports a social post that links back to the structured catalogue.
15. First lead is tracked; merchant receives a response reminder and closes the lead.
16. Merchant is offered a small ad or creator campaign only after catalogue quality is adequate.

12.2 Buyer journey

17. Buyer arrives from search, shared link, market QR, creator clip or direct visit.
18. Buyer selects location or grants coarse location permission.
19. Buyer searches, browses nearby, watches clips or submits a structured request.
20. Results show relevance, distance, freshness, trust and sponsored status.
21. Buyer opens product, checks seller, price, branch and fulfilment.
22. Buyer saves, compares, calls, WhatsApps or requests a quote without mandatory registration.
23. Shoppage records the lead source and prompts the merchant to respond.
24. Buyer can report inaccurate stock, misleading price or seller conduct.

12.3 Creator campaign journey

25. Vendor selects approved products, creator eligibility and commission or production budget.
26. Creators apply or are invited based on category, area and quality.
27. Brief, disclosure, content rights, dates and payout events are agreed.
28. Creator records a tagged clip or collection and submits for review.
29. Content publishes in Showcase and may be exported externally.
30. Attribution follows view-to-action events and verified outcomes.
31. Vendor and creator receive transparent reporting; disputes follow a defined process.

13. Competitive strategy

Shoppage will face global platforms with enormous reach and local platforms with existing awareness. It should not attempt to beat each player at its strongest feature. It should combine local functions that no single competitor currently integrates well.

Player / model	Existing strength	Shoppage response
Facebook Marketplace, Pages and Groups	Reach, familiarity, communities and low-friction posting.	Structured catalogues, freshness, trust, search, local attribution and merchant analytics.
WhatsApp	Direct conversation and ubiquitous merchant behaviour.	Use it as a handoff channel while preserving product and lead context.
Google Search, Maps and local inventory ads	High-intent search, maps and ad infrastructure.	Zimbabwe-first product graph, market clusters, local trust and merchant assistance.
TikTok / Reels / Shorts	Algorithmic video discovery and creator attention.	Commerce-only clips linked to real local products, vendors and outcomes.
Ownai	Broad local e-commerce catalogue and checkout orientation.	Merchant operating system plus geo, media, ads, creators and markets.
Classifieds.co.zw	Established local listing behaviour and category breadth.	Persistent vendor identity, catalogue quality, short video, RFQ and measurable ads.
Shop@Zim	Verified supplier and B2B quote positioning.	Consumer plus B2B demand, geo, content, creators and market clusters.
HyperMarket	Conventional multi-vendor e-commerce and Paynow integration.	Lead-first flexibility, commerce media, creator attribution and market infrastructure.
Independent websites	Brand control and direct customer ownership.	Low-cost operating layer, network demand and shared local discovery.
Physical markets	Trust, availability, bargaining and dense supply.	Digitise discovery without destroying the physical market relationship.

13.1 Global pattern library - adopt selectively

Pattern	Learning	Shoppage application
Shopify merchant OS	Merchants pay for operational control even before marketplace demand.	Central must deliver standalone merchant value.
TikTok Shop	Video, product tagging, creator commissions and seller tools reinforce one another.	Showcase and Creators share catalogue and attribution.
Google local inventory	Nearby stock and pickup convert local search into store visits.	Branch freshness and geo availability are first-class.
YouTube Shopping	Creators tag products while retaining content workflow and analytics.	Creator studio needs tagging, insights and commissions.

Pattern	Learning	Shoppage application
Meesho-style reseller distribution	Community sellers extend reach into trust networks.	Community distributors and group admins become affiliates.
Mercado Libre trust and payments	Trust, payments and logistics deepen only after marketplace liquidity.	Stage transactions after demand and seller quality.
Shopee gamification	Promotions and engagement can accelerate frequency but create subsidy risk.	Use restrained loyalty and campaign tools, not cash-burning games.
Amazon Inspire discontinuation	A generic shopping video feed is not automatically durable.	Video must solve local discovery and link to fresh supply.
Nextdoor local communities	Local relevance creates defensible engagement.	Suburb and market-based commercial discovery.
Jumia operational complexity	Full marketplace fulfilment can consume capital in fragmented markets.	Remain partner-led in payments and delivery initially.

14. Network effects and defensible moat

The interface can be copied. The defensible asset is the interconnected local commerce graph and the operating relationships required to keep it accurate. The v0.4 implementation package establishes the first reproducible version of that graph through source records, evidence states, classification, matching queues, product masters, place nodes and offer observations. The moat now depends on converting this seed into fresh Zimbabwe commercial truth without overstating discovery data.

Moat asset	How it compounds	Why it is difficult to copy
Product graph	More structured products improve search, content and ads.	Requires continuous merchant data cleaning and freshness.
Geo-commerce graph	Branches, markets, pickup points and demand improve local ranking.	Requires field verification and local commercial knowledge.
Trust graph	Response, complaints, identity and fulfilment create reputation.	History cannot be recreated quickly by a new entrant.
Demand graph	Searches, saves, requests and leads reveal unmet demand.	Needs meaningful buyer and seller liquidity.
Content-attribution graph	Clips, creators, products and outcomes improve distribution.	Requires creator relationships and credible attribution.
Market graph	Associations, malls and clusters create dense local supply.	Depends on offline partnerships and operational execution.
Ad performance graph	Local campaign results improve targeting and merchant ROI.	Needs spend history and outcome data.
Operational network	Agents, captains, moderators and support maintain quality.	Field systems and trust take time to establish.

The strongest flywheel is: merchants create fresh supply; supply makes Showcase useful; buyer actions reveal demand; demand attracts advertisers and creators; ads and creators generate merchant outcomes; outcomes improve retention and fund more onboarding; markets create dense clusters that accelerate every step.

15. Revenue model and pricing architecture

Shoppage must diversify revenue while keeping merchant entry friction low. Subscription revenue alone will be insufficient early because many MSMEs need proof of leads before committing to recurring software fees. Managed services, advertising, onboarding and institutional packages should support the first six months.

15.1 Revenue pillars

Revenue line	Who pays	Launch logic
Merchant subscriptions	Vendors and service providers.	Recurring revenue after clear operational value.
Promoted placements	Merchants and brands.	Low-ticket, measurable local visibility.
Managed campaigns	Merchants, distributors and brands.	High-touch early revenue and learning.
Catalogue digitisation	Merchants, markets and institutions.	Solves adoption barrier and funds field operations.
Creator campaigns	Merchants and brands.	Content production plus performance distribution.
Qualified leads	High-value categories and B2B vendors.	Charge for intent when catalogues are incomplete.
Market packages	Malls, associations and commercial clusters.	Dense onboarding and shared promotion.
Data intelligence	Brands, distributors and institutions.	Only aggregated, privacy-safe and sufficiently representative.
Transaction fees	Buyers or merchants later.	Only where Shoppage controls payment or protection.
Partner referrals	Payments, delivery, finance and services.	Transparent and non-exclusive where possible.

15.2 Pricing hypotheses for validation

Offer	Indicative price	Included value
Free Merchant	US\$0	Basic Shop, limited active products, WhatsApp/call, QR and limited analytics.
Starter	US\$5-8/month	More products, offers, freshness tools, basic leads and clips.
Growth	US\$15-20/month	Advanced leads, staff, creator tools, campaign credits and analytics.
Pro	US\$35-60/month	Branches, bulk import, advanced reports, integrations and priority support.
Market	US\$50-250/month	Market page, member administration, shared campaigns and analytics.
Onboarding	US\$20-150 once-off	Catalogue, photography, video and setup depending on scope.
Managed ads	US\$75-500+/month	Campaign strategy, content, optimisation and reporting, excluding spend.
Self-service ads	From US\$2/day or US\$20 campaign	Simple local product, video or lead promotion.

Pricing is a test framework, not a final tariff. Plans must be configurable and allow local invoices in supported currencies. Shoppage should avoid hard-coding product limits, fees or commission rates. Early founding merchants may receive time-limited free Growth access in exchange for complete catalogues, weekly feedback and permission to use performance case studies.

15.3 Scenario economics - not a forecast

Scenario at month 6	Operating assumptions	Monthly revenue range
Conservative	250 active vendors; 50 paying; limited ads; 5 markets.	US\$4,000-8,000
Base	500 active vendors; 150 paying; repeat managed campaigns; 10-15 markets.	US\$12,000-23,000

Scenario at month 6	Operating assumptions	Monthly revenue range
Accelerated	1,000 active vendors; 350 paying; brand campaigns; 25 markets.	US\$28,000-50,000

The revenue ranges depend more on field activation, ad sales and merchant retention than on software completion. Break-even should not be assumed by month six. The base case requires disciplined costs, founder-led sales, local talent, managed infrastructure and avoidance of a proprietary logistics fleet.

16. Delivery budget and operating model

AI-assisted development can compress coding time, but a credible launch still requires engineering, product, design, field operations, merchant success, moderation, sales and compliance. The budget should be chosen explicitly rather than allowing an undefined scope to consume cash.

Delivery mode	0-3 month cash range	Trade-off
Lean founder-led	US\$25,000-45,000	Small senior team, strict scope, founder performs sales and product, limited field coverage.
Standard launch	US\$50,000-90,000	Balanced product team, field onboarding, moderation, content and launch campaigns.
Accelerated national pilot	US\$100,000-180,000	Parallel squads, larger merchant acquisition, more media production and institutional engagement.

These ranges exclude large subsidies, major celebrity campaigns, owned delivery vehicles, office build-outs and national advertising. Cloud, video and messaging costs should start modestly but be instrumented by user and feature so that unit economics remain visible.

16.1 Minimum launch team

Function	Minimum coverage	Critical responsibility
Product / founder	1 accountable lead	Scope, commercial decisions, partner alignment and weekly acceptance.
Engineering	3-5 strong full-stack/backend engineers	Core platform, integrations, quality and security.
Design / research	1 product designer	Mobile flows, field testing and design system.
QA / release	1 shared or dedicated	Test automation, device matrix and launch readiness.
Merchant operations	2-5 field/onboarding staff	Catalogue activation, training and quality.
Growth and ad sales	1-2	Merchant pipeline, campaigns and market partnerships.
Content / moderation	1-2	Video quality, creator briefs, safety and complaints.
Legal / compliance	Part-time specialist	Terms, privacy, consumer, advertising and contracts.

17. Go-to-market strategy

Shoppage should launch as a curated commercial network, not an open empty marketplace. Supply density, freshness and merchant response quality must be established before broad consumer promotion.

17.1 Launch wedge

Recommended first cluster

Home, Power and Building: solar, batteries, inverters, electrical, plumbing, hardware, building materials, appliances, furniture, installation and related services. This cluster supports high-intent search, comparison, quote requests, local availability, technical video and diaspora purchasing.

Selection criterion	Why the wedge fits	Implication
High purchase intent	Buyers actively search and compare.	Search and RFQ produce measurable value.
Local availability matters	Stock and location change the buying decision.	Geo and freshness are meaningful differentiators.
Higher ticket values	A few qualified leads can justify merchant spend.	Lead and managed campaign revenue are viable.
Video is useful	Demonstration and installation reduce uncertainty.	Showcase content adds conversion value.
Diaspora relevance	Remote buyers fund household and construction needs.	Verified fulfilment can become a strong niche.
Dense vendor clusters	Harare has identifiable supplier areas.	Markets and field acquisition can create liquidity quickly.

17.2 Merchant acquisition channels

- Founder-led acquisition of anchor merchants with broad catalogues and recognised locations.
- Market and mall agreements that activate multiple sellers through one relationship.
- Creator and field-agent referral incentives tied to activated, fresh catalogues - not raw registrations.
- Import assistance for merchants already posting on Facebook and WhatsApp, using only merchant-authorized data.
- Partnerships with distributors, brands, associations and service providers.
- Founding-merchant programme with free access, professional setup and performance reviews.
- Case studies showing search-to-lead and content-to-lead outcomes.

17.3 Buyer acquisition channels

- Shareable product, market and video links distributed through Facebook and WhatsApp.
- QR codes at stores, markets, events, receipts, packaging and delivery points.
- Creator collections and local deal content.
- Search-engine-indexed product and vendor pages.
- Buyer-request campaigns: "Tell Shoppage what you need; matched vendors respond."
- Category content and price guides that answer local buying questions.
- Partnership campaigns with markets, brands, radio, community pages and institutions.

18. Field operations and the 1,000-entity market register

The 1,000-entity research requirement should become an operational asset rather than a presentation claim. Shoppage should build a structured market register during launch, combining research, sales pipeline and catalogue acquisition.

Entity class	Target count	Data captured
Facebook-led informal and small sellers	400	Category, area, page/group activity, products, contact, trust and workflow.
Formal retailers and service businesses	250	Branches, systems, ad spend, catalogue size and decision maker.

Entity class	Target count	Data captured
Creators, group admins and media pages	100	Audience, category, geography, content capability and commercial terms.
Markets, malls and commercial clusters	100	Ownership, vendor count, location, category mix and administration.
Brands, distributors and wholesalers	75	Channel structure, campaign needs, data and reseller network.
Payments, logistics, finance and support partners	50	Coverage, integration, service level, pricing and regulation.
Institutions and associations	25	Mandate, beneficiaries, partnership case and governance.

Each record must have a source, date, owner, consent status where contact data is stored, verification state and next action. Public Facebook observations can inform patterns, but Shoppage must not violate platform terms, bypass access controls or scrape private data. Merchant-authorised imports and manual field verification are the safe default.

18.1 Merchant activation standard

Stage	Definition of done	Owner
Qualified	Relevant category, location and decision maker identified.	Sales / field.
Verified	Phone and minimum identity/location evidence accepted.	Trust operations.
Catalogued	Minimum product threshold and required data complete.	Onboarding.
Fresh	Required share confirmed inside category window.	Merchant success.
Responsive	Test lead answered within agreed SLA.	Merchant success.
Activated	At least one real buyer action or campaign interaction.	Growth.
Retained	Active and fresh across consecutive review periods.	Account owner.

19. Trust, safety and consumer protection

Trust should be visible, progressive and explainable. Shoppage must not create a badge that buyers interpret as a guarantee when only a phone number was checked.

Trust level	Evidence	Displayed meaning
Contact verified	Phone and email or OTP.	The contact channel is controlled by this account.
Identity verified	Government-issued identity or approved business representative.	Shoppage has verified the responsible person.
Location verified	Site visit, geotagged evidence or recognised market confirmation.	The stated trading location has been checked.
Business verified	Company or trading documents where applicable.	Business credentials have been reviewed.
Performance verified	Sustained response, accurate listings and low complaint rate.	Platform behaviour supports higher trust.

19.1 Safety controls

- Prohibited and restricted goods policy before launch.

- High-risk category rules and manual review.
- Suspicious price and duplicate-image detection.
- New-account limits on ads, reach and mass uploads.
- Buyer warnings for off-platform deposits and unverifiable claims.
- Complaint intake, evidence upload, response deadlines and appeal.
- Creator and advertiser disclosure enforcement.
- Product recall and urgent content takedown process.
- Law-enforcement request process reviewed by counsel and logged.

Reviews should not launch as an unmoderated star-rating system. Early trust is better built from verified transactions or leads, response metrics, listing accuracy, complaint handling and structured buyer feedback. Anonymous public accusations can create defamation and manipulation risk.

20. Payments, currencies, fulfilment and logistics

The architectural boundary is now explicit: Shoppage owns the transaction and fulfilment workflow, evidence and customer experience, while licensed payment providers and approved merchant or logistics partners execute regulated money movement and physical delivery. This is on-platform orchestration, not an uncontrolled off-platform handoff.

Capability	0-3 months	4-6 months
Currency	USD and ZWG display, dated rates, price-valid-until and merchant confirmation.	More currencies for diaspora and improved rate governance.
Payment methods	Cash, collection, mobile money, bank, card/pay-link and deposit flags.	Integrated payment links, deposits and selected protected payments.
Checkout	Optional reservation or quote, no forced universal cart.	Single-vendor checkout for selected categories.
Delivery	Merchant delivery, pickup and partner quote request.	Integrated partner estimates, dispatch status and proof.
Buyer protection	Warnings, verified sellers, complaint path and evidence.	Limited escrow/protection pilot with regulated partner.
Settlement	Outside platform unless integrated partner handles payment.	Reconciliation and vendor payout only after controls are ready.

Shoppage must create and retain the commercial record, payment status, fulfilment choice, proof, complaint and outcome. It should not initially hold customer funds, store sensitive payment credentials, operate a wallet, pool multi-vendor settlements, own a fleet or run warehouses. The merchant remains the merchant of record for normal vendor sales.

Multi-vendor settlement, Shoppage-held escrow, universal refunds and chargebacks, owned fulfilment and warehousing are intentionally excluded from the first six months. Part V defines the payment, fulfilment, Merchant Site and Pemosites decisions in implementation detail.

21. AI operating model

AI should reduce the cost of creating and maintaining a high-quality local commerce graph. It should not be positioned as a decorative chatbot or allowed to make unreviewed commercial, moderation or payment decisions.

21.1 AI for merchant operations

- Extract product titles, prices, attributes and contacts from merchant-authorised images, PDFs and spreadsheets.
- Clean titles, standardise brands and suggest categories while preserving original data.

- Generate missing descriptions, specifications and social captions for merchant approval.
- Detect duplicates, improbable prices, stale products and conflicting branch information.
- Create video captions, thumbnails, price overlays and translated text.
- Summarise leads and suggest follow-up actions.
- Recommend which products need confirmation, promotion or better media.

21.2 AI for buyers, ads and creators

- Semantic search across local naming variations and mixed-language queries.
- Buyer-request parsing and vendor matching.
- Product and content recommendations constrained by location, freshness and safety.
- Campaign budget and creative suggestions based on verified outcomes.
- Creator-product matching based on category, geography, quality and audience fit.
- Fraud, spam, prohibited-content and misleading-claim risk scoring.
- Customer-support triage with human escalation.

21.3 AI development discipline

Use of AI in development	Required control	Reason
Code generation	Human review, tests, linting and dependency checks.	Speed without hidden security and maintainability debt.
Schema and migrations	Architecture approval and rollback plan.	Data integrity is harder to repair than UI defects.
Test generation	Coverage review and realistic fixtures.	Generated tests can repeat the same mistaken assumption.
UI implementation	Design-system constraints and device QA.	Avoid inconsistent or inaccessible screens.
Security review	Automated scanning plus specialist review.	AI cannot certify compliance or threat resistance.
Production operations	No unrestricted model access to production secrets or data.	Protect users, vendors and infrastructure.

22. Technology architecture

The existing modular-monolith direction remains appropriate. The launch architecture should maximise speed, type safety, tenant isolation and managed infrastructure while keeping future extraction possible. The commerce-intelligence package uses SQLite for reproducible scale testing and package delivery; production authority must remain PostgreSQL, with immutable source evidence, review services, current-state materialisations and search indexes connected through NestJS.

Layer	Recommended technology	Implementation decision
Public and merchant web	Next.js App Router PWA, Tailwind and component system.	One responsive app with role-based surfaces during MVP.
Operations console	Refine Core or custom admin components.	Internal dense workflows, not the main merchant experience.
API and business rules	NestJS modular monolith.	Authoritative layer for permissions, ads, leads and billing.
Database and ORM	PostgreSQL / Supabase with Prisma.	Tenant-scoped relational source of truth.
Search	Meilisearch plus PostgreSQL fallbacks.	Products, vendors, markets, videos and geo facets.
Jobs	BullMQ and Redis.	Imports, indexing, media, reminders, analytics and AI.
Images and files	Supabase Storage or compatible object storage.	Organisation-scoped paths and policies.

Layer	Recommended technology	Implementation decision
Short video	Cloudflare Stream initially; Mux as alternative.	Direct upload, encoding, adaptive delivery and analytics.
Analytics	First-party event pipeline and product analytics.	Avoid dependence on a single external analytics vendor.
Hosting	Vercel plus container host; managed database and Redis.	Fast deployment with infrastructure as code.

A separate native mobile app is not required for the 0-3 month launch. A strong PWA provides shareable URLs, search visibility, app-like navigation and one codebase. Native applications can be introduced after repeat usage, notification needs, offline workflows or device integration justify the maintenance cost.

22.1 Module boundaries

Domain group	0-3 month modules	Expansion modules
Identity	Auth, users, organisations, roles, memberships and audit.	SSO, advanced delegation and institutional tenancy.
Merchant	Stores, branches, hours, policies, staff and verification.	Franchise and distributor hierarchies.
Catalogue	Categories, products, variants, media, price and freshness.	Supplier feeds, bundles and advanced compatibility.
Discovery	Search, geo, Showcase feed, saves and comparisons.	Advanced personalisation and visual search.
Demand	Leads, buyer requests, routing, notes and reminders.	Bookings, orders and transaction workflows.
Media	Clips, captions, tags, rights and moderation.	Live commerce and richer editing.
Advertising	Campaigns, budgets, placements, approvals and reports.	Agency accounts and advanced optimisation.
Creators	Profiles, links, briefs, commissions and disputes.	Automated payouts and creator marketplace depth.
Markets	Markets, captains, members, events and sponsorships.	Local-authority and market-management integrations.
Platform	Plans, billing, notifications, support and analytics.	Enterprise APIs and data products.

23. Data governance, privacy and security

Shoppage will process identity, location, contact, behavioural, advertising and potentially payment-related data. Privacy and security must be designed before launch, not added after an endorsement or incident. Data governance must also preserve predicate-specific source authority, licensing, observation time, evidence hashes, confidence, review state and unresolved conflicts. A public record is not automatically reusable content or verified current truth.

- Register and operate as required under Zimbabwe data-protection rules, with counsel confirming controller and processor obligations.
- Collect the minimum location precision and personal data needed for each function.
- Use explicit purpose notices for merchant verification, buyer accounts, creator attribution and advertising.
- Maintain consent, lawful-basis, access, correction, deletion and retention workflows.
- Separate public business data from private identity and verification documents.
- Encrypt data in transit and at rest; protect secrets with managed key and environment controls.
- Apply PostgreSQL row-level security as defence in depth, but keep NestJS authorisation authoritative.
- Require multi-factor authentication for platform administrators and sensitive merchant roles.

- Log administrative access, verification decisions, campaign edits and data exports.
- Prepare breach response, vendor-risk review, backup restore tests and incident communications.

Data sovereignty should be a staged operational commitment. Version 1 may rely on reputable global managed infrastructure because reliability and security matter. Shoppage should maintain data portability, local corporate control, documented sub-processors, regional backup strategy and a roadmap for increased local or regional hosting where technically and economically justified.

24. Metrics and management system

The launch must be governed by evidence. Registrations, raw listings and video views are supporting metrics, not proof of a functioning commerce platform.

Metric group	Primary measures	Why it matters
Supply quality	Active verified vendors, fresh products, catalogue completeness and branch accuracy.	Determines whether discovery can be trusted.
Demand	Searches, product opens, buyer requests, saves and return visits.	Shows real buyer utility.
Conversion	Search-to-contact, product-to-lead, RFQ fill and merchant response.	Connects activity to commerce.
Merchant value	Qualified leads, reported sales, repeat campaigns and retention.	Supports willingness to pay.
Creator value	Active creators, accepted content, attributed leads and payout accuracy.	Validates distribution network.
Ad value	Spend, cost per lead, campaign repeat and advertiser retention.	Tests local ad substitution.
Market value	Active market vendors, market demand and sponsorship revenue.	Tests market-in-market model.
Trust	Complaint rate, accuracy reports, resolution time and repeat buyers.	Protects the brand and adoption.
Operations	Activation cost, time to catalogue, moderation SLA and support load.	Determines scalability.
Economics	Revenue per active vendor, gross margin and cash burn.	Determines sustainability.

24.1 Month-three launch thresholds

Outcome	Minimum target	Stretch target
Verified active vendors	100	200
Fresh active products / services	5,000	12,000
Tagged short clips	500	1,500
Active markets / clusters	5	10
Active creators / agents	30	75
Median merchant response	Under 2 business hours	Under 30 minutes in trading hours
Visible listings confirmed in policy window	At least 80%	At least 90%
Buyer actions per week	1,000 qualified actions	3,000 qualified actions
Repeat advertisers	10	25

25. 0-3 month implementation roadmap

The implementation plan assumes a senior team, strict product ownership, managed infrastructure, AI-assisted engineering and daily access to merchants for validation. It delivers one commercially operable release across all five layers by the end of week 12. The starting point is now the validated v0.4 commerce-intelligence seed; the critical path is productionising its evidence model and acquiring authorised Zimbabwe offers, not rebuilding the reference layer from zero.

Period	Build and operating focus	Exit condition
Weeks 0-1	Company, legal, brand, architecture, design system, monorepo, environments, analytics taxonomy and pilot merchant list.	Approved scope, clickable flows, running skeleton and 30 committed pilot merchants.
Week 2	Auth, organisations, roles, vendor onboarding, stores, branches, geo model and audit.	Merchant can create a secure organisation and branch.
Week 3	Catalogue, products, media, price, currency, stock, freshness and assisted import.	Merchant can publish a complete structured product.
Week 4	Showcase search, categories, product pages, store pages, nearby and sharing.	Buyer can discover and contact a relevant vendor.
Week 5	Video upload, processing, tagging, feed, captions and moderation queue.	Buyer can watch a tagged clip and open the product.
Week 6	Leads, WhatsApp/call attribution, buyer requests, routing and merchant inbox.	Demand can be captured, routed and managed.
Week 7	Ads campaign setup, budgets, placements, sponsored labels, approvals and reports.	Merchant can run and measure a simple paid campaign.
Week 8	Creator profiles, product links, briefs, attribution and manual payout ledger.	Creator can produce tagged content with auditable performance.
Week 9	Markets, captains, membership, shared feed, map, events and QR.	One real market can operate end to end.
Week 10	Trust levels, complaints, policies, consent, notifications, billing plans and support tools.	Commercial and safety controls ready for pilot.
Week 11	Device QA, security review, load testing, data clean-up, merchant training and content seeding.	Launch candidate passes acceptance and incident drills.
Week 12	Curated Harare launch, campaign execution, daily operations room and KPI review.	Public release with monitored supply, demand and support.

25.1 Parallel non-engineering workstream

Workstream	Weeks 0-6	Weeks 7-12
Merchant acquisition	Anchor merchants, market agreements and catalogue pilots.	Activation, freshness and case studies.
1,000-entity register	Build taxonomy, collect and qualify first 600 entities.	Complete 1,000, deduplicate and prioritise pipeline.
Creators	Recruit 20 pilot creators and define briefs.	Publish campaigns, assess quality and attribution.
Ads sales	Interview advertisers and package managed offers.	Sell first repeatable campaigns and establish reporting.
Trust / compliance	Policies, verification design and legal review.	Operational moderation, complaints and audits.
Partnerships	Payments, video, logistics, markets and institutional meetings.	Pilot agreements and launch participation.

25.2 Scope exclusions protecting the deadline

- No owned delivery fleet or warehouse.
- No universal multi-vendor cart or complex split settlement.
- No unrestricted live streaming.
- No public political advertising.
- No national rollout before Harare supply quality is proven.
- No advanced loyalty game or subsidy programme.
- No uncontrolled web scraping or private social-data collection.
- No microservices decomposition unless a proven technical constraint requires it.
- No separate native iOS and Android applications before PWA validation.

26. 4-6 month expansion roadmap

Months four to six expand a working system. They should not be used to finish essential version 1 features that were allowed to slip without an explicit decision.

Expansion area	Month 4	Months 5-6
Geography	Bulawayo supply activation and second-city market pages.	Selected corridors or cities based on partner density.
Categories	Phones/electronics or auto spares pilot after data model review.	Agriculture, fashion or services based on evidence.
Transactions	Reservations, deposits and payment links with partners.	Selected checkout and buyer-protection pilot.
Delivery	Partner directory, quotes and fulfilment status.	Integrated estimates, dispatch updates and proof.
Creators	More categories, creator marketplace and quality tiers.	Automated commission rules and payout integration.
Ads	Self-service improvements, saved audiences and brand dashboards.	Agency accounts, better optimisation and sponsorship products.
Markets	10-25 active markets and standard onboarding kit.	Provincial and institutional market programmes.
AI	Better matching, moderation and merchant recommendations.	Personalisation and demand forecasting where data supports it.
Data products	Internal category dashboards.	Pilot aggregated reports for brands and distributors.
Institutional engagement	Demonstrate measured Harare outcomes.	National partnership and endorsement brief based on evidence.

Expansion into South Africa should not begin during months four to six unless Zimbabwe execution is materially ahead of plan and a specific funded opportunity exists. The model should be designed for multi-country support, but the organisation should not split focus before local network effects and revenue are visible.

27. Governance and decision rights

A platform with advertising, creators, trust decisions and national ambitions needs explicit decision rights. Founder control alone is insufficient once campaigns, complaints and public partnerships scale.

Governance body	Mandate	Cadence
Executive operating review	Product, growth, revenue, cash and major risks.	Weekly.
Trust and safety review	Complaints, fraud, prohibited content and appeals.	Weekly, urgent as needed.

Governance body	Mandate	Cadence
Data and AI review	Privacy, model changes, data products and automated decisions.	Monthly.
Merchant council	Merchant pain, pricing, policies and roadmap feedback.	Monthly.
Creator council	Attribution, disclosure, rates and content standards.	Monthly.
Independent advisory board	National value, governance, partnerships and strategic risk.	Quarterly.

Public-sector partnerships should be documented, time-bound and transparent. Shoppage should avoid dependence on a single ministry, political sponsor, telecom operator, bank or advertising customer. Commercial ranking and moderation rules must remain platform-governed and publicly described.

28. Risk register and mitigation

The model is ambitious. The principal risks are operational, not conceptual.

Risk	Failure mode	Mitigation
Overbuilding	Team attempts a full TikTok, Google, Shopify and Amazon clone.	Version 1 completion tests and scope exclusions.
Empty marketplace	Public launch before dense, fresh supply exists.	Curated Harare wedge and anchor merchants.
Stale catalogue	Buyers encounter wrong prices and unavailable products.	Freshness engine, reminders, ranking decay and penalties.
Weak merchant response	Leads are ignored and buyers lose trust.	Response SLA, routing, alerts and performance visibility.
Low willingness to pay	Merchants do not value software alone.	Lead proof, ads, managed services and onboarding revenue.
Video cost / data burden	Feed becomes expensive or excludes low-data users.	Short clips, adaptive delivery, low-data mode and cost telemetry.
Fraud and scams	Platform reputation is damaged.	Progressive verification, limits, moderation and complaint operations.
Creator abuse	Fake leads, undisclosed ads and low-quality content.	Attribution rules, disclosure, review and payout windows.
Regulatory failure	Data, advertising or consumer obligations are missed.	Early legal review, policies, logs and designated compliance owner.
Political capture perception	Platform is seen as partisan or a surveillance tool.	Neutral governance, no political ads and privacy controls.
Platform dependency	External hosting, WhatsApp or payment changes disrupt operations.	Adapters, portability, graceful fallback and multi-partner strategy.
Cash burn	Field operations and media outpace revenue.	City/category focus, unit economics and milestone-based hiring.

29. Decision gates

Management should stop, narrow or change direction when evidence contradicts assumptions. Commitment to the mission does not justify ignoring poor unit economics or buyer trust.

Gate	Proceed condition	Action if missed
Week 3 supply gate	At least 30 merchants can maintain structured catalogues.	Simplify onboarding and increase assisted service.
Week 6 demand gate	Real buyers use search/RFQ and merchants respond.	Refine wedge, routing and buyer acquisition before ads.

Gate	Proceed condition	Action if missed
Week 8 ad gate	Merchants understand objectives and pay for test campaigns.	Emphasise managed campaigns and lead products.
Week 10 trust gate	Verification, complaint and moderation workflows work in drills.	Delay public scale; do not waive controls.
Month 3 retention gate	Merchants maintain freshness and repeat actions.	Reduce category breadth and strengthen success operations.
Month 4 city gate	Harare has stable supply and repeat demand.	Delay Bulawayo expansion.
Month 6 economics gate	Repeat revenue is growing and activation cost is controlled.	Restructure pricing, field model or category focus.

30. Final business model

Shoppage is Zimbabwe-owned commerce media infrastructure. Shoppage Central turns merchants into structured commerce nodes. Shoppage Showcase turns products, places and short videos into local buyer discovery. Shoppage Ads captures measurable commercial attention. Shoppage Creators turns local influence and content capability into attributable income. Shoppage Markets digitises dense commercial destinations and communities.

The model stands above a conventional marketplace because it does not depend on native checkout to create value. It stands above classifieds because sellers become persistent, verified operating entities rather than isolated posts. It stands above social media for commerce because content is attached to fresh catalogues and measurable outcomes. It stands above a directory because buyers can search actual products, watch demonstrations, submit demand and contact relevant vendors. It stands above a pure advertising platform because it owns the local commerce graph needed to target purchase intent.

Final strategic instruction

Build the commerce graph first. Make it fresh, local, trusted, measurable and useful before scaling. Use Facebook and WhatsApp as acquisition and distribution bridges, not permanent owners of the customer relationship. Sell merchants outcomes, not software features. Earn national endorsement through verified public value, not promises.

31. Immediate executive actions

The following decisions should be completed before the first development sprint begins.

32. Approve Shoppage as the master brand and commission trademark/domain checks.
33. Approve the five-layer architecture and the shared horizontal engines.
34. Appoint one accountable product owner with authority to enforce scope.
35. Select the 0-3 month budget mode and secure the full launch runway.
36. Recruit the senior engineering lead, product designer and merchant-operations lead.
37. Confirm the Home, Power and Building launch wedge and Harare pilot zones.
38. Secure 30 anchor merchants and at least one market partner before week 2 ends.
39. Commission legal review of data protection, consumer, advertising, creator and marketplace terms.
40. Create the 1,000-entity register schema and assign field ownership.
41. Approve the week-12 launch thresholds and stop/go decision process.

Appendix A. Version 1 product requirements by layer

This appendix converts the model into a compact release checklist.

Layer	Must have by week 12	Not required for launch
Central	Auth, organisations, stores, branches, catalogue, media, price, stock, freshness, leads, staff, analytics, billing.	Accounting, payroll, procurement and advanced ERP.
Showcase	Search, geo, feed, clips, product/store/market pages, saves, contact, RFQ and reports.	General social graph, messaging replacement and entertainment feed.
Ads	Campaign objective, product/video/store promotion, geo/category targeting, budget, review, placement and reporting.	External ad network, real-time bidding and complex lookalikes.
Creators	Profile, application, tagged links, briefs, disclosure, attribution, ledger and disputes.	Automated bank payouts and live commerce.
Markets	Market identity, boundary, admins, members, combined feed, search, map, QR, events, ads and analytics.	Lease, rent, security and full market management.

Appendix B. Core data entities

The entity model should be agreed before rapid AI-assisted coding begins. Inconsistent naming and relationships will otherwise create expensive migrations.

Domain	Core entities	Key relationships
Identity	User, organisation, membership, role, verification, consent and audit event.	Users join organisations with scoped roles.
Merchant	Vendor, store, branch, location, hours, policy, payment method and delivery zone.	Vendor owns stores and branches.
Catalogue	Category, product, variant, attribute, media, price, inventory state and freshness event.	Products belong to vendor and may be available at branches.
Discovery	Search event, save, comparison, collection, recommendation and geo context.	Buyer actions connect demand to catalogue.
Media	Video, image, caption, tag, rights, moderation decision and view event.	Content tags products, stores, markets and campaigns.
Demand	Lead, buyer request, match, contact action, status, note and outcome.	Demand connects buyer context to vendors and creators.
Ads	Advertiser, campaign, objective, audience, creative, placement, budget, spend and result.	Campaign promotes commerce objects.
Creators	Creator profile, affiliate link, brief, commission, attribution, dispute and payout ledger.	Creator promotes approved commerce objects.
Markets	Market, boundary, member, captain, event, sponsorship and QR asset.	Markets aggregate vendors and content.
Platform	Plan, entitlement, invoice, credit, notification, support case and feature flag.	Commercial rules apply to organisations and users.

Appendix C. Analytics event standard

Events must be defined before launch so merchant and advertiser reports are comparable.

Event family	Examples	Required context
Discovery	search_submitted, result_viewed, filter_applied, nearby_opened.	Query, category, coarse location and result set.
Content	video_impression, video_started, video_completed, product_tag_opened.	Video, creator, product, campaign and placement.
Commerce	product_viewed, saved, compared, WhatsApp_clicked, call_clicked.	Product, vendor, branch, source and sponsored state.
Demand	request_created, vendor_matched, lead_opened, lead_responded, outcome_reported.	Request, vendor, creator attribution and timing.
Ads	campaign_created, approved, impression, click, spend, conversion.	Advertiser, budget, placement and objective.
Trust	listing_reported, complaint_created, verification_changed, action_taken.	Actor, entity, evidence and resolution.
Merchant	product_created, price_changed, stock_confirmed, video_published.	Organisation, user, branch and timestamp.

Appendix D. Evidence base and source notes

The business model uses the prior Shoppage baseline and current public evidence. The sources below support the principal market, platform and infrastructure assumptions; they are not a substitute for the 1,000-entity field register.

- Existing Shoppage / ShopPage consolidated business model and technology baseline - Local uploaded project document.
- Zimbabwe - eCommerce, U.S. International Trade Administration, last published 26 March 2026 - <https://www.trade.gov/country-commercial-guides/zimbabwe-ecommerce>
- Digital 2026: Zimbabwe, DataReportal - <https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-zimbabwe>
- Zimbabwe eTrade Readiness Assessment, UN Trade and Development - <https://unctad.org/publication/zimbabwe-etrade-readiness-assessment>
- FinScope MSME Survey Zimbabwe 2022 - <https://www.finscope.co.za/>
- Ownai Marketplace - <https://www.ownai.co.zw/>
- Classifieds.co.zw - <https://www.classifieds.co.zw/>
- Shop@Zim - <https://shopatzim.co.zw/>
- HyperMarket Zimbabwe - <https://hypermarket.co.zw/>
- Google Merchant Center - Local inventory ads and free local listings - <https://support.google.com/merchants/answer/14615117>
- YouTube Shopping affiliate programme overview - <https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/13376398>
- TikTok Shop Affiliate Marketing - <https://seller.tiktokglobalshop.com/business/en/affiliate>
- Cloudflare Stream documentation and pricing - <https://developers.cloudflare.com/stream/>
- Mux video pricing - <https://www.mux.com/pricing>
- Supabase Storage documentation - <https://supabase.com/docs/guides/storage>
- Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe publications and payment-system reports - <https://www.rbz.co.zw/>
- Postal and Telecommunications Regulatory Authority of Zimbabwe reports - <https://www.potraz.gov.zw/>
- Zimbabwe legal and statutory materials - Veritas - <https://www.veritaszim.net/>

Appendix E. National impact scorecard for public engagement

This scorecard should be populated with live evidence before any presidential or national endorsement request.

Impact area	100-day evidence	Six-month evidence
MSME digitisation	Verified active merchants and fresh catalogues.	Retention, paid adoption and provincial reach.
Local ad retention	Campaign spend processed locally and first repeat advertisers.	Share of merchant digital budget moved to Shoppage.
Youth and creator income	Creators, agents and content fees paid.	Repeat earners and full-time equivalent jobs.
Consumer value	Search-to-lead, response and complaint resolution.	Repeat buyers, trust and reported fulfilment.
Markets and devolution	Active Harare market pages.	Multiple city and district market programmes.
Diaspora commerce	Verified leads and fulfilment pilots.	Repeat remote purchases and delivery evidence.
Local industry	Manufacturers and distributors listed.	B2B enquiries, reseller connections and demand insights.
Governance	Privacy, safety and audit controls operating.	Independent review and published transparency report.

END OF PART I - CORE IMPLEMENTATION BLUEPRINT

PART II

STRATEGIC SUPERIORITY, COMMERCE INTELLIGENCE AND INVESTOR DEFENSIBILITY

This part is integral to the business model. It converts the ambition to outclass local and global alternatives into implementable product systems, proprietary assets, operating disciplines and measurable gates.

Part II contents

The following chapters define what must be true for Shoppage to become difficult to reproduce, nationally useful, continuously improving and investable.

- 32. Non-negotiable Shoppage doctrine
- 33. The difficult-to-copy moat system
- 34. Zimbabwe Commerce Intelligence Graph
- 35. Intelligence products unavailable through ordinary search
- 36. International product and service quality standard
- 37. Continuous competitor matching and improvement system
- 38. AI-native platform and operating model
- 39. Investor-proof company architecture
- 40. Existing-player analysis and outclass strategy
- 41. Daily utility and responsible habit formation
- 42. Twenty-four additional strategic product ideas
- 43. Practical 0-3 month implementation upgrade
- 44. Months 4-6 expansion and compounding plan
- 45. National legitimacy, endorsement and public-value safeguards
- 46. Organisational model, talent and operating cadence
- 47. Strategic KPI and proof framework
- 48. Final non-negotiable decision statement

- Appendix F. Commerce graph entities and intelligence claims
- Appendix G. AI evaluation and safety gates
- Appendix H. Competitive benchmark references

32. Non-negotiable Shoppage doctrine

The following requirements are not marketing language. Each one creates a product obligation, a data obligation, an operating obligation and a proof metric.

Requirement	Implementation meaning	Proof standard
1. Difficult to recreate	Build proprietary verified data, workflows, relationships, response history and field operations.	A competitor can copy screens but cannot reproduce the underlying graph, trust and outcomes quickly.
2. Intelligence beyond search	Record places, companies, branches, products, variants, availability, pricing, demand, relationships and operational constraints.	Answers must include live and local facts not reliably available through generic web results.
3. International quality	Use global standards for speed, accessibility, safety, search, design, reliability and support.	Zimbabwe-specific design must improve relevance without lowering quality.
4. Continuous improvement	Use modular architecture, event telemetry, feature flags, experiments and competitor reviews.	The release process must respond to evidence faster than competitors can respond to Shoppage.
5. Practicality	Launch city by city and category by category, with assisted onboarding and measurable use cases.	No feature ships without an owner, operating process, adoption path and success metric.
6. AI infused	Embed AI in ingestion, normalisation, search, assistance, risk, content, recommendations and operations.	AI reduces cost or improves decisions; it never becomes a decorative chatbot.
7. Investor proof	Demonstrate recurring revenue, improving unit economics, proprietary assets, governance and expansion logic.	Capital must compound the moat rather than fund uncontrolled feature breadth.
8. Local outperformance	Benchmark Facebook, Google, WhatsApp, Classifieds, Ownai, Shop@Zim and emerging platforms.	Shoppage wins on Zimbabwean commercial intent, structured data, trust, geo and outcomes.
9. Daily relevance	Create legitimate daily reasons to return: alerts, deals, requests, market activity, price intelligence and saved needs.	Optimise for useful repeat behaviour, not compulsive dark patterns.
10. National utility	Support formal and informal commerce, urban and provincial markets, diaspora demand and local value retention.	Public-value claims must be independently measurable.

Product doctrine

Shoppage is not a website with listings. It is a continuously updated operating map of Zimbabwean commerce, connected to tools that improve the businesses and markets represented in that map.

33. The difficult-to-copy moat system

No single feature creates defensibility. Shoppage requires a layered moat in which every additional merchant, product, buyer request, creator, market and verified outcome improves the system for all other participants.

33.1 The nine compounding moats

Moat	What Shoppage owns	Why it compounds
Commerce graph moat	Resolved identities for businesses, places, products, variants, markets, creators and supply relationships.	Accumulated breadth, history, provenance and entity resolution.
Freshness moat	Price-validity, stock confirmations, response behaviour and customer corrections.	Operational routines and longitudinal history that static directories lack.
Demand moat	Searches, buyer requests, saves, shortages, comparisons and unfulfilled demand by location.	Exclusive first-party intent generated inside Shoppage.
Trust moat	Verification, complaints, response rates, fulfilment evidence and appeals.	Time-dependent reputation cannot be recreated from copied listings.
Workflow moat	Merchant catalogue, lead, campaign, creator and market management embedded in daily operations.	Switching costs created by useful work history, not artificial lock-in.
Distribution moat	Creators, market captains, field agents, associations, QR surfaces and merchant sharing.	Physical and social routes to market that software-only competitors cannot instantly acquire.
Outcome moat	Attributed calls, WhatsApp actions, RFQs, visits, reservations and verified fulfilment.	Proof that advertising and discovery generated economic activity.
Institutional moat	Relationships with markets, brands, councils, banks, telecoms, associations and development institutions.	Contractual and operational integration around public and commercial value.
Learning moat	AI models, rules and recommendations trained on local taxonomy, language and commerce outcomes.	Better local decisions as proprietary labelled data grows.

33.2 Copy-resistance rules

- Every public-facing feature must strengthen at least one proprietary asset: structured data, verified identity, demand history, trust, workflow adoption, distribution or outcomes.
- Do not expose bulk proprietary intelligence through unrestricted APIs. Publish useful results while controlling high-value exports, rate limits, licensing and provenance.
- Allow merchant data portability and lawful user rights, but preserve derived platform signals, aggregate models and fraud controls as Shoppage intellectual property where legally permissible.
- Prefer workflows that solve recurring jobs. A copied interface has limited value if merchants still use Shoppage to manage the underlying catalogue, campaigns, leads and reputation.
- Create field and partner processes that produce unique information: stall mapping, branch verification, stock confirmation, payment methods, delivery areas and market operating conditions.
- Use canonical IDs, historical versions and evidence links. A competitor scraping a current page should not obtain the longitudinal intelligence behind the current answer.

33.3 Defensibility milestone gates

Milestone	Required evidence	Management decision
Month 1	Canonical data model, verification method, provenance rules and merchant workflow in production.	Do not add category breadth until data quality is stable.
Month 3	Dense launch graph with fresh listings, demand events, response history, creator attribution and market relationships.	Scale only the categories where the graph improves buyer outcomes.
Month 6	Repeat advertiser spend, repeat buyer use, proprietary demand reports and declining activation cost.	Raise expansion capital against demonstrated compounding assets.

Milestone	Required evidence	Management decision
Month 12	Multi-city graph, institutional integrations and intelligence products with measurable retention.	Expand country or category footprint without weakening trust.

34. Zimbabwe Commerce Intelligence Graph

The central proprietary asset is the Zimbabwe Commerce Intelligence Graph: a versioned, evidence-backed representation of who sells what, where it is available, in which variant, at what price, under which conditions, to whom, with what trust and with which unmet demand.

34.1 What the graph must know

Graph domain	Examples	Required intelligence fields
Places	Provinces, cities, suburbs, growth points, streets, landmarks, malls, markets, industrial clusters, pickup points and delivery corridors.	Boundaries, hierarchy, coordinates, aliases, access, hours and confidence.
Businesses	Formal companies, informal traders, market stalls, branches, service providers, distributors, manufacturers and associations.	Identity, category, contacts, locations, status, verification, relationships and history.
Products and variants	Canonical products, local names, brands, models, sizes, colours, grades, packs, conditions, compatibility and alternatives.	Attributes, evidence, media, offers, branch availability, currency and price validity.
Services	Installers, repairers, delivery operators, professionals, artisans and recurring service providers.	Service area, qualifications, capacity, pricing logic, response and outcomes.
Supply relationships	Manufacturer-distributor-retailer-reseller links, market membership, creator partnerships and delivery coverage.	Direction, evidence, effective dates, confidence and commercial restrictions.
Demand	Searches, requests, saves, comparisons, shortages, desired prices, intended location and urgency.	Anonymous/coarse by default; consented personal data only where required.
Behaviour	Views, responses, fulfilment reports, complaints, repeat visits, creator influence and campaign outcomes.	Event-level controls, retention rules and privacy-safe aggregates.
Improvement opportunities	Missing products, weak response, poor media, stale stock, pricing gaps, low trust and underserved areas.	Recommended action, expected value, owner and evidence.

34.2 Evidence and provenance architecture

Every material fact must be stored as a claim with source, timestamp, confidence and responsible actor. Shoppage should avoid one editable field that silently overwrites history. The system should distinguish what a merchant declared, what a field agent observed, what a buyer reported, what an integration supplied and what an AI model inferred.

Evidence class	Examples	Control
First-party merchant	Catalogue entries, stock confirmations, branch details, delivery zones and policies.	Authenticated actor, audit history, reminders and random verification.
Field verified	Physical location, signage, stall position, operating hours and product sample.	Agent identity, timestamp, evidence media and supervisor spot check.
Customer contributed	Availability correction, proof of visit, review, complaint and fulfilled request.	Anti-abuse controls, evidence requirements and appeal.

Evidence class	Examples	Control
Partner supplied	Distributor feed, payment status, market roster, logistics coverage and registry reference.	Contract, schema validation, refresh SLA and data-use terms.
Public-source extracted	Business pages, public posts, websites, catalogues and directories.	Respect terms and law; retain source URL/date; require confirmation for sensitive claims.
AI inferred	Entity match, category, attribute, compatibility, duplicate, demand forecast and risk flag.	Confidence score, evaluation set, explainability and human review threshold.

34.3 Data-quality score

Each entity and listing should receive a data-quality score composed of completeness, freshness, provenance strength, verification, consistency and user feedback. Ranking, advertising eligibility and intelligence outputs should depend on this score. The platform should expose understandable status labels such as Verified Location, Stock Confirmed Today, Price Valid Until, Vendor Responds Within Two Hours and Customer-Corrected.

Dimension	Example rule	Platform consequence
Completeness	Required category attributes, location, price logic, contact path and media present.	Lower-quality objects rank below complete alternatives.
Freshness	Confirmation window varies by product velocity and volatility.	Stale items decay, hide or require reconfirmation.
Provenance	Direct merchant or field evidence outranks weak public inference.	Confidence shown internally and in selected user labels.
Consistency	Price, stock and identity agree across branches and recent claims.	Conflicts trigger review rather than silent overwrite.
Trust	Verification and performance support the claim.	Advertising and lead access depend on trust tier.
Feedback	Reports and fulfilled outcomes validate or challenge data.	Quality score updates with abuse-resistant weighting.

35. Intelligence products unavailable through ordinary search

Google can identify pages and places, but Shoppage should answer operational Zimbabwean commerce questions that require fresh structured data, local context and transaction-adjacent evidence.

35.1 Shopper intelligence

- Where can I find this exact model or compatible substitute today, within my travel or delivery radius?
- Which verified seller has recently confirmed stock, responds quickly and accepts my preferred payment method?
- What is the realistic local price range, how recently were prices confirmed and what explains the difference?
- Which bundle, size, grade or variant is appropriate for my use case and budget?
- Can I collect today, reserve, request delivery, ask for installation or obtain multiple quotes?
- Which nearby market has the highest concentration of the products I need so I can minimise travel?
- What locally manufactured or locally supplied alternative can replace an imported product?

35.2 Merchant intelligence

- What are buyers searching for in my area that I do not currently stock?
- Which of my products are viewed but not generating contact, and what content, price, trust or availability problem may explain the gap?

- Which suburbs, market clusters and delivery areas are producing profitable demand?
- Which product variants are under-supplied, overpriced, frequently requested or commonly substituted?
- How does my response speed, freshness, catalogue quality and conversion compare with anonymised category benchmarks?
- What should I promote today, what budget is justified and which creator or market is most relevant?
- Which customers or leads require follow-up without exposing private data to unrelated advertisers?

35.3 Market, brand and national intelligence

User	Intelligence product	Commercial/public value
Market manager	Footfall proxies, category gaps, tenant visibility, event performance and member responsiveness.	Improves the market as a destination and sells measurable sponsorship.
Distributor / brand	Demand heatmap, price bands, stock gaps, reseller activity, creator performance and campaign lift.	Improves allocation, sales activation and local advertising.
Financial partner	Consented merchant activity indicators, catalogue stability and demand evidence.	Supports better merchant services without claiming creditworthiness from unvalidated data.
Development institution	MSME digitisation, category participation, provincial coverage and capability gaps.	Targets programmes and measures outcomes.
Public authority	Aggregated market coverage, local-industry visibility and service gaps.	Supports planning while prohibiting individual surveillance or political profiling.

35.4 Shoppage Intelligence product line

- Shoppage Ask: Natural-language buyer assistant grounded only in graph evidence, with sources, confidence and direct actions.
- Price Pulse: Local price ranges, movement, confirmation dates and alerts; not a claim that every seller is comparable.
- Stock Truth: Recently confirmed availability, probability of availability and rapid merchant confirmation requests.
- Demand Radar: Merchant view of searches, requests and unmet demand by category and coarse location.
- Market Lens: Market-level supply, content, demand, trust, response and campaign intelligence.
- Brand Lens: Distributor and brand dashboard for reseller coverage, stock gaps and attributed activation.
- Business Improvement Copilot: Prioritised weekly recommendations tied to measurable merchant outcomes.
- Zimbabwe Commerce Observatory: Privacy-safe aggregate reports on digitisation, local supply and market activity, released with methodology.

Intelligence boundary

Shoppage should be comprehensive about commerce, not intrusive about citizens. It must not build political profiles, sell sensitive personal data, infer protected characteristics for advertising or make high-stakes eligibility decisions from opaque behavioural signals.

36. International product and service quality standard

A Zimbabwe-first platform must meet global platform expectations while adapting to data cost, addressing, currency, trust and informal-commerce realities. Local relevance is an additional standard, not permission for poor execution.

Quality domain	Required standard	Evidence
Performance	Fast first load on common mid-range Android devices; compressed media; low-data mode; resilient caching.	Track p50/p75/p95 load and interaction latency by network class.
Reliability	Graceful failure, retries, idempotent writes, backups, disaster recovery and operational alerts.	Define service objectives and publish internal incident reviews.
Search quality	Typo tolerance, synonyms, local names, structured facets, semantic matching and geo relevance.	Curated query set and weekly relevance evaluation.
Design quality	Consistent design system, clear hierarchy, one-handed mobile actions and high-quality merchant surfaces.	Design review and usability testing before release.
Accessibility	WCAG-aligned contrast, keyboard use, labels, captions, readable text and reduced motion.	Automated and manual accessibility checks.
Safety and trust	Visible sponsored labels, verification, reports, appeals, audit logs and prohibited-category controls.	Trust operations tested before growth campaigns.
Privacy and security	Least privilege, tenant isolation, encryption, consent, retention, deletion and incident response.	Security review, logs and privacy-impact assessment.
Support	Merchant onboarding, in-product help, WhatsApp support path, escalation and response targets.	Measure first response and issue resolution.
Content quality	Structured product data, rights management, captions, moderation and duplicate control.	Publishing score and enforcement rules.
Internationalisation	Currency, language, date, measurement, country and tax abstractions.	Zimbabwe configuration first; no hard-coded country assumptions.

36.1 Global benchmark, Zimbabwe adaptation

Global capability	Shoppage adaptation	Competitive benefit
Local inventory search	Branch-level availability, market/stall location, price validity and confirmation request.	More operationally useful for Zimbabwean buying conditions.
Shoppable short video	Every clip tied to structured products, location, stock and local action.	Entertainment reach becomes measurable local commerce.
Affiliate commerce	Lead, quote, visit and later sale attribution, not only card checkout.	Works before all transactions are digitally closed.
Business profiles and maps	Actual products, service areas, market membership and trust history.	Commercial map rather than static place directory.
Advertising manager	Fixed local packages, assisted campaigns, outcome reporting and creator activation.	Accessible to merchants who find global ad tools complex.
AI shopping assistant	Grounded in verified local graph with evidence and confidence.	Answers local availability and suitability, not generic web text.

37. Continuous competitor matching and improvement system

Shoppage must be organised to absorb useful competitor features without destabilising the platform or losing its Zimbabwean advantage. This requires an operating system for improvement, not founder-driven feature reactions.

37.1 Product architecture for rapid improvement

- One canonical commerce data model shared across Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators and Markets.
- Modular monolith boundaries with explicit contracts so a domain can later be extracted without rewriting the platform.
- API-first business logic and versioned contracts for web, mobile, partner and AI interfaces.
- Design tokens and reusable components so global-quality interface improvements propagate consistently.
- Feature flags by user, merchant, category, city and market so experiments can be reversed safely.
- Event instrumentation defined before feature release, with dashboards linked to a decision hypothesis.
- Provider adapters for search, AI, messaging, payments, maps, storage and video to limit lock-in.
- Automated tests, migrations, security checks, preview environments and controlled releases for AI-assisted development.

37.2 Competitor intelligence cadence

Cadence	Activity	Output
Weekly	Review local platforms, social-commerce behaviour, support tickets and lost deals.	Top five friction points and immediate fixes.
Monthly	Structured benchmark of Facebook, Google, TikTok, YouTube, marketplaces and African commerce platforms.	Capability gap matrix, adoption evidence and build/buy/ignore decision.
Quarterly	Merchant, creator, buyer and market councils review roadmap and pricing.	Validated priorities and policy changes.
Six-monthly	Architecture, data, security and product-quality review against expansion plan.	Investment plan and technical-debt budget.

37.3 Feature decision rule

A competitor feature should be copied only when it solves a verified Shoppage job, can be operated safely, strengthens the graph or revenue, and has a measurable adoption path. Novelty alone is not a priority. A feature that increases entertainment time but produces no commerce value should not outrank search quality, freshness, trust or merchant response.

38. AI-native platform and operating model

AI should be distributed through the product and company rather than isolated in one assistant. The first objective is to lower the cost of building and maintaining the commerce graph; the second is to improve matching, decisions, content and operations.

38.1 AI capability stack

AI layer	Primary use	Required control
Ingestion AI	Extract products, variants, prices, contacts and locations from merchant photos, spreadsheets, PDFs, voice notes and public content.	Human confirmation before material claims publish.
Entity resolution	Match duplicate businesses, branches, products, brands and aliases.	Confidence threshold, merge review and reversible history.
Catalogue intelligence	Category, attributes, compatibility, alternatives, bundles, missing fields and quality scoring.	Category-specific evaluation sets.
Search and matching	Semantic retrieval, local synonyms, intent classification and RFQ-to-vendor matching.	Relevance tests and no silent exclusion of valid small vendors.
Content copilot	Descriptions, captions, price overlays, translation, thumbnails and campaign variants.	Rights, factuality and prohibited-claim checks.

AI layer	Primary use	Required control
Merchant copilot	Weekly actions for catalogue, pricing, stock, leads, campaigns and creator selection.	Recommendation evidence and merchant control.
Buyer assistant	Grounded answers, comparisons and action plans based on verified graph data.	Sources, freshness and uncertainty visible.
Trust AI	Duplicate images, suspicious prices, spam, prohibited goods, fake leads and abnormal behaviour.	Human appeal and bias/error monitoring.
Operations AI	Support triage, moderation queues, data-quality prioritisation and field-agent routes.	Audit logs and service-level monitoring.
Forecasting AI	Demand, stock gaps, campaign yield and market opportunities after sufficient data accumulates.	Backtesting and conservative use before automation.

38.2 AI-assisted development without fragile software

- AI may generate code, tests, schemas, migrations, documentation and UI variants, but a human owner approves architecture and production changes.
- Use typed contracts, linting, automated tests, security scanning, database migration review and preview deployments as mandatory gates.
- Keep business rules in explicit services and policies rather than hidden prompts. Prompts are versioned artefacts with owners and evaluation results.
- No direct production database changes by coding agents. All changes pass through migrations, review and backup validation.
- Use retrieval and tool calling against the commerce graph; do not let models invent prices, stock, verification or merchant claims.
- Maintain provider portability and cost ceilings. Expensive models should be reserved for tasks where cheaper models or deterministic rules fail.

38.3 Model evaluation programme

Evaluation	Minimum test	Release gate
Extraction	Representative Zimbabwean merchant images, posts, spreadsheets and voice transcripts.	Accuracy by required field and safe fallback.
Search	High-frequency, misspelled, local-name and location queries.	Relevance improvement without material trust degradation.
Matching	Buyer requests mapped to eligible vendors.	Coverage, precision, response and fairness across merchant size.
Moderation	Known scams, prohibited categories, legitimate edge cases and local language.	Acceptable false-positive/negative rates and appeal path.
Recommendations	Historical or controlled tests for merchant and buyer actions.	Measured outcome lift, not engagement alone.
Assistant	Grounded questions with stale, conflicting and missing evidence.	Correct uncertainty, evidence links and no fabricated facts.

39. Investor-proof company architecture

Long-term investors need proof that Shoppage can become a large, defensible company without depending on endless subsidies, political access or a single transaction model.

39.1 Investment thesis

- Large fragmented market: commerce exists across formal retail, informal trade, markets, services, social channels and diaspora demand, but the information and advertising layers are fragmented.
- Capital-efficient wedge: Shoppage creates value from discovery, leads, advertising, content and merchant tools before carrying inventory or owning logistics.
- Multiple reinforcing revenue lines: subscriptions, managed digitisation, local ads, leads, creator campaigns, market programmes, intelligence and later transaction services.
- Proprietary compounding asset: the verified commerce graph becomes more valuable as supply, demand, trust and outcomes accumulate.
- Expansion logic: the platform can expand by city, category and country using the same core architecture while maintaining local taxonomies and operating partners.
- National-value alignment: merchant digitisation, creator income, local ad retention and local-industry visibility can attract institutional partnerships without becoming government-dependent.

39.2 Investor proof milestones

Proof area	Month 3 threshold	Month 6 threshold
Supply	Dense launch categories, verified merchants, fresh products and active market pages.	Second-city replication with controlled onboarding cost.
Demand	Repeat searches, requests, saves and merchant contact with good response.	Cohort retention and growing organic/direct traffic.
Revenue	Paid onboarding, managed campaigns, first subscriptions and repeat advertisers.	Predictable monthly revenue mix and improving gross margin.
Moat	Canonical graph, provenance, freshness, trust and creator attribution functioning.	Unique demand reports and measurable data-quality improvement.
Unit economics	Known merchant activation cost and lead/campaign delivery cost.	Improving payback, revenue per active merchant and support efficiency.
Governance	Policies, financial controls, data register, contracts and decision rights.	Board reporting, risk review and independent assurance plan.
Technology	Stable production system with observability, backups and release controls.	Capacity, security and multi-city scaling evidence.

39.3 Revenue-quality hierarchy

The highest-quality early revenue is repeatable and evidence-linked: recurring merchant plans, repeat advertising, market subscriptions and managed campaigns with improving delivery margin. Onboarding services are valuable for adoption and cash flow but should become standardised. Lead fees and commissions require auditable definitions. Data products must be aggregate, lawful and methodologically credible. Grants or public programmes may accelerate inclusion but should not mask weak commercial demand.

39.4 Investor risk controls

- No national launch before category-city density and operational trust are proven.
- No large fixed logistics fleet during the first six months; integrate partners and collection networks.
- No broad checkout obligation before repeated remote-buying demand and dispute capability exist.
- No exclusive political or institutional dependency that compromises neutrality or commercial decisions.
- No unsupported “AI valuation” narrative; report AI cost savings, quality lift and adoption using operational evidence.
- No unbounded media cost; enforce video duration, encoding, retention and unit-cost telemetry.
- No single cloud, payment, mapping or AI provider embedded without an adapter and documented migration path.

40. Existing-player analysis and outclass strategy

Shoppage should respect existing platforms and analyse their strengths accurately. The objective is not to claim that competitors have no value; it is to build a broader and more operationally useful Zimbabwean commerce system.

Player	Strength to respect	Shoppage outclass position
Facebook / Marketplace / groups	Mass reach, existing identities, social proof, informal sharing and seller familiarity.	Structured catalogues, canonical products, freshness, verified locations, local search, demand routing, merchant analytics and local ad-value capture.
WhatsApp / Status	Direct communication, trust through existing contacts and low learning barrier.	Persistent discovery, shared catalogues, lead structure, attribution, reminders and cross-vendor comparison while retaining WhatsApp hand-off.
Google Search / Maps / Shopping	Broad discovery, mapping, web index and mature advertising.	Deeper Zimbabwean product/variant/availability intelligence, market/stall mapping, local actions and informal-commerce coverage.
Classifieds.co.zw	Established categories, free-ad workflow, suburb selection and broad vertical coverage.	Persistent verified merchant nodes, branch inventory, short video, buyer requests, creator attribution, markets, intelligence and merchant operating tools.
Ownai	Broad retail categories, cart, comparison, seller access and adjacent services such as airtime, bills and tickets.	Open commerce graph across more merchant types, geolocal market discovery, content commerce, local ads, RFQ, creator and intelligence layers.
Shop@Zim	Local multi-vendor positioning, verified-supplier claim, quote flow, product categories and local/export orientation.	Greater buyer frequency, geo, videos, demand data, market networks, merchant workflows, creator distribution and measurable advertising.
Emerging local marketplaces	Local focus, category niches, entrepreneurial speed and potential communities.	Shared infrastructure depth, trust history, data quality, market density, APIs and institutional partnerships.
TikTok / YouTube Shorts	Highly engaging video, creator reach and content tools.	Commerce-only relevance, product/stock/location grounding, local lead attribution and Zimbabwe creator monetisation.

40.1 What Shoppage must never do

- Compete with Facebook by attempting to recreate a full friends-and-family social network.
- Compete with Google by indexing the entire open web instead of owning local commercial depth.
- Compete with WhatsApp by forcing all conversation into a new messenger.
- Compete with established marketplaces only through more categories and copied storefront templates.
- Use vague “verified” badges with no published verification scope.
- Claim every product is available merely because a listing exists.
- Promise national coverage while operating only an unverified Harare catalogue.

40.2 Positioning statement

Competitive position

Facebook knows who people know. Google knows what the public web says. Classifieds know what advertisers posted. Conventional marketplaces know what is listed for sale. Shoppage must know what Zimbabwean commerce can actually provide, where, in which variant, under which conditions, with what trust and in response to which unmet need.

41. Daily utility and responsible habit formation

Shoppage should become a frequent-use product because it saves money, time and uncertainty. The goal is voluntary habit based on recurring utility, not addiction through infinite-scroll manipulation or deceptive notifications.

41.1 Daily consumer reasons to return

- Nearby deals and newly confirmed stock matched to saved interests.
- Price-drop and back-in-stock alerts with clear confirmation dates.
- Saved searches and open buyer requests receiving new vendor matches.
- Short commerce videos from followed categories, creators, vendors and markets.
- Market events, new arrivals, operating changes and category spotlights.
- Household, building, school or business shopping lists with local sourcing progress.
- Reliable “open now”, collection and delivery information before travel.
- Local substitution suggestions when an imported or exact item is unavailable.
- Rewards for useful actions such as verified corrections, fulfilled-request confirmation and referrals, subject to anti-abuse controls.

41.2 Daily merchant reasons to return

- Confirm stock and prices in a rapid daily queue.
- Respond to leads and buyer requests before competitors.
- See demand changes and recommended products to promote.
- Publish one short product clip and distribute it to Shoppage plus external channels.
- Monitor campaign spend, creator activity and attributed outcomes.
- Follow up on saved leads and repeat customers with consented contact context.
- Receive a prioritised “three actions today” merchant copilot instead of a complex analytics dashboard.

41.3 Responsible engagement rules

Rule	Implementation	Prohibited pattern
User control	Granular notification topics, frequency and quiet times.	Forced alerts or difficult unsubscribe.
Finite value	Feeds can surface “you are up to date” and purposeful next actions.	Endless low-value autoplay designed only for time spent.
Transparent ranking	Explain sponsored, nearby, fresh and recommended signals.	Hidden pay-to-rank presented as neutral.
Outcome metrics	Optimise fulfilled needs, leads, saves and return utility.	Optimising emotional arousal or compulsive refresh.
Youth safety	Age-aware content and restricted categories.	Targeting minors with manipulative commercial pressure.
Privacy	Use consented first-party preferences and coarse location where possible.	Sensitive inference or cross-context surveillance.

42. Twenty-four additional strategic product ideas

The following ideas strengthen daily utility, data depth, inclusion, defensibility and revenue. They should be prioritised by the roadmap gates rather than launched simultaneously.

1. Shoppage Ask / Request Network

A buyer describes the need, budget, location and urgency; Shoppage structures the request and routes it to qualified vendors.

Strategic value: Creates demand data and works where catalogues are incomplete.

2. Price Pulse

Confirmed price ranges, alerts and explanations by variant, place and date.

Strategic value: Creates a trusted local reference without pretending all offers are identical.

3. Stock Truth

Availability confidence, last confirmation and one-tap merchant reconfirmation.

Strategic value: Makes freshness visible and turns uncertainty into a workflow.

4. Compatibility Graph

Maps parts, accessories, sizes, devices, vehicles, systems and substitutes.

Strategic value: High-value intelligence for auto, electronics, solar and hardware.

5. Merchant Reputation Passport

Portable Shoppage history of verification, response and fulfilled outcomes.

Strategic value: Rewards good operators and creates time-based switching value.

6. Verified Collection Network

Approved shops, market desks or partner points for collection and identity checks.

Strategic value: Improves trust without owning a national fleet.

7. Market Captain Programme

Trained operators digitise a market, maintain rosters, verify changes and sell campaigns.

Strategic value: Creates local operations and a scalable distribution network.

8. Field Agent Micro-franchise

Agents earn from onboarding, verification, content capture and catalogue maintenance.

Strategic value: Extends reach beyond self-service merchants.

9. Universal ShopPage Link and QR

One link/QR resolves to live catalogue, location, contacts, videos and offers.

Strategic value: Makes Shoppage the merchant identity shared everywhere.

10. WhatsApp and Voice Ingestion

Merchants send a photo, voice note or price list; AI drafts structured updates for confirmation.

Strategic value: Matches existing behaviour and reduces dashboard friction.

11. Low-data and Assisted Access

Text-first mode, compressed media, agent-assisted onboarding and optional messaging notifications.

Strategic value: Improves inclusion under connectivity constraints.

12. Diaspora Purchase Concierge

Verified local quotes, recipient confirmation, proof of collection/delivery and dispute support.

Strategic value: Captures high-value remote demand without immediate full marketplace complexity.

13. B2B Procurement Exchange

Businesses and institutions request quotes, compare verified suppliers and preserve audit trails.

Shoppage - Zimbabwe National Commerce Media Infrastructure

Strategic value: Creates valuable demand and supplier intelligence.

14. Made in Zimbabwe Discovery

Dedicated local-manufacturer, producer and artisan graph with substitution and distribution tools.

Strategic value: Supports local industry and national-value positioning.

15. Local Substitution Engine

Recommends locally available alternatives when exact/imported items are unavailable.

Strategic value: Reduces failed searches and exposes domestic capability.

16. Proof-backed Reviews

Reviews linked where possible to a verified lead, visit, reservation or fulfilment event.

Strategic value: Higher trust than unrestricted anonymous ratings.

17. Live Commerce Rooms

Scheduled vendor/creator demonstrations with tagged products and moderated questions.

Strategic value: Combines content, trust and concentrated campaign demand.

18. Commerce Academy

Short practical lessons and capability scoring for product data, response, video, pricing, trust and ads.

Strategic value: Improves merchant performance and creates certification signals.

19. Business Improvement Score

Private diagnostic with recommended actions and benchmark ranges.

Strategic value: Turns intelligence into measurable merchant development.

20. Open Partner APIs

Controlled APIs for banks, distributors, logistics, malls, POS systems, agencies and public programmes.

Strategic value: Embeds Shoppage in external workflows and increases switching cost.

21. Shoppage Ad Credits

Prepaid promotional balance, vouchers and partner-sponsored merchant activation, without becoming a deposit-taking wallet.

Strategic value: Simplifies small campaign purchases and institutional programmes.

22. Demand Bounties

Brands or markets sponsor rewards for creators and agents who fulfil verified catalogue or content gaps.

Strategic value: Directs ecosystem effort to valuable missing data.

23. Community Correction Network

Users report closed stores, wrong prices or moved stalls; trusted corrections earn recognition or limited rewards.

Strategic value: Improves the graph while using anti-abuse review.

24. Commerce Continuity View

During shortages, outages or emergencies, surface verified essential availability, delivery changes and open suppliers.

Strategic value: Creates legitimate public utility and resilience.

43. Practical 0-3 month implementation upgrade

A three-month launch is feasible only as a tightly controlled city-category implementation. “Fully functional” means each layer completes its core job end to end, the graph and trust systems are real, and the operating team can maintain the service. It does not mean nationwide exhaustive coverage or every long-term idea.

43.1 Version 1 scope lock

In scope by week 12	Deliberately constrained	Deferred
Shoppage Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators and Markets complete their primary workflows.	Harare-first; Home, Power and Building; curated merchants and markets.	National breadth, general social network and broad entertainment.
Canonical business/place/product graph with provenance, freshness and verification.	Thousands of high-quality products rather than millions of scraped records.	Fully automated universal ingestion without confirmation.
Search, geo, short clips, RFQ, leads, creator attribution, campaigns and reporting.	Simple objectives and fixed ad packages alongside managed campaigns.	Complex auction, external ad network and advanced attribution.
AI ingestion, normalisation, grounded ask, matching, moderation assistance and merchant recommendations.	Human review for material claims and high-risk decisions.	Autonomous pricing, credit or enforcement decisions.
Operational support, complaints, audits, backups, metrics and field workflows.	Partner delivery/collection and payment links where suitable.	Owned national logistics, escrow and full multi-vendor settlement.

43.2 Week-by-week build and operating plan

Period	Delivery definition
Weeks 0-1: decisions and controls	Freeze category/city scope; appoint product/engineering/operations owners; finalise data model, verification, policies, analytics events, brand and architecture; recruit anchor merchants and market partners.
Week 2: foundation	Deploy auth, organisations, roles, stores, branches, geo, catalogue, media, audit, feature flags, observability, backups and CI/CD; launch the field register and canonical ID rules.
Weeks 3-4: Central and graph	Mobile merchant onboarding; product/variant ingestion; price and stock; freshness; provenance; verification; rapid daily actions; assisted onboarding; first 30-50 active merchants.
Weeks 5-6: Showcase and demand	Search, facets, geo, product/store/market pages, low-data short clips, saves, WhatsApp/call/directions, buyer requests and vendor routing; buyer usability tests.
Weeks 7-8: Ads, creators and markets	Fixed promotion packages, campaign review, sponsored labels and reporting; creator profiles, tagged links and lead attribution; market rosters, combined feeds, QR assets and captain workflow.
Weeks 9-10: intelligence, trust and AI	Grounded Shoppage Ask beta; demand radar; quality scores; entity resolution; moderation queues; complaints/appeals; merchant action recommendations; load and security testing.
Weeks 11-12: controlled launch	Populate dense supply; run creator and market campaigns; test billing and support; validate response and freshness; launch to selected public cohorts; publish transparent metrics and issue log.

43.3 Minimum launch team

Function	Minimum accountable capacity	Critical responsibility
Product / programme	1 senior owner plus business founder decisions.	Scope, user value, roadmap and cross-team decisions.
Engineering	1 senior full-stack/architect, 2-4 product engineers, part-time DevOps/security.	Reliable platform, data model, integrations and release controls.

Function	Minimum accountable capacity	Critical responsibility
Design / research	1 strong product designer with field-testing capability.	International-quality mobile experience and usability.
Data / AI	1 applied AI/data engineer or strong shared capability.	Ingestion, entity resolution, search, evaluation and intelligence.
Merchant operations	1 lead plus 3-8 agents/captains depending target supply.	Onboarding, verification, freshness and support.
Trust / support	Named owner plus trained operational coverage.	Complaints, moderation, appeals and service response.
Commercial	Founder/commercial lead plus campaign operator.	Anchor merchants, markets, ads, creators and partners.

43.4 Week-12 launch gates

Gate	Minimum evidence	Consequence if missed
Data quality	Target catalogue completeness, provenance and freshness achieved in launch categories.	Delay broad acquisition and fix onboarding/data operations.
Buyer utility	Search/RFQ users find relevant vendors and take meaningful actions.	Narrow taxonomy, improve ranking and increase supply density.
Merchant value	Merchants respond, update stock and recognise attributable leads.	Simplify daily workflow and strengthen success operations.
Ad value	At least several advertisers pay and can interpret outcomes.	Prioritise managed packages before self-service scale.
Trust	Verification, reports, complaints and appeals work in live drills.	Do not scale public promotion.
Reliability	Production monitoring, backup restore, security checks and support coverage pass.	Hold launch until defects are resolved.

44. Months 4-6 expansion and compounding plan

Expansion should deepen the moat before increasing geographic and category breadth. The company must prove that the launch system can be repeated without a proportional increase in manual effort.

Expansion stream	Months 4-5	Month 6 proof
Geography	Replicate playbook in Bulawayo or the strongest evidence-backed second cluster.	Comparable activation, freshness and buyer response at controlled cost.
Categories	Add one high-value category such as phones/electronics or auto spares after taxonomy review.	Compatibility, fraud and data-quality controls work.
Intelligence	Expand Price Pulse, Demand Radar, Market Lens and merchant copilot.	Users act on intelligence and selected reports support revenue.
Ads	Improve self-service, saved audiences, creator briefs and brand dashboards.	Repeat spend, better outcome yield and manageable support.
Creators	Introduce tiers, briefs marketplace, content quality and limited automated commissions.	Repeat creator earnings and fraud-controlled attribution.
Markets	Standardised captain kit, dashboards and sponsorship products.	10-25 useful active market pages with maintained data.
Transactions	Reservations, deposits, payment links and proof of fulfilment in selected flows.	Disputes controlled and economics understood.
APIs	Pilot distributor, logistics, POS, market or financial-partner integration.	Reliable refresh SLA and mutual commercial value.

Expansion stream	Months 4-5	Month 6 proof
Governance	Board/advisory reporting, data review, transparency metrics and investor data room.	Investment readiness supported by evidence rather than narrative.

44.1 Expansion rule

Scale rule

No city, category or major feature expands merely because development is possible. Expansion requires a local supply owner, data-maintenance plan, trust controls, buyer-acquisition route, revenue hypothesis and measurable stop condition.

45. National legitimacy, endorsement and public-value safeguards

A platform capable of national endorsement must be demonstrably useful, neutral, lawful and professionally governed. Presidential endorsement may be valuable, but the model must remain viable without it and must never imply access to private citizen commerce data.

45.1 Public-value case

- Improve discoverability and digital capability for MSMEs, informal traders, markets, manufacturers and service providers.
- Retain a greater share of advertising, campaign work, creator income and commercial data value in Zimbabwe.
- Create youth income in onboarding, content, market digitisation, support, data quality and software operations.
- Give consumers more reliable product, place, price, trust and availability information.
- Increase visibility of locally manufactured goods and substitution opportunities.
- Produce transparent aggregate evidence on commercial digitisation and market gaps.

45.2 Non-partisan and rights safeguards

- No political advertising during the initial operating period; any future policy requires separate legal, safety and governance review.
- No government, party or sponsor receives privileged access to personal search, purchasing, location or merchant-performance data.
- Public-sector dashboards use minimum necessary aggregation, suppression and documented methodology.
- Commercial ranking remains governed by published relevance, quality, trust and sponsored-placement rules.
- Endorsement, partnership or grant relationships are disclosed and do not confer ownership of user data.
- Complaints, delisting and verification decisions include evidence, audit history and appeal where appropriate.

45.3 Endorsement-readiness evidence pack

Component	Required evidence	Independent check
100-day impact brief	Active merchants, fresh products, buyers, leads, campaign spend and jobs/earnings.	Auditable definitions and sample validation.
National demonstration	End-to-end merchant, buyer, creator and market workflows.	Live production data with privacy protection.
Governance file	Policies, company control, data map, legal review, audits and incident process.	External legal/security review.

Component	Required evidence	Independent check
Economic-value case	Local ad retention, merchant outcomes, creator payouts and local-industry visibility.	Financial records and methodology.
Inclusion case	Informal/formal mix, women/youth participation, provincial plan and low-data access.	Disaggregated but privacy-safe metrics.

46. Organisational model, talent and operating cadence

Shoppage's competitive advantage must exist in the company, not only in the product. A national commerce intelligence platform requires disciplined product development, field execution, data governance, trust operations and commercial delivery.

46.1 Core operating units

Unit	Mandate	Primary output
Product and engineering	Build reliable shared platform and user workflows.	Frequent, safe product improvements.
Commerce graph and AI	Taxonomy, entity resolution, data quality, search, models and intelligence.	Trusted proprietary graph and recommendations.
Merchant success and field network	Onboarding, verification, freshness and workflow adoption.	Active high-quality supply.
Demand and growth	Buyer acquisition, lifecycle, referrals, content distribution and market activation.	Repeat qualified demand.
Ads and commercial	Campaigns, plans, creators, markets, brands and partners.	Repeat revenue and attributable outcomes.
Trust, support and compliance	Moderation, complaints, appeals, privacy, security and policies.	Safe, legitimate platform operation.
Finance and governance	Cash, controls, contracts, reporting, board and investor readiness.	Capital discipline and accountability.

46.2 Operating cadence

Cadence	Meeting / artefact	Decision
Daily	Launch operations dashboard and incident/quality queue.	Freshness, support, trust and campaign intervention.
Weekly	Product-commercial-operating review.	Priorities, experiments, merchant/demand issues and cash.
Fortnightly	Release review and architecture/data-quality gate.	Ship, hold, roll back or retire features.
Monthly	Unit economics, cohort, competitor and risk review.	Resource allocation and roadmap changes.
Quarterly	Board/advisory and public-value review.	Strategy, governance, funding and expansion.

47. Strategic KPI and proof framework

The executive dashboard must measure whether Shoppage is becoming more useful, more defensible and more investable. Registration, total listings and video views are supporting metrics, not the definition of success.

Dimension	Core measures	Question answered
Graph depth	Verified active businesses/places; canonical products/variants; coverage by category/area; provenance strength.	Is the asset difficult to reproduce?
Freshness and truth	Share confirmed within policy; correction rate; price validity; stock-confirmation response.	Can users trust operational facts?
Buyer utility	Successful search rate; search-to-action; RFQ match and response; repeat use; fulfilled need reports.	Does Shoppage save time or money?
Merchant utility	Weekly active merchants; stock/price actions; lead response; retained cohorts; revenue lift evidence.	Is Shoppage embedded in operations?
Daily habit	Useful returning users; alert action; saved-need resolution; market/category repeat.	Is frequency based on value?
Ads	Repeat advertisers; spend; outcome rate; cost per qualified action; merchant interpretation of reports.	Can local advertising compete for budget?
Creators	Active quality creators; attributed actions; repeat earnings; fraud/dispute rate.	Does distribution compound?
Markets	Active markets, maintained vendors, QR traffic, events, sponsor revenue and market-level demand.	Does market-in-market work?
Economics	MRR, revenue mix, gross margin, activation cost, payback, revenue per active merchant and burn.	Is growth financeable?
Quality	Performance, uptime, error, support, accessibility, security and incident metrics.	Does execution meet international standards?
AI	Cost per task, accuracy, human correction, outcome lift and failure/appeal rates.	Is AI operationally valuable and safe?
National value	MSME digitisation, local campaign value, creator/agent earnings, local products and geographic reach.	Is endorsement supported by evidence?

47.1 North-star metric

Recommended north star

Verified Commerce Outcomes: the number of buyer needs that reach a qualified, responsive merchant and result in a confirmed useful outcome - contact, quote, reservation, visit, collection, delivery or purchase - with attribution and trust controls. This combines demand, supply quality and practical value better than traffic alone.

48. Final non-negotiable decision statement

Shoppage must be built as Zimbabwe's commerce intelligence and activation infrastructure, not as another catalogue website. The public product is the visible layer; the durable company is the commerce graph, merchant operating system, trust history, demand engine, creator and market distribution network, advertising outcomes and continuous-learning capability beneath it.

The platform should be capable of answering commercial questions that ordinary web search cannot answer reliably: exact local availability, variant compatibility, current conditions, trusted alternatives, market concentration, response capability, unmet demand and practical improvement opportunities. It must present those answers with evidence, freshness and uncertainty rather than false certainty.

Global quality is mandatory. The interface, speed, reliability, search, accessibility, security, content, support and analytics must be credible against international platforms. Zimbabwe-specific constraints should shape the solution - low-data operation, manual location, assisted onboarding, WhatsApp hand-off, multiple payment methods and field verification - without lowering the standard.

The three-month objective is a fully functioning, dense Harare launch system across all five layers with the core intelligence graph, trust, ads, creators and markets working. Months four to six deepen intelligence, repeat revenue, second-city replication and selected transaction support. National breadth follows evidence, not ambition alone.

Board-level instruction

Approve no initiative that does not strengthen verified commerce utility, proprietary intelligence, trusted outcomes, revenue quality or scalable operating capability. Competitors may copy appearance. Shoppage must make the underlying Zimbabwean commerce system too deep, fresh, connected and useful to copy overnight.

Appendix F. Commerce graph entities and intelligence claims

This appendix is a minimum modelling checklist for engineering and data governance. Each item requires a canonical ID, lifecycle, ownership, provenance and access policy.

Domain	Minimum entities	Critical claim types
Geography	Country, province, district, city, suburb, growth point, route, landmark, market, building, stall, geo zone.	Located at, contains, serves, delivers to, open at, access condition.
Organisation	Legal entity, trading name, informal seller, association, brand, distributor, manufacturer, market operator.	Owns, operates, distributes, manufactures, member of, verified as.
Commerce location	Store, branch, stall, warehouse, pickup point, service base.	Located at, hours, payment accepted, collection, delivery, accessibility.
Catalogue	Category, product family, product, variant, attribute, brand, model, bundle, alternative.	Has attribute, compatible with, substitute for, sold by, available at.
Offer	Price, currency, validity, promotion, minimum order, stock state, lead time and terms.	Price claimed, confirmed, expired, available, made to order.
Content	Image, video, document, caption, collection, creator post and rights record.	Depicts, promotes, explains, sponsored by, authorised by.
Demand	Search, saved need, request, quote, comparison, shortage and urgency.	Wants, located near, budget, deadline, matched to, unresolved.
Trust	Verification, evidence, complaint, review, correction, response, fulfilment and appeal.	Verified scope, reported, resolved, responded, fulfilled.
Commercial	Lead, campaign, placement, attribution, creator agreement, commission and invoice.	Generated by, sponsored, attributed to, payable, disputed.
Improvement	Gap, recommendation, task, benchmark and measured result.	Needs improvement, expected impact, accepted, completed, outcome.

Appendix G. AI evaluation and safety gates

AI release quality must be measured against real Zimbabwean commerce data and user impact.

Gate	Required artefact	Owner decision
Use-case approval	Problem, user, benefit, risk, non-AI fallback and cost ceiling.	Build, buy, test or reject.
Data approval	Source rights, consent, sensitive-data review, representation and retention.	Data permitted, restricted or prohibited.
Offline evaluation	Gold dataset, baseline, error analysis and category/location breakdown.	Ready for limited pilot or revise.
Human workflow	Review threshold, override, audit and appeal.	Operationally safe or blocked.
Pilot	Feature flag, cohort, monitoring, user disclosure and rollback.	Expand, hold or stop.

Gate	Required artefact	Owner decision
Production monitoring	Accuracy proxy, correction, complaints, cost, latency and drift.	Continue, retrain, narrow or retire.

Appendix H. Competitive benchmark references

The following current public examples support the benchmark design. They should be supplemented by the ongoing 1,000-entity Zimbabwe field and platform register.

1. Classifieds.co.zw - broad categories, free ads, deals and suburb selection - <https://www.classifieds.co.zw/>
2. Ownai Marketplace - broad retail catalogue, cart, comparison, seller access and adjacent services - <https://ownai.co.zw/>
3. Shop@Zim - multi-vendor positioning, verified suppliers, quotes, local products and delivery messaging - <https://shopatzim.co.zw/>
4. Google Merchant Center local inventory ads and local listings - <https://support.google.com/merchants/answer/14615117>
5. YouTube Shopping affiliate programme and tagged product content - <https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/13376398>
6. TikTok Shop affiliate marketing for sellers and creators - <https://seller.tiktokglobalshop.com/business/en/affiliate>
7. Existing Shoppage / Shoppscene consolidated business and technology baseline - Local project document: Shoppscene Business Model Recap.txt

PART II CONTINUES - OPERATING AND FINANCIAL DEPTH

49. National knowledge acquisition and 1,000-entity execution programme

Shoppage cannot become aware of Zimbabwean commerce through desk research alone. The graph must be built through a repeatable national acquisition system that combines merchant self-service, field verification, public-source discovery, partnerships, customer corrections and AI-assisted normalisation. The initial 1,000-entity programme is not a publicity number; it is a controlled learning and coverage instrument.

49.1 Register design

Register object	Minimum sample	Purpose
Businesses and sellers	Formal retailers, informal traders, manufacturers, distributors, service providers and social sellers.	Test identity, onboarding, verification and category coverage.
Places and markets	Malls, CBD clusters, flea markets, industrial areas, growth points and pickup locations.	Test geographies, boundaries, access and market-in-market models.
Products and variants	High-demand items across launch categories, with aliases and compatibility.	Test taxonomy, search, price, availability and substitution.
Facebook and social commerce pages	Merchant pages, groups, creator pages and community administrators.	Understand existing distribution, content, trust and lead behaviour.
Customer needs	Search queries, RFQs, failed searches, saved needs and interviews.	Build real demand language and priority gaps.
Payments, logistics and enabling partners	Gateways, banks, mobile money, couriers, runners, collection points and POS providers.	Map practical conversion and fulfilment options.

Register object	Minimum sample	Purpose
Competitor and adjacent platforms	Marketplaces, directories, media pages, agencies, classifieds and commerce tools.	Maintain grounded benchmark and partnership/competition map.

49.2 Collection channels

- Merchant self-registration with progressive verification and AI-assisted catalogue creation.
- Field-agent and market-captain visits with evidence capture, geolocation and supervisor sampling.
- Public Facebook page, public group and website discovery used to identify entities and draft records, subject to terms, law and merchant confirmation.
- Partner feeds from markets, brands, distributors, payment providers, logistics providers and associations under explicit data agreements.
- Buyer requests and failed searches that create structured demand and expose missing suppliers or variants.
- Community corrections and merchant claims of existing pages, with dispute and ownership verification.
- Import tools for spreadsheets, POS exports, catalogues, product images, PDFs and approved APIs.

49.3 Field protocol

Stage	Agent action	Quality control
Discovery	Identify business/place, category, owner contact and public evidence.	Duplicate check before new ID.
Consent and explanation	Explain Shoppage, data use, public fields, verification and merchant control.	Standard script and consent record.
Identity and location	Capture trading name, business status, branch/stall, landmark and hours.	Evidence photo/document where appropriate; location confidence.
Catalogue sample	Capture priority products, variants, price logic, stock state and media.	Category template and merchant confirmation.
Conversion setup	Verify WhatsApp/call, collection, delivery and payment options.	Test contact path and record limits.
Training	Show daily stock, price, lead and clip actions.	Activation checklist completed by merchant.
Follow-up	Review first leads, freshness and missing fields within seven days.	Supervisor dashboard and dormant-account intervention.

49.4 Coverage scoring

Coverage must be measured by usefulness rather than entity count. A category-area cell is “usable” only when it has enough verified and responsive supply, variant representation, fresh offers and buyer actions to resolve common needs. Management should maintain a coverage matrix by city, area, category and trust tier. Empty cells become acquisition priorities; weak cells trigger market captains, distributor outreach or buyer-request routing rather than fabricated completeness.

50. Layer-by-layer implementation requirements

The five layers must behave as one product system. Each layer has a primary job, a proprietary asset contribution, a revenue role and a week-12 completion test.

Layer	Primary job and moat contribution	Week-12 completion test
Shoppage Central	Turns merchants into structured, verified and active commerce nodes; owns workflow, catalogue, freshness, leads and history.	A merchant can onboard, publish, confirm, respond, promote and understand outcomes from a mobile device.
Shoppage Showcase	Resolves buyer needs through search, geo, short video, pages, saves and requests; produces demand data.	A buyer can find or request a relevant item, judge confidence and reach a qualified vendor without forced registration.

Layer	Primary job and moat contribution	Week-12 completion test
Shoppage Ads	Converts local commercial intent into measurable paid reach; produces advertiser history and outcome data.	A merchant can buy a transparent campaign and see spend plus qualified actions.
Shoppage Creators	Turns local content and influence into attributed commerce; builds distribution and creator earnings.	A creator can select approved products, publish/tag content and track valid outcomes.
Shoppage Markets	Digitises commercial clusters; builds place density, shared discovery and sponsorship inventory.	A market can manage identity, members, map, feed, QR traffic, events and campaigns.

50.1 Shoppage Central detailed release criteria

- Organisation, owner, staff and role model with tenant isolation and complete audit history.
- Business, store, branch, stall, pickup point, hours, location, contact, service area, payment and delivery records.
- Category templates for products, variants, services, prices, currencies, minimum orders, promotions, lead times and stock states.
- Image, short video, document and rights records with compression, moderation and product tagging.
- Freshness queue, bulk confirmation, expiry, customer correction and category-specific policies.
- Lead inbox for WhatsApp, calls, RFQs, creator referrals, market sources and outcomes.
- Merchant copilot with three prioritised actions and evidence, never automatic spend changes.
- Plan, entitlement, invoice, ad credit and managed-service request model.

50.2 Showcase detailed release criteria

- Keyword, typo-tolerant and semantic search with local aliases and category facets.
- Manual and optional GPS location, radius, service area, market and route-based discovery.
- Product, business, branch, market, creator and collection pages with freshness and trust labels.
- Low-data image mode, short-video feed, captions, product tags and finite “up to date” state.
- Saves, comparisons, lists, price/stock alerts and open-now/available-today filters.
- Buyer request with category, description, budget, location, urgency, attachments and consented contact.
- Grounded Shoppage Ask answers with evidence links, confidence and direct next action.

50.3 Ads detailed release criteria

- Objectives: visibility, product view, catalogue visit, WhatsApp/call, RFQ and market visit intent.
- Objects: product, store, branch, video, collection, creator collaboration, market and event.
- Targeting: category, city/area, market, keyword/context, delivery area and selected first-party interest.
- Buying: simple fixed packages, daily/total budget, dates, prepaid credits and managed campaign request.
- Controls: stale-stock block, misleading claim checks, sponsored labels, frequency caps and organic safeguards.
- Reports: reach, view, click, contact, request, response, outcome, spend and cost per qualified action.

50.4 Creators detailed release criteria

- Creator identity, categories, locations, channels, content examples, audience declaration and verification.
- Product/merchant discovery, campaign briefs, sample request, terms, disclosure and content approval.
- Tagged links, QR/codes, attribution windows, lead validation, disputes and earnings ledger.
- Content studio for captions, price/location overlays, product tags, rights and reuse exports.
- Quality tiers based on valid outcomes, content quality, disclosure and dispute history rather than followers alone.

50.5 Markets detailed release criteria

- Market entity, operator, boundary, access, hours, transport/parking notes, contacts and verification.

- Member roster, branch/stall positions, categories, trust, onboarding status and maintenance ownership.
- Combined product/video feed, market search, map, buyer requests, events, offers and announcements.
- QR signage and trackable entrances/sections, sponsor inventory, campaigns and market analytics.
- Market captain queue for new members, moved stalls, hours, closures, disputes and content gaps.

51. Financial architecture and investor scenario logic

The financial model must separate software gross margin, managed-service labour, media delivery cost, field acquisition cost and partner pass-throughs. Revenue growth without this separation can conceal an agency-heavy or infrastructure-heavy business.

51.1 Revenue engines and economic character

Revenue engine	Economic character	Management objective
Merchant plans	Recurring software/service revenue with support and media usage.	Increase retained active merchants and gross margin through standardisation.
Managed onboarding and content	Service revenue that accelerates supply and cash.	Productise packages, train agents and reduce hours per activated merchant.
Shoppage Ads	Usage revenue with media, moderation, sales and support costs.	Drive repeat spend and measurable outcomes; automate only after fit.
Creator campaigns	Campaign/service margin plus optional platform fee or commission.	Increase valid outcome volume while controlling fraud and disputes.
Market subscriptions/sponsorship	Recurring B2B/community revenue with field operations.	Standardise market kit and create shared sponsor inventory.
Qualified leads/RFOs	Outcome-linked revenue where buyer and vendor value is high.	Define valid lead, cap disputes and avoid double charging.
Intelligence products	High-margin aggregate insights and decision tools.	Earn trust through methodology, coverage and privacy safeguards.
Transaction services later	Commission, convenience, protection or fulfilment fee.	Add only where Shoppage materially improves conversion or risk.

51.2 Scenario discipline

The board should maintain conservative, base and ambitious scenarios driven by active merchants, merchant revenue, repeat advertisers, managed-service capacity, creator/market revenue and gross margin. The model should not assume that all registered sellers pay, all ad impressions monetise or all leads become sales. Each scenario must expose cash needs, hiring triggers and the operational work required to achieve the numbers.

Scenario	Core assumption	Required response
Conservative	Slow merchant payment, managed services dominate and buyer growth is gradual.	Protect runway, narrow categories, prioritise outcomes and standardise service delivery.
Base	Strong anchor supply, repeat ads emerge, subscriptions grow after demonstrated leads.	Invest in second-city replication, creator/market systems and data quality.
Ambitious	High organic demand, brands/markets adopt, creator distribution works and intelligence is valued.	Scale infrastructure and leadership without relaxing trust or scope gates.

51.3 Unit economics dashboard

- Cost per verified active merchant, separated into sales, field, data, support and incentives.
- Time and cost to create the first useful catalogue and first shoppable clip.
- Merchant activation-to-first-lead time and percentage receiving value within 14 days.
- Monthly gross revenue and gross contribution per active merchant by revenue type.
- Advertiser first-to-repeat conversion, campaign service hours and media cost.

- Creator valid-action cost, payout ratio, dispute rate and campaign margin.
- Market onboarding cost, member activation, sponsorship revenue and maintenance cost.
- Buyer acquisition source, repeat rate and cost per verified commerce outcome.
- AI cost per extracted item, matched request, moderated object and assistant answer, with human-correction cost.

52. Category and city launch playbook

Each category requires its own taxonomy, freshness, trust, media, search, pricing and conversion logic. Shoppage should not treat a solar inverter, a bag of cement, a plumbing service and a fashion item as equivalent listings.

52.1 Home, Power and Building launch wedge

Subcategory	Key structured intelligence	Primary conversion
Solar and backup power	System size, inverter rating/type, battery chemistry/capacity, panels, warranty, installation, compatibility and lead time.	Advice/RFQ, store visit, installation quote and reservation.
Electrical and plumbing	Brand/model, specifications, dimensions, standards, compatibility, pack and installation availability.	Search, comparison, quote and collection.
Hardware and tools	Tool type, power, size, grade, consumables, rental/sale, warranty and branch stock.	Immediate availability and price-led contact.
Building materials	Grade, dimensions, quantity, minimum order, delivery zone, transport cost logic and price validity.	Bulk RFQ, delivery quote and supplier comparison.
Furniture and appliances	Dimensions, material, colour, condition, energy/power, warranty, made-to-order and delivery.	Video discovery, reservation, store visit and delivery request.
Installation and services	Service area, qualification, capability, evidence, pricing basis, availability and workmanship policy.	Quote and booking request.

52.2 Category readiness checklist

- Named category owner and taxonomy approved with merchant experts.
- Minimum useful supply density by target area and a clear acquisition list.
- Required attributes, aliases, variants, compatibility and substitution rules.
- Freshness window, price volatility and stock-confirmation method.
- Trust risks, prohibited claims, counterfeit/safety issues and verification scope.
- Buyer actions, RFQ structure, expected response time and outcome definition.
- Creator content formats, ad units, benchmarks and likely willingness to pay.
- Media cost, search evaluation set, support guide and dispute playbook.

52.3 City replication checklist

- Local commercial lead and field/market-captain capacity.
- Anchor merchants, market partner and distribution channels secured before public launch.
- Area, suburb, landmark, route and market geography verified.
- Buyer demand evidence and category gap map.
- Local support, verification and complaint response coverage.
- Launch budget, stop conditions and weekly scorecard.

53. Security, privacy, intellectual property and compliance architecture

The intelligence moat has value only if merchants, consumers, creators, partners and investors trust Shoppage to govern it. Security and privacy are product requirements, while intellectual property protection must coexist with user rights, lawful portability and fair merchant treatment.

Control domain	Implementation	Evidence
Tenant and role security	Organisation-scoped records, least privilege, branch roles, admin separation and row-level defence.	Automated access tests, audit logs and periodic review.
Data inventory	Register personal, merchant, public, partner, derived and sensitive data with purpose and retention.	Data map, owners and privacy-impact assessments.
Consent and notices	Layered notices for public profiles, leads, location, messaging, creator attribution and analytics.	Versioned consent and withdrawal records.
Security engineering	Encryption, secrets management, secure coding, dependency scanning, backups and incident response.	Test results, restore drills and incident register.
AI governance	Prompt/model register, source rights, evaluation, human review, appeal and provider data terms.	Model cards and release approvals.
IP and contracts	Trademark, code ownership, employee/contractor assignments, data licences and creator/media rights.	Executed agreements and asset register.
Merchant fairness	Published verification, ranking, advertising, suspension and appeal rules.	Decision logs and policy reports.
Consumer protection	Accurate claims, sponsored labels, pricing clarity, contact identity, complaints and prohibited goods.	Monitoring, resolution targets and enforcement history.
Partner access	Scoped APIs, contracts, rate limits, purpose restriction and termination.	Access logs and periodic partner audit.

54. Product, data and operating service levels

Global quality requires explicit service expectations. Initial targets should be demanding but realistic, then tightened as evidence and infrastructure improve.

Service	Initial target principle	Escalation
Merchant onboarding	Self-service within minutes; assisted activation scheduled promptly; first useful catalogue within agreed package.	Merchant success owner for blocked activation.
Stock/price confirmation	Immediate update; search reflects change within a short operational window.	Queue alert and manual reindex path.
Buyer request routing	Eligible vendors notified quickly; buyer sees match and response status.	Reroute, expand radius or identify unresolved demand.
Merchant response	Category-specific target displayed and measured.	Reminder, ranking effect and success intervention.
Complaint acknowledgement	Prompt acknowledgement with severity triage.	Trust owner and urgent safety escalation.
Ad review	Low-risk trusted campaigns fast; high-risk claims manually reviewed.	Campaign hold with reason and appeal.
Critical incident	Detection, containment, communication and recovery roles pre-assigned.	Executive incident command and post-incident review.
Data correction	Simple corrections rapid; disputed identity or ownership evidence-based.	Case management and appeal.
Support	Published response windows by plan and severity.	Escalation path and customer-visible status.

Final operating reality

Shoppage will not become defensible through AI-generated code alone. The moat is produced by disciplined acquisition, verified data, category expertise, merchant workflow adoption, customer outcomes, trust operations, creator and market distribution, and continuous product execution. AI accelerates each system; it does not replace them.

EXECUTIVE CHARTER FOLLOWS

55. Executive twenty-point commitment and anti-failure charter

This charter converts the full model into decisions that the board, founders, product team and operating leaders can enforce. It should be signed off before implementation and used to reject shortcuts that create a visually impressive but strategically weak platform.

Commitment	Operating interpretation	Board proof
1. Graph before breadth	Build canonical, versioned and evidence-backed commerce entities before opening unlimited listing categories. Every new category must enrich the graph rather than create unstructured volume.	Coverage quality, not raw listings.
2. Freshness before traffic	Do not buy large consumer traffic for catalogue areas that cannot confirm price, stock, location and response. Failed discovery destroys trust faster than advertising can rebuild it.	Freshness and successful-search gates.
3. Outcomes before impressions	Merchant reports and internal growth decisions must prioritise qualified actions and fulfilled needs. Impressions and video views are diagnostic, not the commercial promise.	Verified commerce outcomes.
4. Mobile simplicity before dashboard density	The normal merchant should complete frequent actions on a phone with minimal taps. Complex enterprise controls may exist, but they cannot define the default experience.	Task completion and activation time.
5. Local depth before national claims	Launch where Shoppage can be genuinely useful. Public language must distinguish active verified coverage from aspirational or discovered records.	Coverage map with confidence.
6. Trust before scale	Verification, reporting, appeals, moderation and audit processes must operate before aggressive acquisition. Trust and safety staffing is part of launch cost.	Complaint and resolution performance.
7. AI grounded in evidence	AI may draft, match and recommend, but cannot invent availability, identity, price or verification. User-facing intelligence must show freshness and uncertainty.	Grounding and correction rate.
8. Human accountability	Every automated system has a named owner, review threshold, fallback and rollback. "The model decided" is not an acceptable operational explanation.	Model register and decision logs.
9. Open distribution, owned intelligence	Use Facebook, WhatsApp, search engines, QR codes and partners to acquire and distribute. Preserve Shoppage as the system of record for catalogue, attribution, trust and intelligence.	Direct/organic return and graph growth.

Commitment	Operating interpretation	Board proof
10. Merchant value before subscription pressure	Prove leads, visibility, organisation or intelligence before forcing payment. Monetisation should scale with visible business value and category economics.	Value-to-payment conversion.
11. Local advertising as a product, not a slogan	Shoppage Ads must offer easier local targeting, clearer reporting and credible outcomes. Local ownership alone will not make advertisers switch.	Repeat advertiser spend.
12. Creator quality before follower size	Reward content relevance, disclosure, valid actions and merchant outcomes. Large followings without commercial trust must not dominate allocation.	Valid-action and dispute metrics.
13. Market operators as partners	Markets require accountable local maintenance, not one-time mapping. Market captains and operators need tools, incentives and standards.	Maintained market density.
14. Data rights and privacy by design	Collect only what supports defined commerce purposes, protect sensitive data and preserve user rights. National intelligence must use privacy-safe aggregation.	Data inventory and impact reviews.
15. International engineering discipline	AI-assisted speed cannot bypass typed contracts, tests, migrations, security, observability, backups and incident response.	Release and reliability controls.
16. Modular improvement	New competitors and technologies should be matched through replaceable providers, feature flags and stable domain boundaries rather than emergency rewrites.	Release lead time and rollback.
17. Capital discipline	Do not own fleets, inventory or broad transaction risk before demand proves the need. Spend should deepen supply, demand, trust, intelligence and revenue.	Runway and unit economics.
18. Neutral national platform	No political capture, surveillance access or hidden ranking privilege. Endorsement must follow measured public value and transparent governance.	Policy, disclosure and access logs.
19. Evidence-based expansion	Every new city, category and country requires supply ownership, buyer demand, trust coverage, operating capacity and a stop condition.	Expansion readiness score.
20. Compounding advantage	At each quarterly review, management must show how new users, data, partnerships and revenue made Shoppage harder to replace and more useful than the previous quarter.	Moat scorecard and investor proof.

The charter is intentionally restrictive. Shoppage's opportunity is large enough that weak focus, poor data quality, political dependency, copied features or uncontrolled expansion could consume significant capital without producing a defensible platform. The discipline above protects the national ambition by forcing every phase to create real utility and cumulative advantage.

Part III - Sovereign commercial discovery, local advertising substitution and 80 additional aims

56. Strategic substitution objectives

Shoppage should adopt two explicit national-commercial targets.

First, it should significantly reduce the dependence of Zimbabwean buyers on Google Search, Google Shopping-style product discovery and fragmented social posts when they are trying to find a local product, price, supplier, branch, market or service. The objective is not to replace general web search. It is to become the better starting point for Zimbabwean commercial intent.

Second, it should significantly reduce the dependence of Zimbabwean merchants on Google Ads and Facebook/Instagram advertising for local customer acquisition. The objective is not to prohibit external platforms or claim that every advertisement can move immediately. It is to offer a superior local performance channel for the use cases where Shoppage has stronger first-party information: current local inventory, exact variants, branch availability, delivery zones, verified sellers, creator attribution, buyer requests, prices, market clusters and transaction or lead outcomes. The implementation package confirms that this advantage cannot come from global reference data alone; it requires first-party and partner offer observations at seller-branch-product-time grain.

56.1 The three substitution metrics

Commercial Discovery Share

The percentage of high-intent local commerce sessions in covered categories and geographies that start on, are resolved by or are referred through Shoppage. This should be measured through search sessions, product-detail views, buyer requests, map interactions, catalogue visits, store contacts and verified outcomes.

Merchant Advertising Wallet Share

The percentage of a participating merchant's measurable digital acquisition budget allocated to Shoppage. The denominator should include Meta boosts and ads, Google Ads, influencer payments, group-admin promotions, classified listing fees and other paid digital acquisition reported or evidenced by the merchant.

Local Advertising Value Retention

The percentage of advertiser spend that remains in Zimbabwe after deducting direct imported infrastructure, payment-processing and model-inference costs. Local payroll, creator earnings, merchant services, field-agent commissions, publisher revenue shares and Zimbabwean taxes should count as locally retained value.

56.2 Practical substitution milestones

These are management targets, not externally guaranteed forecasts.

- **Months 0-3:** establish a reliable baseline from launch merchants; prove that Shoppage can receive at least 10% of the measurable digital acquisition budget of a cohort of active pilot advertisers; achieve attributable lead or store-action reporting for at least 70% of paid campaigns.
- **Months 4-6:** reach 15-25% advertising-wallet share among retained active advertisers; demonstrate that a meaningful proportion of covered-category product searches in the launch zones resolve without leaving Shoppage; launch keyword, geo, video, creator and buyer-request ad products.
- **Month 12:** target 20-35% advertising-wallet share among high-engagement advertisers; establish Shoppage as one of the first three product-discovery channels named by surveyed buyers in the launch categories and cities; show repeat campaign purchase from at least half of merchants who achieved a verified outcome.

- **Months 24-36:** target category-level leadership in selected cities rather than claiming national dominance prematurely; pursue 25-40% of structured local commercial-discovery activity in mature categories and a similar or higher share of local performance-ad budgets among active Shoppage merchants.

56.3 What must remain outside the claim

Shoppage must not publish unsupported estimates of total Google or Meta advertising revenue from Zimbabwe. It must not describe all external ad spend as economic loss, because external platforms provide real value and imported infrastructure will remain part of Shoppage's own cost base. The defensible claim is narrower and stronger: Shoppage will retain more Zimbabwean commercial value by owning local commerce data, merchant tools, creator earnings, campaign measurement and buyer relationships.

57. Shoppage product-search and shopping substitution system

The substitute for Google Shopping is not a copied product grid. It is a deeper local commerce-resolution system.

57.1 Shoppage commercial search

Commercial search should resolve natural-language and structured requests such as:

- “Who has a 5 kVA inverter in stock near Chitungwiza today?”
- “Compare 195/65 R15 tyres available in Harare with fitting.”
- “Which verified suppliers deliver cement to Ruwa?”
- “Find an original charging port for this exact phone model.”
- “Show furniture makers who can deliver before month end.”
- “Where can I collect this item after work?”

Google can index public pages, but Shoppage should answer using private and operational data that general web search normally does not possess: last stock confirmation, exact variant, service radius, response time, branch-level availability, verified location, merchant reliability, real lead outcomes, compatible alternatives and local delivery constraints.

57.2 Search result architecture

Every result should combine:

- Exact and semantic relevance.
- Variant and compatibility matching.
- Distance, delivery zone and collection feasibility.
- Freshness and confidence score.
- Merchant trust and response performance.
- Price validity and currency timestamp.
- Organic quality and clearly labelled sponsored relevance.
- Low-data preview and immediate buyer action.

57.3 The Shoppage answer layer

Shoppage Ask should produce a concise commercial answer before presenting listings. It should explain what is available, where, at what confidence level, what alternatives exist and what information remains uncertain. For ambiguous requests, the system should ask practical questions such as budget, area, size, model or delivery date before routing the buyer to sellers.

57.4 Product graph depth

The catalogue must distinguish brand, model, generation, size, capacity, colour, condition, specification, compatibility, warranty, branch, seller, currency, price date and stock state. This structured variant depth is

central to replacing generic search results and is a major moat because it requires ongoing merchant and field operations rather than one-time web crawling.

57.5 Public-web strategy

Shoppage should still publish crawlable, high-quality product, vendor, market and category pages so that external search engines become acquisition channels. The objective is to use Google to acquire a buyer once, then retain the buyer through saved needs, alerts, verified inventory, repeat searches, price tracking and local recommendations.

58. Shoppage Ads substitution system

58.1 The strategic promise

Shoppage Ads should promise locally measurable commerce outcomes rather than cheap impressions. The primary advertiser proposition is:

Reach people who are actively looking for products, suppliers, services and markets in Zimbabwe, using current local commerce data and reporting tied to calls, WhatsApp leads, quote requests, visits, reservations and verified sales.

58.2 Ad products required to substitute external spend

- Sponsored commercial search with strict relevance thresholds.
- Promoted products and product variants.
- Branch and nearby-availability promotions.
- Category and market sponsorships.
- Short-video commerce campaigns.
- Creator affiliate and managed content campaigns.
- Buyer-request matching and qualified-lead access.
- Retargeting within Shoppage using consented first-party behaviour.
- Saved-search and price-alert sponsorship with frequency controls.
- Market-day, launch, stock-arrival and event campaigns.
- Diaspora-to-Zimbabwe campaigns.
- Brand and distributor campaigns routed to verified local stockists.
- Offline QR and location campaigns with digital attribution.

58.3 Why merchants should shift budget

The platform must be easier than Meta Ads Manager for a small seller and more locally informative than general search advertising. A merchant should be able to select a product, choose an objective and area, set a budget, receive a quality warning, publish and see attributable results without understanding campaign jargon.

58.4 Outcome measurement

Campaign reporting should distinguish:

- Impression and view.
- Engaged product view.
- Catalogue visit.
- Save or share.
- Phone, map or WhatsApp action.
- Qualified buyer request.
- Vendor response.
- Reservation or quote.

- Verified store visit or completed sale where available.
- Repeat customer or repeat enquiry.

58.5 Local ad ecosystem

Shoppage should progressively share value with Zimbabwean creators, field agents, market operators, media publishers and specialist communities. This creates a domestic performance-media network rather than a closed platform that merely redirects foreign-platform economics to one local company.

59. International benchmark lessons

The model is feasible because several markets have produced strong local or regional platforms by combining search, commerce, advertising, payments, logistics, content and merchant services around local behaviour.

- South Korea's Naver demonstrates the strategic value of connecting search, shopping, maps, content, advertising and payments around local language and local data.
- Latin America's Mercado Libre demonstrates how a regional commerce platform can combine marketplace demand, merchant tools, advertising, payments, credit and fulfilment into a compounding ecosystem.
- Poland's Allegro demonstrates that a locally entrenched marketplace can remain the leading commerce destination while expanding advertising, loyalty, logistics and AI-assisted shopping capabilities despite global competition.

The lesson is not to copy their mature scope. The lesson is to build a narrow local advantage, gather proprietary first-party data, compound merchant and buyer utility, and expand only after the core loop works. Zimbabwe's smaller market makes focus and capital discipline more important, not less.

60. Eighty additional strategic aims to blend into the operating model

The aims below are mandatory design objectives. They are grouped so each can be assigned to an owner, roadmap, metric and release gate.

A. Commercial sovereignty and platform substitution

- 1. Make Shoppage the default local product-search habit.** Optimise the home screen, saved needs and search quality around frequent Zimbabwean buying tasks. Measure unaided buyer recall and repeat direct traffic.
- 2. Capture measurable merchant ad-wallet share.** Onboard each paid advertiser with a baseline of current external spending and report the percentage moved to Shoppage.
- 3. Retain advertising value locally.** Track how advertiser revenue is distributed to Zimbabwean salaries, creators, agents, market partners and taxes after direct imported costs.
- 4. Convert external platforms into feeders.** Generate shareable cards, clips and links for Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok and Google while ensuring the structured catalogue and analytics remain on Shoppage.
- 5. Own covered-category commercial intent.** Select categories where current availability, location and trust matter more than broad web coverage, then aim for category leadership city by city.
- 6. Build a Zimbabwean commercial keyword graph.** Learn local spellings, slang, brand nicknames, product substitutions and buying phrases that generic global search may misinterpret.
- 7. Create a local merchant advertising standard.** Define transparent campaign objectives, billing, relevance, disclosure and outcome measurement suitable for SMEs.
- 8. Establish a local commerce media network.** Allow approved local publishers, communities and market pages to earn from relevant Shoppage ads and affiliate outcomes.

B. Buyer utility and daily relevance

9. **Resolve a need faster than a Facebook post.** Measure median time from search or request to a credible available option.
10. **Show stock confidence, not false certainty.** Every availability claim should carry a last-confirmed timestamp and confidence score.
11. **Provide exact variant discovery.** Buyers must find the correct size, model, condition, specification and compatible alternative.
12. **Deliver useful price intelligence.** Show price date, currency, range, historical movement and comparable local alternatives where data quality allows.
13. **Offer “available today” discovery.** Prioritise same-day collection, open-now branches and realistic local delivery.
14. **Create saved-needs automation.** Buyers can save a requirement and receive an alert when a matching product, price or seller appears.
15. **Provide buyer-request routing.** Unresolved searches become structured requests routed to capable and responsive vendors.
16. **Support voice-first search.** Enable voice notes and speech input for users who prefer speaking to typing.
17. **Support multilingual commerce.** Progressively support English, Shona and Ndebele search terms, prompts and assistance.
18. **Design for low data and unstable networks.** Provide compressed media, offline-tolerant forms, cached recent pages and optional no-autoplay mode.
19. **Make comparison practical.** Compare total buyer outcome, including delivery, warranty, location, trust and availability rather than price alone.
20. **Create a personal commerce memory.** With consent, remember sizes, device models, preferred areas, saved brands and recurring household or business needs.

C. Merchant growth and operating capability

21. **Give every merchant a world-class mobile storefront.** A small trader should look credible without paying for a custom website.
22. **Reduce product publishing to minutes.** Use image, spreadsheet, voice, message and AI-assisted ingestion with human confirmation.
23. **Turn every product into reusable content.** Automatically generate cards, captions, videos, QR codes and campaign variations.
24. **Create a daily merchant action queue.** Prioritise stale stock, unanswered leads, price checks, campaign opportunities and missing information.
25. **Measure lead quality, not only lead volume.** Report which enquiries were genuine, responded to, quoted and completed.
26. **Improve merchant response performance.** Provide response templates, reminders, staff routing and response-time benchmarks.
27. **Build branch-level intelligence.** Help multi-branch merchants understand local demand, stock gaps and campaign performance by branch.
28. **Enable informal-to-formal progression.** Offer increasing verification, bookkeeping, payment and compliance tools without excluding informal sellers at entry.

- 29. Create merchant improvement plans.** AI and human advisors should recommend specific actions based on catalogue, demand and service evidence.
- 30. Provide affordable managed services.** Product digitisation, photography, campaign setup and catalogue maintenance must be available to merchants who cannot self-serve.
- 31. Create portable merchant reputation.** A merchant's verified history, response performance and customer outcomes should compound into a durable Shoppage reputation passport.
- 32. Build supplier and distributor links.** Allow merchants to discover stock sources, authorised distribution and replenishment opportunities.

D. Intelligence and data moat

- 33. Build the national commerce entity graph.** Maintain linked records for places, businesses, branches, markets, products, variants, services, creators and supply relationships.
- 34. Record evidence and provenance.** Every important claim should show source type, collection date, confidence and verification history.
- 35. Develop a stock-truth history.** Track how often merchants confirm, change or misstate availability and use the history in ranking.
- 36. Build a local compatibility graph.** Link parts, accessories, consumables and substitutes to the exact products they work with.
- 37. Map unmet demand.** Analyse searches, abandoned journeys and buyer requests that produce no adequate result.
- 38. Identify geographic supply gaps.** Show where demand exists without nearby stock, delivery or service coverage.
- 39. Develop merchant opportunity scores.** Recommend products, locations, content and campaigns based on observed local demand.
- 40. Create category price and availability indices.** Publish carefully qualified, privacy-safe market views for selected categories.
- 41. Build a Zimbabwe business knowledge layer.** Capture operating hours, service areas, payment options, delivery practices, trust evidence and special capabilities not reliably available in ordinary search.
- 42. Create a correction and verification network.** Reward merchants, buyers, agents and market operators for verified updates while controlling abuse.
- 43. Protect the graph from scraping and poisoning.** Use rate limits, provenance, anomaly detection, canary fields and contractual controls.
- 44. Create data products without selling personal data.** Monetise aggregated demand and market intelligence while preserving individual privacy and commercial confidentiality.

E. Advertising and creator economy

- 45. Make self-service advertising understandable.** Replace complex campaign configuration with objective, product, area, budget and duration.
- 46. Guarantee relevance floors for sponsored results.** Money must not buy placement for an irrelevant, stale or unsafe listing.
- 47. Create creator-product attribution.** Track which creator, clip, collection or market page produced a lead or transaction.

- 48. Build a creator marketplace.** Match vendors and brands to creators by category, location, audience quality and proven outcomes.
- 49. Pay for verified value.** Support campaign fees, qualified-lead commissions and transaction commissions rather than follower-count pricing alone.
- 50. Develop local creative intelligence.** Identify which formats, languages, lengths, offers and presenters work for each category and location.
- 51. Launch market and area sponsorships.** Give local advertisers high-visibility, geographically relevant inventory unavailable on global platforms.
- 52. Enable brand-to-stockist campaigns.** Brands should advertise only where buyers can find verified local inventory or authorised sellers.
- 53. Create Shoppage ad credits.** Use controlled credits for onboarding, training and performance guarantees without permanently subsidising poor campaigns.
- 54. Build campaign experiments into the product.** Provide simple creative and audience tests with minimum sample-quality rules.
- 55. Establish independent ad-integrity controls.** Separate commercial sales targets from relevance, safety and complaint decision rights.

F. Markets, geography and offline integration

- 56. Digitise markets as operating units.** Each market, mall, cluster and growth point should have a searchable page, map, vendors, content and campaigns.
- 57. Create market captain roles.** Local operators maintain merchant participation, verification, freshness and dispute escalation.
- 58. Use QR infrastructure at physical locations.** Link shelves, stalls, windows, receipts and posters to products, markets, offers and attribution.
- 59. Map commercial corridors, not only street addresses.** Support growth points, highways, bus routes, rural service areas and informal landmarks.
- 60. Build verified collection points.** Allow trusted locations to serve as pickup, inspection or assisted-order points.
- 61. Create market events and live discovery.** Promote market days, stock arrivals, trade fairs, exhibitions and seasonal selling periods.
- 62. Enable province-by-province replication.** Use a repeatable city and market launch scorecard rather than uncontrolled national expansion.

G. Trust, safety, payments and fulfilment

- 63. Build progressive verification.** Separate phone, identity, location, business, bank/payment and authorised-dealer verification.
- 64. Use proof-backed reviews.** Weight feedback by verified contact, reservation, payment or collection evidence.
- 65. Detect suspicious pricing and duplicate scam content.** Combine rules, image similarity, behaviour analysis and human review.
- 66. Create category-specific safety policies.** High-risk categories require tighter identity, content, payment and moderation controls.

- 67. Support multiple realistic payment paths.** Cash, collection, mobile money, bank transfer, payment link, deposit and later escrow should be available where appropriate.
- 68. Add buyer protection gradually.** Introduce guarantees only when operational processes, reserves and dispute capability can support them.
- 69. Integrate delivery as a quoted network.** Match merchants and buyers to delivery partners without prematurely owning a national fleet.
- 70. Measure fulfilment reliability.** Track dispatch, pickup, delivery, cancellation and dispute performance where transactions are supported.

H. Global quality, technology and AI

- 71. Set international performance budgets.** Define targets for page speed, search latency, uptime, crash-free sessions and media efficiency on common Zimbabwean devices.
- 72. Build accessible interfaces.** Follow recognised accessibility standards and test with screen readers, low vision, limited literacy and motor constraints.
- 73. Use a modular product platform.** Shared identity, graph, trust, billing and analytics should support rapid layer-by-layer improvement without duplicate systems.
- 74. Maintain provider portability.** AI, search, storage, messaging and payment integrations should use adapters to reduce lock-in.
- 75. Create an AI evaluation harness.** Test search, extraction, recommendations, moderation and fraud models against Zimbabwe-specific datasets before release.
- 76. Keep humans in high-impact decisions.** Verification rejection, serious fraud, account suspension and disputed payments require review and appeal.
- 77. Use AI to reduce cost, not hide weak operations.** Automate repetitive work while retaining clear ownership for data quality, merchant support and customer outcomes.
- 78. Run a continuous competitor-response system.** Track competitor releases, prioritise genuine user value and ship measured improvements in short cycles.
- 79. Build observability from day one.** Product events, job failures, model performance, security alerts and data-quality regressions must be diagnosable.
- 80. Treat security and privacy as product quality.** Implement tenant isolation, least privilege, encryption, audit logs, retention controls and incident response before national scale.

61. Strategic scorecard for the eighty aims

The aims become operational only when they are tied to a common scorecard.

61.1 Buyer scorecard

- Direct and repeat traffic.
- Search success rate.
- Median time to credible option.
- Percentage of searches with fresh local results.
- Saved-need match rate.
- Buyer-request fulfilment rate.
- Trust complaint rate.
- Verified purchase or visit outcomes where measurable.

61.2 Merchant scorecard

- Activated and weekly active merchants.
- Fresh catalogue percentage.
- Median lead response time.
- Lead-to-quote and lead-to-sale rates.
- Advertising-wallet share.
- Repeat campaign rate.
- Merchant retention and expansion revenue.
- Measurable sales or operational improvement.

61.3 Platform-substitution scorecard

- Commercial Discovery Share in covered categories and zones.
- Direct Shoppage searches versus external referrals.
- Percentage of buyer sessions resolved without returning to external platforms.
- Merchant Advertising Wallet Share.
- Local Advertising Value Retention.
- Number and value of creator, agent, market and publisher payouts in Zimbabwe.
- Campaign cost per verified outcome relative to merchant-reported alternatives.

61.4 Intelligence scorecard

- Verified entities and relationships.
- Product and variant coverage.
- Freshness confidence.
- Provenance completeness.
- Correction resolution time.
- Unmet-demand observations converted into supply.
- AI accuracy by task and language.

62. Execution rules for the 0-6 month programme

62.1 Months 0-3

The first release should prove the complete operating loop in one launch wedge and geography:

- Merchant creates a verified Shoppage.
- Products and variants are ingested and kept fresh.
- Buyer finds an item through search, geo or Showcase.
- Buyer contacts, requests or reserves.
- Merchant responds and marks outcome.
- Creator or market attribution is recorded where relevant.
- Merchant launches a paid campaign.
- Shoppage reports attributable commercial actions.
- Data feeds the intelligence graph and improvement recommendations.

The product must include the measurement fields needed for the substitution metrics from the first pilot. Retrofitting advertising-wallet baselines and commercial-discovery measurement after launch would weaken the investor and national-value case.

62.2 Months 4-6

Expansion should add depth before uncontrolled breadth:

- More categories only after freshness and search-quality gates pass.

- Second city or provincial cluster using the same market-captain and field-agent playbook.
- Keyword and buyer-request advertising.
- Creator marketplace and tracked commissions.
- Brand-to-stockist campaigns.
- Saved-needs and price/stock alerts.
- Deeper product compatibility and variant graph.
- Selected payment, reservation and delivery workflows.
- External publisher and partner pilots.
- Investor dashboard showing wallet share, discovery share, local retention and cohort economics.

63. Final substitution doctrine

Shoppage should not define success as the disappearance of Google, Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp or TikTok from Zimbabwe. That is neither realistic nor necessary. Success is achieved when Zimbabwean buyers use Shoppage first for local commercial intent, when merchants choose Shoppage for measurable local acquisition, and when external platforms become optional distribution channels rather than owners of the core customer, catalogue, intelligence and advertising relationship.

The defensible national ambition is:

Build the most complete, current and trusted map of Zimbabwean commerce; use it to deliver a better buying and selling experience than generic global platforms can provide locally; and retain a growing share of the resulting data, advertising, creator earnings, merchant growth and economic value inside Zimbabwe.

Part IV - Commerce Intelligence Foundation Integration

64. Implementation evidence status as of 10 July 2026

Shoppage now has a runnable commerce-intelligence foundation package. This changes the model from a strategy that proposes a data moat into a strategy with an initial, validated evidence and resolution layer. The package includes source inventories, classification references, repeatable ingestion scripts, validation scripts, a PostgreSQL commerce-graph schema, a million-record global product reference database, organisation and place studies, review queues and a merchant-offer feed contract.

The package was independently re-run against its included validators before this edition was prepared. The global-product, organisation-study, place-hierarchy and package-integrity checks passed. The correct management conclusion is therefore: **the technical foundation is proven at seed and scale-test level, while Zimbabwe commercial truth still depends on merchant, regulator, municipal, distributor, manufacturer, POS and field evidence.**

Foundation layer	Validated implementation	Boundary that must remain explicit
Organisation discovery	6,101 source records; 5,281 distinct normalised names; 5,899 ISIC-mapped records	Candidates include organisations, branches, institutions, facilities and places; they are not 5,281 verified operating companies
Global product mastering	1,000,000 unique global food identities; 950,334 checksum-valid GTINs; 466,276 family keys	A scale-tested global reference seed, not Zimbabwe stock, price, seller coverage or demand
Place and market scaffold	25,210 nodes; 25,209 edges; 118 explicitly tagged markets or malls	GeoNames and OpenStreetMap discovery scaffolding; official geography and operating status require reconciliation and verification
Merchant-offer bridge	Versioned feed contract, idempotent observation store, exact-GTIN matching and review queue	Acceptance tests are synthetic; production merchant offers are not yet present

64.1 Claims ladder

Every public, investor, government and merchant claim must use one of four states.

- **Foundation validated:** a schema, pipeline, count or test was reproduced from the package.
- **Discovered candidate:** a source indicates that an entity, place, product or relationship may exist.
- **Verified claim:** the specific predicate has sufficient current evidence and a defined verification scope.
- **Production truth:** a verified claim is fresh enough and operationally safe to use in search, advertising, intelligence or fulfilment.

A record must never move from candidate to verified merely because it appeared in a directory, map, Facebook page, website or model output. Verification is predicate-specific. A regulator may verify a licence; a merchant may verify a current catalogue; a field observation may verify a location; a buyer outcome may verify responsiveness. These sources may disagree, and the disagreement must remain visible until resolved.

64.2 What this changes in the investment thesis

The defensibility thesis is no longer limited to future user growth. Shoppage has the beginning of an evidence graph with source identity, licence, timestamps, hashes, confidence, review states and unresolved conflicts. Competitors can copy a storefront layout, but copying a governed history of what was observed, by whom, under what rights, at which branch, in which market, at what time, with what confidence and how the claim changed is materially harder.

However, the model must avoid a common investor mistake: counting reference rows as commercial coverage. The value of the graph will be determined by the percentage of Zimbabwean buyer needs it can resolve with fresh local offers, verified suppliers and attributable outcomes, not by the gross number of global reference records.

65. Commerce graph architecture locked by implementation

The package validates the model's central architectural decision: Shoppage must be an evidence-backed commerce graph, not a flat listings database.

65.1 Stable entities, changing claims

Stable nodes include organisations, branches, places, markets, master products, variants, creators, categories and commercial locations. Time-varying claims include:

- a branch is operating at a location;
- a merchant sells a product or provides a service;
- a variant is in stock;
- a price is valid in a currency;
- a store belongs to a market;
- a creator is authorised to promote an offer;
- a merchant responds within a measured time;
- a buyer outcome occurred;
- a licence or verification remains valid.

This separation is essential. Product identity should not be overwritten when a seller changes price. A business should not be duplicated for every branch. A market should not be declared inside another market because two coordinates are close. A product family should not be treated as a compatible substitute without category evidence.

65.2 Required source and evidence controls

Production records must preserve:

- source system and source type;
- source authority and predicate scope;
- external source identifier and source URL where permitted;
- observation and retrieval time;
- content hash or equivalent immutable evidence reference;
- rights and reuse note;
- confidence and verification state;
- reviewer and review decision;
- validity period and supersession history;
- unresolved conflicts.

The source-precedence rule is predicate-specific. There is no universal best source. CIPZ may control legal registration evidence; a regulator controls a licence within its mandate; a merchant controls its current

catalogue; a market operator controls a roster; field verification controls what was observed at a time; and transaction evidence may control whether a lead or sale occurred.

65.3 Review queues are a product capability

Review queues must be first-class operational products, not hidden database leftovers. Required queues include:

- organisation duplicate and branch-resolution candidates;
- unresolved activity classification;
- product identity and variant conflicts;
- product-enrichment gaps;
- place-parent and market-containment review;
- offer records with invalid, absent or unmatched identifiers;
- stale stock and price claims;
- disputed merchant, creator or customer claims;
- rights and licensing exceptions.

Each queue needs severity, owner, service-level target, evidence display, decision reason and audit history. AI may propose a decision, but high-impact merges, rejections, suspensions and disputed claims require human approval and appeal.

65.4 Coverage cells become the national operating map

The implemented schema includes a place-category coverage concept. Shoppage should operationalise this as a coverage cell for every relevant combination of location and commercial category. A coverage cell should track:

- verified organisations;
- active branches and markets;
- fresh offers and variant depth;
- average price and stock recency;
- merchant response rate;
- buyer demand and unresolved requests;
- verified outcomes;
- trust and complaint signals;
- coverage state: empty, thin, usable, strong or authoritative.

Coverage cells guide field operations, merchant acquisition, advertising inventory, creator assignments, city expansion and national reporting. They prevent Shoppage from claiming nationwide coverage when only a few categories or neighbourhoods are useful.

66. Organisation intelligence programme

66.1 Current baseline

The current study contains 6,101 source records from OpenStreetMap, the Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe microfinance register, Zimbabwe Stock Exchange anchors and ZERA petroleum licences. It demonstrates source ingestion, normalisation, provenance and activity classification. It does not yet resolve all records into legal entities, branch structures or active merchant accounts.

The source mix is weighted toward OpenStreetMap discovery. That is useful for coverage, but insufficient for national business truth. The next wave must diversify toward official identity, first-party merchant evidence and active commercial relationships.

66.2 Required organisation lifecycle

Every organisation record should move through a controlled lifecycle:

1. **Discovered:** source-backed candidate exists.
2. **Resolved:** duplicate, branch and legal-entity relationships have been reviewed.
3. **Claimed:** an authorised representative controls the Shoppage profile.
4. **Verified:** defined identity, location or licence checks pass.
5. **Activated:** catalogue, contact path and freshness obligations are live.
6. **Performing:** the merchant responds, keeps information current and generates outcomes.
7. **Monitored:** verification, activity and complaint states are continuously reviewed.
8. **Suspended, dormant or closed:** lifecycle change is retained rather than deleted.

66.3 Priority source expansion

The organisation programme should add, subject to access and reuse rights:

- CIPZ or Ministry of Justice legal-identity evidence;
- VFEX and additional exchange/company anchors;
- RBZ banks, payment providers and other regulated financial institutions;
- POTRAZ telecom, postal and courier operators;
- ZimTrade exporter and manufacturer partnerships;
- PRAZ and procurement-supplier evidence;
- tourism, medicine, insurance and other sector regulators;
- mall, market, association and distributor rosters;
- merchant self-registration and authorised feeds;
- field-agent and market-captain observations;
- public social and directory discovery followed by merchant confirmation.

66.4 Organisation intelligence outputs

Shoppage should be able to answer more than “does this business exist?” It should progressively know:

- legal and trading names, aliases and brands;
- parent, subsidiary, franchise, branch and operator relationships;
- activities mapped to ISIC and Shoppage commercial roles;
- categories, products, services and brands carried;
- operating locations, service areas and delivery zones;
- payment, collection and fulfilment options;
- response, freshness and outcome performance;
- trust, complaint and verification history;
- digital maturity and recommended improvements.

This supports merchant search, B2B sourcing, brand-to-stockist advertising, market intelligence and the Business Improvement Copilot.

67. Product, variant and compatibility intelligence

67.1 What the million-product seed proves

The million-record database proves that Shoppage can ingest, uniquely identify, index and validate a large global reference source. It includes 950,334 valid GTINs and exposes 883,674 records with one or more enrichment gaps rather than silently filling missing values.

The seed is intentionally global and food-focused. It should be treated as:

- a product-mastering scale test;

- a source of food identifiers and attributes where rights permit;
- a future grocery and packaged-goods reference asset;
- a test corpus for matching, enrichment and search infrastructure.

It should not be treated as the launch catalogue for Zimbabwe, and it does not replace category-specific mastering for Home, Power and Building.

67.2 Launch-category correction

The launch wedge remains solar, batteries, inverters, electrical, plumbing, hardware, building materials, appliances, furniture and related services. The product programme must therefore prioritise non-food reference and supplier data immediately.

For each launch category, Shoppage needs:

- brand and manufacturer identity;
- model and manufacturer-part-number structure;
- capacity, voltage, size, dimensions, material and grade;
- pack, unit and minimum-order conventions;
- condition and warranty;
- compatibility relationships;
- safety and certification fields where applicable;
- substitution rules and “not equivalent” constraints;
- local naming, spelling and informal aliases;
- category-specific freshness windows.

Sources should be merchant, distributor and manufacturer feeds, authorised catalogues, standards data under suitable licences and category-expert review. Public listings may help discovery, but descriptions and images must not be copied without rights.

67.3 Product-layer discipline

Shoppage must preserve four distinct layers:

- **Product family:** broad navigational need, such as hybrid solar inverter.
- **Master product or model:** a defined manufacturer and model identity.
- **Variant:** commercially meaningful configuration, such as capacity, voltage, colour, pack, size, grade or condition.
- **Offer:** seller, branch, market, price, currency, stock, lead time, terms and observation time.

Family keys support navigation and candidate generation. They do not prove interchangeability. Compatibility and substitution require category-specific rules, exact identifiers and expert review.

67.4 Enrichment programme

The enrichment queue should be prioritised by commercial impact, not by random record completion. Priority should reflect:

- active Zimbabwe demand;
- launch-category relevance;
- merchant and brand partnerships;
- search failures and buyer requests;
- advertising demand;
- safety and compatibility risk;
- number of local offers affected;
- expected conversion improvement.

A record with a missing optional marketing field should rank below a widely sold inverter with an ambiguous voltage or compatibility attribute.

68. Place, market and geolocal intelligence

68.1 Current baseline

The package materialises every 25,019-feature Zimbabwe GeoNames record and creates a 25,210-node, 25,209-edge scaffold with 2,101 settlement nodes and 118 explicitly tagged OpenStreetMap markets or malls. It deliberately creates no unsupported market-in-market containment edges.

Only a small portion of market-parent proposals are based on exact source-city naming; most are proximity candidates requiring review. This is correct behaviour. Proximity is a discovery signal, not proof of containment or operating status.

68.2 Production authority

ZIMSTAT boundaries and current official identifiers must control province, district, ward and other official administrative hierarchy in production. GeoNames and OpenStreetMap remain valuable for aliases, discovery and geometry, subject to licence and reconciliation.

Municipal, market-operator and mall evidence should control:

- market and mall operating identity;
- building, section, shop and stall membership;
- market-in-market relationships;
- access points and operating hours;
- pickup and collection points;
- parking, route and delivery constraints;
- temporary market days and seasonal events.

68.3 Geolocal model enhancements

Administrative geography must be complemented by commercial geography:

- commercial corridors and supplier streets;
- CBD blocks and industrial clusters;
- growth points and rural service centres;
- informal landmarks and route-based access;
- delivery zones and service areas;
- verified collection points;
- market sections, buildings and stall ranges.

Delivery zones and service areas are overlays, not administrative children. They need effective dates because merchants and logistics partners can change coverage.

69. Zimbabwe offer acquisition and Stock Truth

69.1 The commercial bottleneck

The global master and discovery graph are valuable, but the decisive dependency is local offer supply. Zimbabwe price, stock, seller, branch and availability data cannot be inferred from a global catalogue. The absence of meaningful public Zimbabwe price coverage in open global datasets reinforces the need for direct partnerships and field operations.

69.2 Canonical observation grain

The merchant feed contract correctly defines one observation as:

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one seller-branch product offer observed at one timestamp.

Every production offer observation should retain:

- source offer identifier;
- seller and branch identifiers;
- market or commercial-location identifier where relevant;
- observation timestamp with timezone;
- evidence URL or evidence object reference;
- product name and seller SKU;
- GTIN, MPN or other identifier when available;
- currency and non-negative price;
- stock state;
- quantity, category and structured attributes;
- rights state for description and image reuse;
- resolution state and method.

Supported stock states should include in stock, limited, out of stock, preorder, backorder and unknown.

Currency must reflect what the merchant actually displayed; Shoppage should not silently convert or combine currencies without a timestamped rate and a clear display rule.

69.3 Acquisition order

Local offer acquisition should follow this order:

1. Merchant-authorized CSV, JSON, API, SFTP or object-storage feeds.
2. Distributor and manufacturer agreements, including identifiers and branch availability.
3. POS and e-commerce connectors installed with merchant authorisation.
4. Merchant mobile updates, WhatsApp-assisted ingestion and structured catalogue entry.
5. Field, receipt and price-tag observations under explicit contributor terms.
6. Public pages only where terms, robots controls, law and intended reuse allow collection.

The model must reject a “scrape first, ask later” strategy. It creates legal, data-quality and investor-diligence risk and does not establish current stock.

69.4 Resolution and idempotency

The validated ingester proves three important operating rules:

- valid GTIN exact matches can be resolved deterministically;
- valid identifiers not yet in the master remain visible for review;
- unbarcoded products enter text-resolution review rather than being silently merged;
- repeated ingestion of the same seller-branch-offer-time observation is idempotent.

Production matching should proceed from exact identifiers to supplier/manufacturer identifiers and then to reviewed brand, model, quantity, pack and category evidence. Text similarity alone must not merge high-risk technical products.

69.5 Scale interpretation

One million offer observations is an operational volume, not necessarily one million unique products. One hundred participating branches with 10,000 active SKUs represent one million branch-SKU observations in a single refresh. Repeated snapshots create a large price and availability history while product masters remain deduplicated.

The business model should therefore report separately:

- unique master products;
- variants;
- active local offers;
- branches with feeds;
- fresh offer observations;
- historical observations;
- unresolved offers;
- verified outcome events.

70. Rights, licences and data governance additions

The implementation package makes rights management a core commercial requirement.

70.1 Source-specific rights

- OpenStreetMap-derived records require attribution and Open Database Licence compliance.
- GeoNames data requires its applicable attribution and licence controls.
- Open Food Facts database content is governed by ODbL/database-content terms; images have separate obligations and were excluded from the seed.
- Regulator and exchange records verify only the stated dated predicate.
- Merchant, distributor, manufacturer, POS and market feeds require explicit agreements defining permitted uses, refresh duties, corrections, retention, confidentiality and termination.
- Public social posts and websites are discovery evidence unless terms and law permit the intended reuse.

70.2 Data agreement minimums

Every recurring data partnership should define:

- data owner and authorised provider;
- permitted processing and display;
- rights for descriptions, images and videos;
- refresh frequency and service levels;
- correction and takedown procedures;
- security and breach responsibilities;
- use in search, ads, intelligence and AI;
- aggregation and benchmark rules;
- termination, portability and deletion;
- attribution requirements.

70.3 No sale of personal data

Shoppage should monetise commerce intelligence, not raw personal data. Intelligence products should use aggregation, minimum cohort sizes, role-based access, suppression of sensitive segments and contractual limits. Merchant-confidential data must not be exposed to competitors. Buyer behavioural data must be governed by clear purpose, consent where required, retention limits and opt-out controls.

71. AI, matching and human-review operating model

AI should accelerate evidence processing without becoming a source of unverified truth.

71.1 AI tasks

- extract names, addresses, contacts, prices and product attributes from authorised documents or messages;
- suggest ISIC, CPC, Shoppage and procurement category mappings;
- generate product and organisation match candidates;

- normalise units, brands, models and local aliases;
- detect duplicate images, suspicious prices and data anomalies;
- prioritise review queues;
- propose compatibility and substitution candidates;
- route buyer requests to likely suppliers;
- identify coverage gaps and merchant improvement actions.

71.2 Evaluation requirements

Every model-assisted workflow needs a Zimbabwe-specific gold set and task metrics. Product resolution should report precision, recall, false-merge rate, false-split rate and review rate by category, source, brand and language. Organisation and place matching should report the same types of errors at branch and legal-entity level.

Automatic decisions should use category-calibrated thresholds. A high precision threshold is more important than aggressive automation when a false merge could misstate product compatibility, price, ownership, location or regulated status.

71.3 Human approval boundaries

Human approval remains mandatory for:

- ambiguous organisation merges;
- branch-to-legal-entity relationships;
- high-risk product identity and compatibility decisions;
- official geography reconciliation;
- market-in-market containment;
- serious fraud and account suspension;
- disputed verification and payment outcomes;
- rights and licensing exceptions.

72. Production service architecture

The included SQLite databases are suitable for scale testing, offline validation and reproducible package delivery. They are not the final multi-tenant production datastore.

72.1 Production components

- PostgreSQL as the authoritative commerce graph and event store.
- Object storage for immutable source payloads, evidence files and media.
- NestJS services for ingestion, evidence, identity, catalogue, offers, places, markets, trust and review workflows.
- Background workers for imports, matching, enrichment, freshness, indexing and notifications.
- Meilisearch or an equivalent search layer for buyer search and internal reviewer discovery.
- Redis for queues, rate controls and short-lived coordination.
- Analytics warehouse or partitioned event tables as volume grows.
- Reviewer applications for organisation, product, place, offer and rights queues.

72.2 Required production APIs

- source-system and source-record APIs;
- organisation and branch resolution APIs;
- product master, variant and identifier APIs;
- offer-observation and current-offer APIs;
- evidence-claim and history APIs;
- place, market and containment APIs;

- review queue and decision APIs;
- coverage-cell APIs;
- freshness and expiry APIs;
- search-index publication APIs;
- correction, dispute and audit APIs.

72.3 Current-state materialisation

Search and public product pages should use a carefully materialised current state derived from the evidence history. The original observations must remain immutable. When a price changes, the earlier observation stays in history, while the current-offer view points to the latest valid evidence. This design enables Price Pulse, Stock Truth, dispute investigation and data-quality audits.

73. Revised months 0-3 implementation roadmap

The existing 12-week scope remains achievable only if the team treats the validated package as the starting point and prioritises local offers over additional reference-data vanity counts.

Period	Delivery focus	Exit gate
Weeks 1-2	Import schema and package into the production repository; migrate core records to PostgreSQL; establish source, evidence, rights and review services; complete security and licence register	Reproducible deployment, CI validation, source lineage visible and no candidate falsely promoted to verified
Weeks 3-4	Build organisation resolution and merchant-claim workflows; launch reviewer console; onboard first authorised merchant and distributor feeds	At least 20 pilot merchants or branches, valid evidence contracts and repeated idempotent offer ingestion
Weeks 5-6	Build non-food masters for Home, Power and Building; create attribute templates and compatibility rules; deploy offer current-state and freshness jobs	Launch categories produce reliable family-model-variant-offer separation and review metrics
Weeks 7-8	Connect Shoppage Central and Showcase to the graph; launch geo search, confidence labels, Stock Truth and buyer requests	Buyers can find fresh branch-level offers and merchants can correct or confirm them
Weeks 9-10	Launch Ads, Creators and Markets against canonical entities; enforce freshness and trust floors for promotion; implement attribution	Paid placements, creator links and market pages resolve to governed products, vendors and locations

Period	Delivery focus	Exit gate
Weeks 11-12	Controlled Harare pilot, load and security tests, field verification, campaign tests and launch-gate review	Search quality, freshness, response, trust, attribution and incident gates pass before public launch

73.1 Month-three data gates

The exact targets should be approved against staffing and partnerships, but the launch must require:

- no unsupported claim of a complete national commerce census;
- 100% provenance on public product, organisation and place records;
- a defined verification state for every surfaced merchant and market;
- at least 80% of visible launch-category offers within their freshness window;
- product-resolution precision above the category threshold on reviewed gold sets;
- false-merge rate low enough to protect technical compatibility and merchant identity;
- review queues with owners and service levels;
- rights-cleared images and descriptions;
- auditable advertising and creator attribution;
- backup restoration, incident response and administrative audit logging tested.

73.2 Scope protection

The team should not spend the first 12 weeks attempting to enrich all one million global food records, map every Zimbabwean business, build national checkout or infer all market containment. It should use the foundation to make one launch wedge and geography materially superior in local commercial truth.

74. Months 4-6 expansion based on the foundation

Expansion should compound data quality and operating leverage.

- Reconcile official geography with ZIMSTAT identifiers and boundaries.
- Add municipal and operator market rosters and verified nested-market structures.
- Expand distributor, manufacturer, POS and merchant-feed partnerships.
- Extend non-food mastering to auto parts, electronics, agriculture or another category only after readiness gates.
- Add second-city coverage cells and field operations.
- Improve text resolution with reviewed Zimbabwe-specific training and evaluation data.
- Launch Price Pulse, Demand Radar, Market Lens and Brand-to-Stockist intelligence from sufficiently dense data.
- Add saved-needs alerts and seller opportunity recommendations.
- Provide enterprise feed-health and catalogue-quality dashboards.
- Introduce selected reservation, deposit, delivery and proof-of-fulfilment flows.
- Publish a transparent coverage report showing where Shoppage is authoritative, usable, thin or empty.

75. Business-model additions created by the implementation package

The foundation enables revenue products that were previously conceptual.

75.1 Data onboarding and integration

- merchant catalogue digitisation;
- distributor and manufacturer feed integration;
- POS connector setup and maintenance;

- product identifier and attribute clean-up;
- branch and location reconciliation;
- market roster digitisation;
- rights and content migration services.

75.2 Intelligence subscriptions

- merchant catalogue-health and freshness dashboard;
- demand-gap and missed-search reports;
- price and stock benchmarking with privacy-safe cohorts;
- brand stockist and distribution visibility;
- market and area opportunity reports;
- supplier discovery and B2B procurement intelligence;
- business-improvement recommendations.

75.3 Verified data and API products

- authorised product and branch feeds;
- current stockist and availability APIs;
- verified market and collection-point APIs;
- category and compatibility data services;
- aggregated demand and coverage APIs;
- campaign audience and outcome APIs under strict privacy controls.

API access should never bypass merchant rights, confidentiality or advertising integrity. High-value data products should be contracted, rate-limited, audited and designed to strengthen Shoppage's ecosystem rather than enable bulk replication of the graph.

76. Five-layer amendments

76.1 Shoppage Central

Central becomes the primary first-party evidence source. Merchant onboarding must create organisation, branch, location, catalogue, offer and rights records. Every merchant action should update evidence history, not overwrite truth without trace. Feed health, unmatched offers, stale items and review requests become daily merchant tasks.

76.2 Shoppage Showcase

Showcase must display confidence and freshness, not only relevance. Results should distinguish verified local availability, recently observed availability, preorder, out of stock and unknown. Search should prefer reliable current offers while still allowing users to inspect alternatives and uncertainty.

76.3 Shoppage Ads

Ads may promote only eligible entities and offers. Eligibility should include trust, rights, category safety, freshness and relevance floors. Advertisers should not be able to purchase visibility for an out-of-stock or unresolved product without a clearly labelled preorder or awareness objective.

76.4 Shoppage Creators

Creator content must tag canonical products, offers, vendors and markets. The platform must retain content rights, sponsor disclosure, attribution and offer state. When a price or stock state changes, the video should show the current state or a warning rather than preserve a misleading old claim.

76.5 Shoppage Markets

Market pages must distinguish discovery candidates from operator-verified structures. Market-in-market, building, section, store and stall relationships need explicit evidence. Market captains should own roster freshness, correction and escalation within defined authority.

77. Investor, government and public reporting controls

77.1 Investor data room

The investor data room should include:

- schema and architecture decisions;
- source inventory and licence register;
- validation outputs and reproducible build instructions;
- entity and offer definitions;
- sample provenance chains;
- data-quality and review metrics;
- false-merge and false-split evaluations;
- partnership agreements and rights summaries;
- security, privacy and incident controls;
- commercial coverage and cohort economics.

77.2 Metrics that must not be blended

Report separately:

- discovery candidates;
- resolved entities;
- legally or regulator-verified entities;
- merchant-claimed entities;
- active merchants and branches;
- global master products;
- local variants and offers;
- fresh offers;
- historical observations;
- verified outcomes;
- markets discovered, operator-verified and fully mapped.

This protects Shoppage from credibility loss and gives investors a clearer view of conversion from raw discovery to valuable production truth.

77.3 National reporting

Public-value reporting should focus on independently understandable outcomes:

- verified merchants digitised;
- branches and markets with current catalogues;
- Zimbabwean products and manufacturers discovered;
- buyer needs resolved;
- local advertising value retained;
- creator, agent and market-partner earnings;
- data quality and correction performance;
- geographic and category coverage;
- jobs and merchant sales improvements where evidence exists.

78. Critical risks revealed by the package

1. **Reference-scale illusion:** one million global products can create false confidence if local offers remain sparse.
2. **Launch-category mismatch:** the current million-product seed is food-focused, while the initial commercial wedge is non-food.
3. **Source concentration:** organisation candidates are heavily weighted toward OpenStreetMap discovery.
4. **Official-geography gap:** GeoNames scaffolding must be reconciled to ZIMSTAT authority.
5. **Market-parent uncertainty:** most current market-parent links are review candidates, not verified containment.
6. **Enrichment workload:** most global product records have at least one gap; commercial priority must govern review.
7. **Rights complexity:** descriptions, images, videos and bulk data cannot be assumed reusable.
8. **Human-review capacity:** the moat depends on disciplined resolution operations, not AI alone.
9. **Local-offer dependency:** merchant, distributor, POS and field partnerships are the decisive bottleneck.
10. **Prototype-to-production migration:** SQLite assets must be integrated into the PostgreSQL architecture with observability, security and tenancy controls.
11. **Freshness cost:** accurate stock and prices require merchant incentives, automation and enforcement.
12. **Overclaim risk:** national endorsement and investor trust can be damaged by presenting candidates as verified commerce truth.

79. Immediate decisions and next actions

1. Adopt the v0.4 package as the controlled technical seed for the Shoppage Commerce Intelligence Graph.
2. Freeze the entity-claim-evidence and product-family-master-variant-offer distinctions as architectural doctrine.
3. Make rights-cleared Zimbabwe offer acquisition the number-one commercial and data partnership workstream.
4. Prioritise non-food mastering for Home, Power and Building before broad global enrichment.
5. Deploy production ingestion, evidence, review, freshness and search services in PostgreSQL.
6. Establish source, licence and data-partnership registers before public scale.
7. Build review operations and gold-set evaluation alongside AI matching.
8. Reconcile official geography and market structures through ZIMSTAT, municipalities and operators.
9. Add coverage cells to the executive dashboard and expansion gates.
10. Publish only claims whose evidence state and scope can be explained.

80. Integrated decision

Proceed. The attached implementation materially strengthens the Shoppage business model because it establishes a reproducible evidence-graph foundation, not merely a directory or scraped catalogue. It also clarifies the hardest truth: the next defensible milestone is not another million reference rows. It is a dense, rights-cleared, fresh and verified Zimbabwe offer graph in selected categories and locations.

Shoppage should use the foundation to become the system that knows what exists, who sells it, where it is, which exact variant it is, whether it is available, how reliable the evidence is, what customers need and what merchants should improve. That is the intelligence advantage that ordinary Google searches, social feeds and copycat marketplaces will struggle to reproduce.

Part V - Transaction, Fulfilment and Merchant-Site Decisions

81. Executive decision: Shoppage controls the workflow, not regulated money or delivery assets

The transaction and fulfilment boundary is now locked.

Shoppage must own the buyer journey, order or request context, merchant terms, attribution, trust record and outcome evidence. It must not initially own customer funds, warehouses, delivery vehicles or national settlement risk.

This is not an off-platform model in the sense of losing the customer, data or commercial outcome. It is an **on-platform orchestration model with partner-executed regulated and asset-heavy services**.

The distinction is critical:

- Shoppage creates and preserves the commercial record.
- The merchant remains the seller and merchant of record unless a later, explicitly contracted model states otherwise.
- A licensed payment provider moves money and returns status to Shoppage.
- The merchant, buyer or approved fulfilment partner performs collection or delivery.
- Shoppage records milestones, proof, complaints, response and partner performance.
- Shoppage does not store card credentials, wallet PINs or pooled customer balances.
- Shoppage does not promise universal delivery where it does not control capacity.

This structure gives Shoppage practical control over conversion and intelligence without exposing the first six months to avoidable banking, custody, vehicle, warehousing, labour, fuel and loss risks.

81.1 Locked operating boundary

Function	Shoppage owns	External party executes
Discovery and intent	Search, video, product page, buyer request, quote, reservation and attribution	None
Commercial record	Basket or request, seller, branch, items, terms, price validity, fulfilment choice and status history	Merchant confirms commercial terms
Payment experience	Method presentation, payment initiation, reference, webhook status, receipt link and dispute case	Licensed provider processes and settles funds
Fulfilment experience	Options, quote request, partner selection, dispatch status, tracking, proof and service score	Merchant, buyer, courier, installer or collection point performs physical movement
Trust and redress	Identity, warnings, evidence, complaints, response deadlines, outcome history and ranking effects	Merchant, provider and partner supply evidence and remedies within their legal scope

Function	Shoppage owns	External party executes
Financial liability	Platform fees, advertising and contracted service obligations	Seller bears product-sale obligations; provider bears regulated payment obligations; carrier bears contracted delivery obligations

81.2 Why not fully off-platform

A simple WhatsApp handoff followed by invisible payment and delivery would preserve neither the outcome moat nor customer protection. Shoppage would know that a click occurred but not whether the merchant responded, the price changed, payment succeeded, the parcel arrived or the buyer was satisfied.

Therefore, Shoppage must maintain a lightweight but complete transaction envelope even when execution happens elsewhere. Every meaningful conversion should create a persistent record with:

- buyer or anonymous session reference;
- merchant and branch;
- product, variant or service;
- quoted price, currency and validity;
- quantity and relevant specifications;
- selected payment method;
- selected fulfilment method;
- status timeline;
- evidence and communication references;
- complaint or cancellation state;
- final outcome and attribution.

The transaction envelope is a core intelligence asset. It connects discovery, advertising, creator activity, merchant behaviour, payment choice, delivery performance and buyer outcomes.

82. Payment architecture decision

82.1 Final decision

Payments should be **visible and initiated inside Shoppage but processed and settled by licensed external providers** for at least the 0-6 month implementation period.

Shoppage should not launch its own wallet, hold customer money, pool merchant settlements or become an unlicensed payment intermediary. The platform should integrate several rails through provider adapters and hosted or tokenised flows.

Zimbabwe already has local online-payment infrastructure that can support partner processing. Zimswitch publicly offers Zimswitch Online and recurring-payment services, and describes itself as the national electronic funds switch and clearing house designated by the Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe. Paynow publicly offers merchant services and e-commerce solutions. These should be treated as procurement and integration candidates, not as permanent exclusive dependencies.

82.2 Payment methods to support

Method	0-3 month treatment	4-6 month treatment
Cash at collection	Merchant declares acceptance; buyer receives collection terms; merchant confirms outcome	Collection code and merchant confirmation with fraud controls

Method	0-3 month treatment	4-6 month treatment
Cash on delivery	Only where merchant or delivery partner accepts responsibility	Partner status, proof and failed-delivery reason captured
Mobile money	Payment instructions or hosted provider flow; no PIN collection by Shoppage	Provider API or hosted checkout with signed status webhook
Bank / ZIPIT transfer	Merchant bank details or provider-generated reference; buyer can submit proof	Automated reference matching where partner APIs permit
Card	Hosted checkout or provider page; no raw card data enters Shoppage	Tokenised or hosted single-vendor checkout with provider status
Pay-by-link	Merchant or Shoppage-generated provider link attached to order or quote	Unified status and reconciliation dashboard
Deposit	Merchant-defined deposit amount and terms; clear risk warning	Integrated deposit flow for approved categories and merchants
Protected payment / escrow	Not offered as a Shoppage-held service	Limited pilot only through a regulated partner with explicit terms

82.3 Merchant-of-record rule

For normal marketplace and lead flows, the vendor remains the merchant of record. The vendor controls product legality, pricing, tax treatment, warranties, refunds, stock and fulfilment promises. Shoppage supplies the platform, advertising, workflow and evidence layer.

This rule must be visible in contracts, checkout copy, receipts and dispute procedures. Shoppage should not accidentally become the seller merely because its interface initiated a payment.

Exceptions should require a separate approved business model, such as a future Shoppage-managed procurement service or a contracted diaspora concierge. Those exceptions need distinct terms, accounting, insurance and consumer-protection controls.

82.4 Checkout design

The practical sequence is:

1. The buyer selects a product, quote or reservation.
2. Shoppage verifies the current merchant, branch, price-validity and fulfilment state.
3. The buyer selects payment and fulfilment methods.
4. Shoppage creates a single-vendor order or transaction intent.
5. The payment provider receives only the fields necessary to process payment.
6. The provider returns a signed success, pending, failed or expired status.
7. Shoppage updates the transaction envelope and notifies merchant and buyer.
8. Fulfilment begins only under the merchant or partner's approved rules.

9. Outcome, refund, cancellation or complaint remains linked to the original record.

82.5 Multi-vendor basket rule

Shoppage may allow a customer to save products from several merchants in one planning basket, but the first transaction implementation should split checkout into separate merchant orders. This avoids pooled settlement, split refunds, cross-merchant delivery promises and unclear merchant-of-record responsibility.

A universal multi-vendor cart should not be built before Shoppage has:

- reliable stock reservation;
- provider-supported split settlement;
- merchant payout and reconciliation controls;
- returns and partial-refund capability;
- fraud and chargeback operations;
- clear tax and contractual treatment;
- enough transaction volume to justify the complexity.

82.6 Payment data and security

Shoppage should store:

- payment provider;
- provider transaction reference;
- method category;
- amount and currency;
- status and timestamp;
- signed callback verification result;
- refund or reversal status;
- merchant reconciliation state;
- evidence and dispute links.

Shoppage should not store:

- full card numbers;
- CVV values;
- mobile-money PINs;
- online-banking passwords;
- provider secrets in client applications;
- unencrypted payment evidence containing unnecessary personal data.

82.7 Payment revenue

Payment should not be treated as the primary early revenue engine. Subscriptions, ads, onboarding, managed campaigns and qualified demand remain stronger 0-3 month revenue products.

Later revenue may include:

- disclosed convenience or orchestration fee;
- contracted payment-provider referral share;
- transaction commission where Shoppage materially controls conversion;
- protected-payment fee through a regulated partner;
- reconciliation and payment-automation subscription for merchants.

Fees must remain transparent and must not make the local platform more expensive than the value it creates.

83. Fulfilment and last-mile decision

83.1 Final decision

Fulfilment should be **partner-led and merchant-led, but orchestrated and measured by Shoppage**.

Shoppage should not buy a fleet, operate a warehouse or promise national same-day delivery during the first six months.

The platform should establish a **Shoppage Fulfilment Network**. This is a software, standards and partner network - not an owned courier company.

83.2 Supported fulfilment modes

Fulfilment mode	Best use	Shoppage role
Buyer collection	High-trust local purchases, bulky items and cash transactions	Verify branch, hours, reservation, collection code and outcome
Merchant delivery	Furniture, appliances, building materials and vendors with own vehicles	Capture zone, charge, lead time, status and proof
Courier partner	Small parcels and predictable urban routes	Quote, assign, track, receive proof and score service
Market collection point	Dense markets, informal addresses and consolidated routes	Verify point, custody handoff, hours and collection confirmation
Installer fulfilment	Solar, electrical, plumbing and home-improvement services	Schedule assessment, installation, proof and workmanship feedback
Long-distance transport partner	Intercity parcels and diaspora-supported purchases	Record handoff, route, collection point, recipient and proof
Customer-arranged transport	Bulk goods or specialised haulage	Preserve quote and terms; label responsibility clearly

83.3 Category-specific fulfilment

Shoppage must not force one parcel model across all categories.

Home, power and building

- Solar systems often require assessment, installation and commissioning rather than simple parcel delivery.
- Building materials require quantity confirmation, loading, vehicle type, distance, access and offloading terms.
- Furniture and appliances need dimensions, handling, floor access, assembly and damage evidence.
- Electrical and plumbing items may be collected, couriered or bundled with an installer.

The product model must therefore distinguish delivery, installation, collection, haulage and service fulfilment.

Small parcels and electronics

Small items can use standard partner rates, scheduled pickup, tracking and proof. Shoppage can automate this category earlier because dimensions, weight and route are more predictable.

Informal markets

Market collection points and market captains can reduce failed navigation and create trusted handoff locations. A stall is not automatically a secure collection point; the operator, custody process and opening hours must be verified.

83.4 0-3 month fulfilment scope

Build:

- merchant-declared fulfilment methods;
- collection, delivery and installation flags;
- delivery zones and indicative charges;
- request-a-delivery-quote workflow;
- partner directory and service-area records;
- reservation and collection reference;
- manual status updates;
- proof upload for collection, delivery or installation;
- complaint and failed-fulfilment reasons;
- partner and merchant performance metrics.

Do not build:

- route optimisation for an owned fleet;
- warehouse management;
- national dispatch control;
- universal real-time pricing;
- Shoppage-employed drivers;
- unconditional delivery guarantees.

83.5 4-6 month fulfilment scope

Pilot in Harare:

- courier and merchant-delivery adapters;
- structured rate cards and quote comparison;
- pickup scheduling;
- dispatch and status webhooks;
- proof of delivery or collection;
- failed-attempt reason codes;
- recipient confirmation;
- selected verified pickup points;
- partner SLA scorecards;
- claims workflow;
- category-specific delivery and installation templates.

83.6 When owned capacity may be considered

Owned vehicles or warehousing should remain an exception. Before approval, management must show:

- sustained route density in a defined zone;
- partner failure or pricing that materially harms conversion;
- positive contribution after vehicles, drivers, fuel, maintenance, insurance, losses, supervision and idle time;
- category-specific demand that cannot be served through contracted capacity;
- regulatory and insurance readiness;
- a separate P&L and stop condition.

Even then, contracted dedicated routes or franchise capacity should be tested before fleet ownership. Shoppage's main competitive advantage is commerce intelligence and orchestration, not vehicle ownership.

83.7 Fulfilment intelligence moat

Every fulfilment event should improve the graph:

- actual delivery coverage by merchant and partner;
- real lead times by route and category;
- failed-delivery and address-friction patterns;
- collection-point reliability;
- damage and complaint rates;
- installation availability and quality;
- cost-to-serve by area;
- preferred fulfilment method by customer segment;
- demand corridors and underserved areas.

This intelligence will eventually allow Shoppage to recommend the best fulfilment method rather than merely listing options.

84. Merchant website strategy

84.1 Final decision

Every merchant should receive a **Shoppage Merchant Site** as part of Shoppage Central. For most small and medium merchants, this should be sufficient to act as their official reference website.

The merchant site is not a disposable marketplace profile. It should be a high-quality, indexable, shareable, domain-capable commercial website connected to the live Shoppage graph.

The default structure should support:

- `shoppage.co.zw/merchant-name` or an equivalent stable path;
- optional `merchant-name.shoppage.co.zw` subdomain;
- custom domain connection on paid plans;
- organisation and trust profile;
- branches, maps, hours and contact methods;
- products, families, variants and current offers;
- services and capability pages;
- short videos and collections;
- delivery, collection and payment methods;
- policies, warranties and FAQs;
- RFQ, reservation, lead and checkout actions;
- structured data for search engines;
- low-data and accessible rendering;
- merchant analytics and export.

84.2 Shoppage as the merchant's reference website

The Merchant Site should be the canonical commercial source for merchants that do not have their own website. It gives the market one current reference for:

- what the merchant is;
- where it operates;
- what it sells;
- which variants are available;

- what prices or price rules apply;
- how buyers can pay, collect or request delivery;
- what evidence and trust state applies;
- how the merchant should be contacted.

This strengthens Shoppage's information moat because merchant updates feed the national graph directly instead of remaining trapped in isolated websites or social posts.

84.3 Merchants that already have websites

Shoppage should not force capable merchants to abandon existing websites. Instead, it should support three modes:

Merchant situation	Recommended mode	Data rule
No website	Shoppage Merchant Site is the official reference site	Shoppage Central is the source of truth
Weak or outdated website	Replace or redirect to a Shoppage Merchant Site with custom domain	Catalogue and merchant data remain in Shoppage
Strong existing website	Connect by feed, API, import or embed; keep Shoppage as verified commerce node	One agreed system controls each field to avoid conflicting truth

Useful integrations include:

- product and offer feeds;
- “available on Shoppage” badges;
- stock or quote widgets;
- verified-location and review widgets;
- creator and video embeds;
- Shoppage Ads conversion events;
- merchant-site links back to the full Shoppage marketplace.

84.4 Site ownership and portability

Merchants should retain rights to their original brand assets and first-party business content. Contracts should grant Shoppage the rights needed to display, distribute and improve that content while the service is active.

To build trust and reduce lock-in objections, paid merchants should be able to export appropriate catalogue, lead and content data subject to privacy, third-party rights and platform-security restrictions. Portability does not require exposing Shoppage's derived intelligence, fraud models, rankings or network-wide graph.

84.5 Why Merchant Sites are strategically important

Merchant Sites:

- create immediate standalone merchant value before marketplace traffic is large;
- replace low-quality or absent websites;
- improve search-engine acquisition while reducing long-term dependence on Google and Facebook;
- give every QR code, video and advertisement a stable destination;
- keep catalogue, trust, payment and fulfilment data synchronized;
- create recurring subscription value;
- generate first-party behaviour and conversion evidence;
- make Shoppage useful to formal and informal merchants without separate software procurement.

85. Pemosites decision

85.1 Final decision

Use **both** Shoppage Merchant Sites and Pemosites, but do not build them as competing systems and do not create a separate operating company during the 0-3 month launch.

The recommended structure is:

- **Shoppage Merchant Sites:** native, standardized commercial sites included in Shoppage Central.
- **Pemosites:** an optional premium website-creation and managed-web product, powered by the Shoppage data and identity layer.

Pemosites may use a separate brand and later a separate P&L. It should initially remain a product line, division or wholly owned brand rather than an independent company with duplicated technology, sales, support and data.

85.2 Pemosites purpose

Pemosites is for organisations that need more than a marketplace-linked merchant site, including:

- corporate and institutional websites;
- richer service-business websites;
- custom brand presentation;
- editorial pages, news and resources;
- careers and application forms;
- bookings and enquiries;
- multiple languages;
- custom domain and email setup;
- managed content, photography and SEO;
- integrations beyond Shoppage commerce.

It can serve businesses outside Shoppage's initial retail categories while still connecting eligible commerce data back to Shoppage.

85.3 One data core, two experiences

Pemosites must not create a second merchant, product or offer database. The architecture should be:

- Shoppage controls organisation, branch, product, offer, trust, payment-method and fulfilment records.
- Pemosites controls page layout, editorial content, theme, navigation, forms and premium web services.
- Shared identities and permissions prevent duplicate logins and contradictory records.
- Pemosites consumes Shoppage APIs and events.
- Updates to a product, branch or offer propagate to both the Shoppage marketplace and the merchant's Pemosites website.
- Pemosites-specific pages do not automatically become national commerce claims unless they pass Shoppage evidence rules.

85.4 Commercial model for Pemosites

Potential products:

Package	Customer	Revenue model
Launch site	Small business needing a credible web presence	Setup fee plus monthly hosting/support

Package	Customer	Revenue model
Commerce site	Merchant needing custom branding around Shoppage catalogue	Subscription plus theme, domain and integration fee
Managed growth site	Business needing content, SEO and campaigns	Monthly retainer with defined deliverables
Corporate site	Larger organisation needing custom structure and governance	Project fee plus support agreement
Market or association site	Commercial cluster needing public site plus Shoppage market data	Setup, subscription and sponsorship tools

85.5 0-3 month Pemosites scope

Do not launch a general Wix or WordPress competitor. Build the shared site engine required for Shoppage Merchant Sites:

- responsive templates;
- page and section blocks;
- merchant profile pages;
- product and service pages;
- custom domain mapping;
- navigation and policy pages;
- lead and form components;
- analytics;
- SEO and structured data;
- safe media management;
- theme variables;
- preview and publish workflow.

This produces the technical foundation for Pemosites without distracting the launch.

85.6 4-6 month Pemosites pilot

Pilot Pemosites with 10-20 businesses that have clear requirements beyond the standard Merchant Site. Measure:

- setup time;
- monthly support hours;
- gross margin;
- retention;
- content-update frequency;
- lead and search performance;
- demand for custom design;
- overlap with Shoppage plans;
- engineering distraction;
- willingness to pay.

A separate company or full spinout should be considered only when Pemosites has:

- at least 100 paying sites or equivalent contracted annual revenue;
- a repeatable acquisition channel;

- standardized delivery rather than bespoke agency work;
- sustainable gross margin;
- a distinct customer and product strategy;
- clean data, IP, support and cross-selling agreements with Shoppage.

85.7 Brand and governance rule

The market must understand that:

- Shoppage is the national commerce network and intelligence platform.
- A Shoppage Merchant Site is the standard commercial website inside that network.
- Pemosites is the optional premium website-building service.

Pemosites must not dilute Shoppage's marketplace brand or create uncertainty about where catalogue truth lives.

86. Implementation changes arising from these decisions

86.1 Additional 0-3 month modules

Add the following to the implementation backlog:

Transaction orchestration

- transaction intent and single-vendor order model;
- quote-to-order and reservation-to-order conversion;
- payment-method registry;
- payment provider adapter interface;
- hosted payment initiation;
- signed webhook verification;
- payment status and reference history;
- merchant confirmation for cash and bank-transfer outcomes;
- cancellation and complaint states;
- reconciliation export.

Fulfilment orchestration

- fulfilment option and zone model;
- collection point and hours;
- delivery or installation quote request;
- fulfilment partner and service-area records;
- manual dispatch and status timeline;
- proof and recipient confirmation;
- failed-attempt reasons;
- partner and merchant scorecards.

Merchant Sites

- stable merchant URLs and subdomains;
- custom-domain capability;
- site theme and layout configuration;
- profile, branch, catalogue, offer, video, policy and contact pages;
- SEO metadata and structured data;
- lead, RFQ, reservation and payment components;
- analytics and conversion events;
- export and redirect controls.

86.2 Data-model additions

Entity	Purpose	Important relationships
TransactionIntent	Preserves commercial context before payment	Buyer/session, merchant, branch, items, quote, campaign and creator
MerchantOrder	Single-vendor confirmed commercial record	Transaction intent, payment attempts, fulfilment and disputes
PaymentAttempt	Records provider initiation and status without sensitive credentials	Order, provider, amount, currency, reference and webhook events
FulfilmentOption	Defines collection, merchant delivery, courier, installer or other method	Merchant, branch, category, zone, charge and service level
FulfilmentJob	Tracks physical or service execution	Order, provider, pickup, recipient, status and proof
CollectionPoint	Verified handoff location	Place, market, operator, hours, custody rules and coverage
MerchantSite	Website identity and publication configuration	Organisation, domain, theme, pages and analytics
SitePage	Editorial or functional page	Merchant site, content blocks, rights and publication history
ProviderAccount	Merchant relationship with payment or fulfilment provider	Organisation, credentials reference, capabilities and status

86.3 Revised roadmap decision gates

Gate	Required evidence
Payment pilot	Provider contract, legal review, secure hosted flow, signed callbacks, reconciliation and failure handling
Cash/deposit flow	Clear responsibility, warnings, merchant confirmation, complaint path and category policy
Delivery partner pilot	Coverage, rate logic, insurance/liability terms, status method, proof and claims process
Pickup-point activation	Verified operator, custody procedure, hours, security and failed-collection process
Custom-domain launch	Domain verification, TLS, redirect policy, ownership dispute process and fallback URL
Pemosites pilot	Shared data core, separate scope, pricing, support capacity and no duplicated catalogue truth

86.4 Investor interpretation

These decisions make the model more investable because they concentrate capital on the differentiating assets:

- commerce intelligence;
- merchant operating software;
- verified local supply;
- buyer demand;
- advertising attribution;
- trust and outcome history;
- creator and market distribution;
- merchant sites and recurring software revenue.

They avoid premature capital concentration in:

- regulated custody;
- fleet ownership;
- warehousing;
- inventory risk;
- multi-vendor settlement;
- bespoke website-agency labour.

86.5 Final decision statement

Shoppage will be the system of record and orchestration layer for Zimbabwean commerce. Payments will be integrated but processed by licensed providers. Fulfilment will be coordinated and measured but performed by merchants, buyers and verified partners. Every merchant receives a high-quality Shoppage Merchant Site. Pemosites will be a premium, shared-core website product introduced after the Shoppage launch, not a duplicated platform or separate company on day one.

This boundary is practical for the 0-3 month implementation window, creates strong data and trust moats, supports a credible 4-6 month expansion, and preserves the option to deepen transactions or fulfilment only when density, regulation and economics justify it.

86.6 Additional sources for this decision

- Zimswitch official website - online payments, recurring payments, business services and national-switch role: <https://zimswitch.co.zw/>
- Paynow official website - merchant services and e-commerce payment solutions: <https://www.paynow.co.zw/>
- Shoppage Commerce Intelligence Foundation v0.4 and implementation progress report - evidence graph, local-offer boundary, merchant-offer ingestion and provenance controls.

Part VI - Shoppage Platform Framework and Ecosystem Architecture

87. Executive decision: Shoppage becomes a commerce operating framework

The strategic direction is now expanded beyond a single marketplace or a fixed portfolio of five products.

Shoppage will be built as a reusable national commerce operating framework on which Shoppage-owned products, subsidiaries, independent companies, market operators, creators, software providers and institutional partners can build specialised business models.

The public product family remains:

- Shoppage Central;
- Shoppage Showcase;
- Shoppage Ads;
- Shoppage Creators; and
- Shoppage Markets.

Under those public layers sits a shared infrastructure layer called the **Shoppage Framework**, also described operationally as the **Shoppage Commerce OS**. The framework contains the identity, organisation, place, product, offer, trust, search, advertising, transaction, fulfilment, intelligence, AI and audit capabilities required by the public products and by approved extensions.

The purpose is not to turn Shoppage into an unfocused conglomerate. The purpose is to ensure that a new commerce venture does not repeatedly rebuild merchant identity, product data, locations, payments, delivery workflows, search, verification, analytics and AI from zero.

A specialised business should be able to launch by composing existing Shoppage capabilities and adding only its differentiated domain logic.

Examples include:

- a construction-procurement network using Shoppage organisations, products, requests, quotes, trust and fulfilment;
- a premium website business such as Pemosites using Shoppage merchant identity, catalogue, media, branches, leads and analytics;
- a market-operator application using Shoppage places, stalls, merchants, events, ads and visitor intelligence;
- a distributor ordering portal using Shoppage products, variants, branches, stock, pricing and merchant accounts;
- a creator-led vertical storefront using Shoppage media, affiliate attribution, product tagging and payouts;
- a logistics partner application using Shoppage delivery requests, routes, proof and service scores;
- a diaspora procurement service using Shoppage verification, quotes, payment-provider integrations and fulfilment evidence.

87.1 The central platform principle

The framework should make it easy to create new value while making it difficult to fragment the core.

Every approved product or business built on Shoppage must reuse common records wherever they exist:

- one organisation identity;
- one branch and place graph;
- one canonical product and variant graph;

- one merchant-offer and availability model;
- one trust and reputation history;
- one event and attribution language;
- one permission system;
- one evidence and provenance model;
- one payment-orchestration boundary;
- one fulfilment-orchestration boundary;
- one analytics and AI-governance standard.

A subsidiary may own a customer experience, operating team, brand, revenue stream and domain-specific workflows. It must not silently create a competing merchant database, product catalogue, identity system, trust score or transaction record.

87.2 Why this strengthens defensibility

Competitors may recreate a storefront, classified listing page, short-video feed or ad dashboard. They will find it materially harder to recreate a platform where every additional company, plugin and subsidiary increases the completeness and usefulness of the same evidence-backed commerce graph.

The compounding loop becomes:

1. Shoppage acquires verified merchants, places, products and demand.
2. A product or partner uses those assets to serve a specialised need.
3. Its operations produce new authorised observations, outcomes and relationships.
4. The shared graph becomes more complete and accurate.
5. Search, recommendations, risk models, advertising and merchant advice improve.
6. The framework becomes more attractive to the next partner or subsidiary.
7. Launch cost and time decline while switching cost and information advantage rise.

This is a stronger moat than a collection of isolated applications.

88. Framework architecture

88.1 Five architectural planes

The Shoppage Framework should be designed in five planes.

Plane	Purpose	Examples
Commerce kernel	Canonical records and rules that must remain consistent	Organisations, branches, places, products, variants, offers, identities, permissions, evidence and audit
Shared platform services	Reusable operational capabilities	Search, media, messaging, trust, ads, leads, requests, payments, fulfilment, billing, analytics and AI
Extension layer	Stable interfaces through which new capabilities connect	APIs, webhooks, SDKs, event contracts, data connectors, provider adapters and plugin runtime

Plane	Purpose	Examples
Experience layer	User-facing products and vertical applications	Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators, Markets, Pemosites and approved verticals
Ecosystem and governance	Commercial, security and quality rules for participants	Developer portal, certification, revenue share, privacy, support, dispute and termination controls

88.2 Commerce kernel

The kernel is the most protected part of Shoppage. It should be modular in code but centrally governed in semantics.

The kernel includes:

- person and account identity;
- merchant and organisation identity;
- legal entity, trading name, branch and facility relationships;
- country, province, city, suburb, market, building, section, store and stall hierarchy;
- global master product, product family, variant and compatibility relationships;
- merchant-specific offer, price, stock state, service area and validity;
- evidence, source, licence, review and confidence state;
- roles, permissions, consent and data-purpose controls;
- immutable event and change history;
- trust cases, complaints, responses and outcomes;
- canonical currency, unit, category and attribute dictionaries.

No plugin should directly mutate kernel data without passing through validated domain services. The objective is not central bureaucracy; it is data integrity.

88.3 Shared platform services

The initial service catalogue should include:

Service	Reusable capability	Primary users
Identity and access	Registration, authentication, organisation membership, roles, consent and delegated access	Every Shoppage product and partner
Commerce graph	Entity lookup, relationship traversal, evidence, history and resolution	Search, intelligence, verticals and integrations
Catalogue and offers	Product matching, merchant listings, variants, price, stock, branch and freshness	Merchants, marketplaces, websites and procurement tools
Place intelligence	Geo hierarchy, nearby search, delivery zones, market containment and branch discovery	Central, Markets, fulfilment and partner apps

Service	Reusable capability	Primary users
Search and discovery	Keyword, semantic, faceted, geo and recommendation services	Showcase, merchant sites and vertical applications
Media and content	Images, short video, documents, moderation, transformations and product tagging	Showcase, Creators, Ads, Pemosites and merchants
Trust and safety	Verification, reports, risk signals, review evidence, disputes and enforcement	All transaction and discovery products
Leads and requests	Enquiries, RFQs, reservations, buyer needs, routing, response and outcome tracking	Central, verticals, creators and markets
Advertising	Campaigns, targeting, inventory, auction or rule-based allocation, attribution and billing	Ads, partner publishers and verticals
Creator and affiliate	Creator identity, tagged products, links, attribution, disclosure and earnings	Creators, merchants and subsidiaries
Payment orchestration	Method presentation, provider initiation, status, receipt and reconciliation reference	Merchant sites, procurement and transaction products
Fulfilment orchestration	Delivery options, quotes, dispatch, tracking, proof and service performance	Merchants, partners and verticals
Billing and entitlements	Plans, usage, limits, invoices, revenue share and partner settlement records	Shoppage and ecosystem businesses
Analytics and intelligence	Events, funnels, dashboards, benchmarks, demand and merchant advice	Merchants, brands, markets, investors and partners
AI platform	Model gateway, prompts, retrieval, grounding, evaluation, cost, privacy and human review	Every AI-assisted workflow
Notification and communication	Email, SMS, push, WhatsApp-compatible handoff, templates and preference controls	Buyers, merchants, creators and operations

88.4 Experience composition

A new application should compose platform capabilities rather than fork the platform.

A market-insurance referral product, for example, may need:

- organisation and merchant identity;

- market and branch relationships;
- consent and verification;
- risk-relevant operational evidence;
- lead generation;
- a regulated partner adapter;
- status and attribution;
- privacy-safe analytics.

It should not build a new market directory and identity database solely for insurance referrals.

89. Extension and plugin model

89.1 Extension types

Shoppage should support six extension patterns.

Extension type	Description	Example
First-party module	Capability built and operated by the Shoppage core team	Search, Ads, trust, payment orchestration
First-party vertical	Specialised product using the core but operated as a business line	Construction procurement or diaspora buying
Subsidiary application	Separately managed company in the group licensing the framework	A mature Pemosites or logistics-coordination business
Certified partner plugin	External software integrated through approved APIs and contracts	POS connector, accounting connector or courier adapter
Powered-by-Shoppage application	Independent company builds a customer product on the framework	Mall application, distributor portal or sector marketplace
White-label deployment	Approved institution receives a branded experience on shared infrastructure	Market association or regional trade platform

89.2 Plugin categories

The first plugin catalogue should prioritise practical connectors rather than decorative add-ons.

- POS and inventory connectors.
- ERP, accounting and invoicing connectors.
- Supplier and distributor feeds.
- Payment-provider adapters.
- Courier and fulfilment adapters.
- Mapping, address and geocoding providers.
- Identity and business-verification services.
- SMS, email and messaging providers.
- Merchant-site themes and content blocks.
- Booking and appointment modules.
- Quote calculators and sector-specific configurators.
- Product compatibility and specification modules.

- Creator attribution and campaign tools.
- Analytics, reporting and export connectors.
- Tax, receipt and compliance tools.
- Customer support and CRM connectors.
- AI extraction, translation, moderation and recommendation providers.
- Market access, stall, event and visitor-management tools.

89.3 API and event principles

The developer surface should be API-first but not database-first.

Approved developers access domain capabilities through:

- versioned REST APIs for standard business operations;
- webhooks for state changes and partner callbacks;
- event contracts for high-volume or asynchronous integration;
- import and export specifications for merchant-controlled bulk data;
- JavaScript and TypeScript SDKs first, followed by other languages where demand exists;
- embeddable widgets for catalogue, search, product, branch, video and enquiry experiences;
- OAuth-based delegated access for merchant-authorized applications;
- service credentials for contracted server-to-server integrations;
- sandbox tenants, test data and simulated provider responses.

Direct production database access should not be a normal integration method.

89.4 Required developer capabilities

The 4-6 month developer portal should provide:

- application registration;
- API credentials and secret rotation;
- scopes and merchant consent;
- environment separation;
- interactive API documentation;
- schema and changelog publication;
- webhook registration and replay;
- usage and error dashboards;
- rate-limit visibility;
- test merchants, products, offers and orders;
- plugin submission and certification workflow;
- security contact and vulnerability disclosure;
- status and incident communication;
- billing and revenue-share reports where applicable.

89.5 Plugin lifecycle

Every plugin moves through a controlled lifecycle.

1. **Development:** isolated sandbox with synthetic or authorised test data.
2. **Technical review:** contracts, retries, idempotency, error handling and security checked.
3. **Data review:** fields, purposes, retention and rights approved.
4. **Operational review:** support owner, incident path and termination behaviour defined.
5. **Limited pilot:** small merchant or partner cohort with feature flags.
6. **Certification:** published availability with capability and risk labels.

7. **Monitoring:** reliability, complaints, misuse and commercial performance reviewed.

8. **Renewal or removal:** certification renewed, restricted or revoked.

89.6 Certification levels

Level	Meaning	Permitted use
Experimental	Early integration with no production guarantee	Internal or invited pilot only
Verified	Identity and basic technical requirements confirmed	Limited production with visible caveats
Certified	Security, data, reliability and support standards passed	General marketplace distribution
Strategic	Deeply integrated partner with contractual service levels and joint operating plan	Critical payment, fulfilment, data or national-scale services

90. Subsidiary and venture-studio model

90.1 Strategic purpose

The framework allows Shoppage to incubate specialised businesses without weakening the core company.

A subsidiary should exist only where separate management, capital, regulation, liability, partnerships or economics create a real advantage. A new brand is not sufficient justification.

90.2 Recommended corporate architecture

Subject to legal, tax and regulatory advice, the long-term group structure should distinguish platform IP from operating ventures.

Entity	Primary responsibility	What it owns or controls
Shoppage Holdings	Group governance, capital allocation, trademarks and subsidiary ownership	Group equity and strategic control
Shoppage PlatformCo	Core software, commerce graph, APIs, AI platform, developer ecosystem and licensing	Platform IP, shared schemas, core contracts and platform operations
Shoppage Zimbabwe OperatingCo	Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators, Markets and local merchant/buyer operations	Zimbabwe operating relationships, sales, support and local execution
Approved subsidiaries	Distinct vertical products with their own P&L and accountable leadership	Domain workflows, customer proposition and contracted operating assets
External powered partners	Independent companies using APIs or white-label services	Their own business, customers and domain-specific IP subject to platform terms

This structure should not be implemented prematurely if it creates cost and administrative burden. During months 0-6, the group can operate through one company with internal cost centres, IP registers and clear

product accounts. The structure becomes relevant when fundraising, regulation, liability, partner ownership or a proven subsidiary business justifies separation.

90.3 Subsidiary admission tests

A proposed subsidiary must pass all of the following tests.

- It serves a distinct customer problem with a coherent proposition.
- It can show a credible route to independent revenue or strategic value.
- At least 60-70% of its non-domain infrastructure can reuse the Shoppage Framework.
- It does not fragment merchant, product, place, trust or outcome data.
- It has a named accountable leader and measurable P&L.
- It has explicit data, IP, brand and platform-licence agreements.
- Its liabilities and regulatory obligations are understood.
- Its existence improves focus or capital access rather than merely increasing organisational complexity.
- It has a stop, merge or reintegration condition.

90.4 Venture maturity stages

Stage	Operating form	Evidence required
Concept	Product brief inside PlatformCo or OperatingCo	Problem evidence, core reuse map and risk review
Incubated module	Feature-flagged internal product	Working workflow and early user value
Business line	Dedicated owner and internal P&L	Repeat use, revenue signal and support process
Subsidiary candidate	Separate governance and investment case	Distinct economics, leadership and legal rationale
Subsidiary	Contracted platform licence and group controls	Board approval, capital plan, audits and service agreements
Externalisation or partnership	Licensed, joint venture or strategic partner model	Better economics or capability than internal ownership

90.5 Initial subsidiary or vertical candidates

These are options, not 0-3 month commitments.

Candidate	Core capabilities reused	Distinct value
Pemosites	Merchant identity, catalogue, media, branches, forms, leads and analytics	Premium business websites and managed digital presence
Shoppage Procurement	Organisations, RFQs, products, suppliers, trust, quotes and fulfilment	B2B and institutional purchasing
Shoppage Build	Products, specifications, compatibility, installers, requests and delivery	Construction and home-improvement commerce
Shoppage Agri	Input catalogues, seasons, locations, suppliers, buyers and delivery	Agricultural input and market coordination

Candidate	Core capabilities reused	Distinct value
Shoppage Services	Provider identity, availability, quotes, bookings, proof and reviews	Local services and installation marketplace
Shoppage Diaspora	Merchant verification, gifting, procurement, payments and proof	Remote purchasing for Zimbabwean households and projects
Shoppage Logistics Exchange	Delivery requests, routes, partner identity, quotes and proof	Coordination layer for approved fulfilment providers
Shoppage Market Systems	Places, stalls, merchants, events, ads, access and analytics	Digital operating tools for physical markets and malls
Shoppage Brand Intelligence	Search, demand, price, stock and campaign data	Privacy-safe market intelligence for brands and distributors
Shoppage Export Gateway	Product evidence, supplier identity, compliance documents and enquiries	Discoverability and lead support for export-ready merchants

No health, financial, insurance, transport or other regulated subsidiary should launch without a domain-specific regulatory decision and licensed partners.

91. Ecosystem commercial model

91.1 Framework revenue streams

The platform framework adds revenue that is distinct from ordinary marketplace subscriptions and advertising.

Revenue stream	Customer	Charging basis
Platform licence	Subsidiary, white-label operator or powered partner	Fixed licence plus usage or revenue component
API usage	Software provider, brand, distributor or institution	Included allowance, volume tier or contracted capacity
Plugin marketplace share	Plugin developer and merchant	Percentage of subscription or transaction revenue
Integration services	Enterprise merchant or partner	Setup, data migration, custom connector and support fees
Managed hosting and operations	White-label or institutional deployment	Monthly platform and service fee
Data and intelligence products	Brands, distributors, markets and institutions	Subscription, report, dashboard or research engagement
Certification and assurance	Integration providers	Cost-recovery review and renewal fee, not pay-to-pass

Revenue stream	Customer	Charging basis
Transaction orchestration	Approved transaction products	Transparent fee or revenue share where permitted
Advertising inventory federation	Partner publishers and verticals	Revenue share based on attributable delivery and outcomes
AI service usage	High-volume partners or subsidiaries	Usage, seat or capability bundle

91.2 Revenue-share principles

Ecosystem economics must reward contribution without encouraging fraud or low-quality volume.

Revenue shares may consider:

- who acquired the merchant or buyer;
- who produced the content;
- who supplied the verified data;
- who delivered the advertising inventory;
- who generated the qualified action;
- who performed regulated payment or delivery execution;
- who carried support, refund or dispute obligations;
- whether the outcome was validated.

The platform must publish the attribution rule for each programme. Hidden discretionary payouts will undermine creator, developer and partner trust.

91.3 Subsidiary transfer pricing

Each subsidiary or internal business line should pay or be allocated a transparent platform charge covering:

- shared cloud and infrastructure;
- identity and security;
- core development;
- data operations;
- AI and media usage;
- trust and safety;
- finance, legal and group services;
- brand and distribution benefits.

This makes subsidiary economics credible to investors and prevents a weak business from appearing profitable by consuming free platform resources.

91.4 Merchant and user pricing protection

The ecosystem must not create a stack of overlapping fees that makes Shoppage more expensive than the platforms it seeks to displace.

Rules:

- merchants should see the total cost before enabling a plugin;
- overlapping platform and plugin charges must be disclosed;
- core functions cannot be silently removed and resold through compulsory plugins;
- cancellation and data export should be practical;
- revenue-share arrangements should not bias organic search without disclosure;
- sponsored distribution must remain labelled;

- high switching costs should result from accumulated value and workflow integration, not data hostage practices.

92. Data, rights and intelligence-sharing model

92.1 One graph, controlled views

The framework should operate one canonical commerce graph but provide different authorised views.

A market operator may see its merchants, spaces, events and aggregate demand. A merchant sees its own catalogue, leads and performance. A brand may receive aggregated category intelligence. A fulfilment partner sees only the delivery data required for accepted jobs.

Shared infrastructure does not imply universal visibility.

92.2 Data classes

Data class	Example	Default control
Public reference	Published branch address, product specification or market location	Searchable subject to source rights and correction
Merchant-controlled	Private stock quantity, margin, customer notes or unpublished price	Merchant-authorised access only
Transactional	Quote, payment state, delivery proof or complaint	Purpose-limited parties and retention
Platform operational	Logs, fraud signals, reliability and support history	Restricted operational access
Aggregated intelligence	Area demand, price bands or category gaps	Privacy-safe thresholds and contractual use
Partner-contributed	POS feed, courier status or verification result	Contract, provenance, purpose and onward-use rules
Sensitive or regulated	Identity documents, financial evidence or protected personal data	Strong controls, minimal collection and jurisdiction-specific compliance

92.3 Contribution-back rule

A powered application should contribute authorised improvements back to the common graph when those improvements concern shared entities.

Examples:

- a verified branch opening updates the organisation-place relationship;
- a merchant-approved product match improves the offer-master link;
- a successful delivery updates fulfilment performance;
- a corrected product attribute improves the shared master after review;
- a resolved identity conflict improves organisation resolution.

The application may retain its proprietary workflow, models and customer-specific private data. The framework should not appropriate data beyond contract, consent and lawful purpose.

92.4 Intelligence flywheel safeguards

The value of the graph must not become an excuse for uncontrolled data collection.

Every new data field or derived model requires:

- a defined commerce purpose;
- source and rights classification;
- retention rule;
- access policy;
- confidence and freshness treatment;
- correction and challenge path;
- privacy review where personal data is involved;
- model monitoring where automated decisions are involved.

93. Security, reliability and platform governance

93.1 Platform constitution

All first-party products, subsidiaries and plugins must follow a common platform constitution.

1. Canonical entities are reused, not duplicated.
2. Evidence and provenance accompany important factual claims.
3. Sponsored distribution is labelled.
4. Sensitive actions are authorised and audited.
5. Tenant and merchant data are isolated by default.
6. External applications receive the minimum required scopes.
7. Payment and fulfilment execution follow the approved boundary.
8. AI cannot invent identity, stock, price, verification or outcomes.
9. Breaking API changes follow a published version and migration policy.
10. Every extension has an owner, support path, kill switch and removal plan.
11. Critical services have service levels, backups and recovery procedures.
12. Data export and merchant continuity are designed before termination occurs.
13. Political, commercial or partner pressure cannot secretly manipulate trust or organic ranking.
14. Platform access may be suspended for fraud, abuse, security or rights violations under published rules.
15. Group subsidiaries receive no undisclosed ranking advantage over equivalent external participants.

93.2 Technical isolation

The preferred architecture remains a modular monolith for the initial build, with strict domain boundaries and an event outbox. Plugin support does not require premature microservices.

Implementation controls:

- all external access through an API gateway or equivalent policy layer;
- organisation and environment-scoped credentials;
- OAuth scopes and short-lived tokens where appropriate;
- signed webhooks and replay protection;
- idempotency keys for writes;
- rate limits and quotas;
- input validation and schema contracts;

- encryption in transit and at rest;
- secret management outside source code;
- audit logs for privileged actions;
- dependency and vulnerability scanning;
- feature flags and rapid revocation;
- background-job isolation and retry controls;
- observability by application, tenant and integration;
- backup and restoration testing.

93.3 Partner risk tiers

Risk tier	Examples	Required controls
Low	Public catalogue widget or read-only branch lookup	Basic identity, rate limit and terms
Moderate	Merchant-authorised catalogue write, CRM or analytics connector	OAuth scopes, audit, data review and support path
High	Payment, identity, fulfilment, complaint or sensitive data integration	Contract, security assessment, service levels, incident duties and manual approval
Critical	National-scale payment switch, official registry, core logistics or public infrastructure	Executive governance, resilience testing, fallback, audit rights and continuity plan

93.4 Neutrality and ecosystem trust

Shoppage-owned subsidiaries will sometimes compete with external ecosystem companies. That conflict must be governed openly.

Required safeguards:

- published organic-ranking factors at an appropriate level;
- clear sponsored labels;
- separation between confidential partner data and competing product teams;
- access logs and role restrictions;
- no use of private partner data to copy a business outside agreed purposes;
- objective certification criteria;
- appeal and complaint process;
- board-level review for material self-preferencing risks;
- contractual protection of merchant and developer data.

94. Product and organisational operating model

94.1 Core teams

The framework requires dedicated ownership even during the first six months.

Team	Initial accountability
Platform kernel	Identity, organisations, places, products, offers, permissions, evidence and audit

Team	Initial accountability
Developer platform	APIs, webhooks, SDK, sandbox, documentation, application registry and support
Data and intelligence	Resolution, provenance, graph quality, analytics, models and data rights
Trust, risk and governance	Verification, complaints, plugin review, privacy, security and policy
Merchant platform	Central, Merchant Sites, onboarding, catalogue, leads and business tools
Consumer discovery	Showcase, search, geo, video, saved needs and buyer requests
Commercial platform	Ads, creators, billing, attribution, revenue share and partner sales
Transaction orchestration	Payment and fulfilment adapters, status, evidence and reconciliation
Ecosystem and ventures	Partners, white-label deployments, vertical incubation and subsidiary gates

A small team may combine roles, but accountabilities must remain explicit.

94.2 Product-council governance

A monthly Platform Council should decide:

- whether a requested feature belongs in the core, a plugin or a vertical;
- whether a new entity or data field is canonical or application-specific;
- whether an integration creates unacceptable security or rights risk;
- whether a vertical should remain a module, become a business line or separate;
- whether a partner receives certification or expanded scopes;
- whether platform investment is producing reuse and moat growth;
- whether competing internal and external products are treated fairly.

The council should include product, engineering, data, commercial, security, legal/privacy and operations representatives.

94.3 Build-versus-partner rule

Shoppage should build a capability internally when it is:

- central to the commerce graph or trust model;
- a strategic differentiator;
- required across several products;
- too risky to delegate without control;
- poorly served by local partners;
- likely to generate important proprietary learning.

Shoppage should integrate or partner when the capability is:

- regulated and already supplied by licensed providers;
- asset-heavy;
- commodity infrastructure;
- faster and safer to procure;
- outside the company's distinctive information advantage;

- better operated by specialists under measurable contracts.

94.4 Framework success metrics

Metric	Meaning
Core reuse ratio	Percentage of a new product's infrastructure supplied by shared platform services
Time to first transaction or qualified outcome	Speed from approved concept to real user value
API adoption	Active applications, merchants connected and useful calls
Contribution-back rate	Valid shared-graph improvements produced by extensions
Integration reliability	Success, latency, webhook delivery and error recovery
Ecosystem revenue	Platform licences, API, plugins, partner ads and integration revenue
Partner retention	Continued productive use by certified developers and institutions
Extension quality	Support cases, complaints, security events and merchant satisfaction
Platform concentration risk	Dependence on any provider, plugin, customer or subsidiary
Innovation throughput	Tested, launched, retained and retired experiments per quarter

95. Implementation roadmap: 0-6 months

95.1 Months 0-3: fully functional internal framework

The first three months should produce a functioning platform framework for all first-party Shoppage layers and at least one controlled partner or subsidiary-style application.

Weeks 1-2: platform contracts and boundaries

- Approve the platform constitution.
- Confirm canonical entity ownership by domain.
- Publish initial API and event naming rules.
- Define application, tenant, merchant, user and scope models.
- Establish platform decision records.
- Define plugin risk tiers and review workflow.
- Confirm corporate and IP registers even if one legal entity is retained.

Weeks 3-4: application registry and access foundation

- Build internal application registration.
- Add service credentials and environment separation.
- Add merchant-authorised scopes.
- Add API gateway policies, quotas and audit.
- Implement signed webhooks and idempotency standards.
- Create sandbox fixtures from non-production data.

Weeks 5-6: reusable service interfaces

- Expose organisation, branch, place, product, offer and search APIs to first-party applications.
- Expose media upload and moderation interfaces.
- Expose lead, request and outcome events.
- Implement common errors, pagination, filtering and version headers.
- Add the outbox pattern for reliable domain events.

Weeks 7-8: first adapter framework

- Build payment-provider adapter contract.
- Build fulfilment-provider adapter contract.
- Build merchant feed and POS connector contract.
- Build notification-provider adapter contract.
- Create test providers for local development and acceptance testing.

Weeks 9-10: first composed products

- Make Shoppage Merchant Sites consume the same public-domain services as Central and Showcase where practical.
- Implement Pemosites prototype as a first-party extension rather than a data fork.
- Implement one market-operator or distributor pilot using scoped APIs.
- Confirm that changes flow back through the canonical graph and audit system.

Weeks 11-12: operational readiness

- Run security and privacy review.
- Test credential revocation, webhook replay, failed provider and data-export scenarios.
- Publish internal developer documentation and changelog.
- Establish plugin support and incident ownership.
- Measure core reuse, launch speed, error rate and data contribution.
- Approve the 4-6 month external beta cohort.

95.2 Month-3 functional acceptance criteria

The framework is considered functional when:

- all five public Shoppage layers authenticate through the common identity model;
- merchant, branch, product, offer and place records are reused rather than copied;
- at least three domain APIs are consumed by more than one application;
- signed webhooks and idempotent writes pass failure and replay tests;
- one payment and one fulfilment adapter contract work with test or approved partner endpoints;
- Pemosites or another extension renders a merchant experience from common data;
- a controlled external or separate-team application can operate with scoped credentials;
- all integration actions are attributable and auditable;
- access can be revoked without corrupting core data;
- data export and partner termination have tested procedures;
- the platform can show the cost and time saved through reuse.

95.3 Months 4-6: ecosystem expansion

- Launch a private developer portal beta.
- Onboard three to five certified integration partners.
- Publish TypeScript SDK and embeddable widgets.
- Pilot Pemosites with 10-20 merchants using the common graph.
- Pilot one market, procurement or distributor powered application.
- Launch plugin discovery and merchant consent screens.

- Add usage metering and partner billing.
- Add partner reliability, support and certification dashboards.
- Introduce privacy-safe aggregate intelligence APIs for approved use cases.
- Evaluate one vertical as a formal business line using the subsidiary admission tests.
- Establish standard platform-licence, data-processing, revenue-share and service-level templates.

95.4 What must not be attempted in months 0-6

- An unrestricted public app store with unreviewed code.
- Arbitrary third-party code running inside core production processes.
- Direct external database access.
- Dozens of speculative subsidiaries.
- A Shoppage-owned payment wallet or nationwide fleet.
- White-label forks with independent databases.
- Selling raw personal or merchant-confidential data.
- Premature microservice extraction solely to appear like a platform.
- Permanent custom integrations without shared contracts and support ownership.
- Claims of an open national platform before reliability, rights and governance are proven.

96. Strategic portfolio of framework-enabled opportunities

The following opportunities should be maintained as a prioritised portfolio rather than treated as simultaneous commitments.

96.1 Merchant infrastructure opportunities

1. Pemosites premium merchant websites.
2. POS and stock synchronisation.
3. Digital catalogues and QR ordering.
4. Branch and franchise management.
5. Merchant CRM and follow-up automation.
6. Quotation and invoice workflows.
7. Booking and service scheduling.
8. Product photography and AI content services.
9. Merchant data-cleaning and migration services.
10. Business Improvement Copilot subscriptions.

96.2 Commerce-network opportunities

11. B2B procurement and tender discovery.
12. Distributor and wholesale ordering portals.
13. Construction-material and installer network.
14. Agricultural input and produce coordination.
15. Local service-provider marketplace.
16. Verified logistics and collection exchange.
17. Diaspora procurement and gifting service.
18. Export-ready supplier discovery.

- 19. Made-in-Zimbabwe catalogue and campaigns.
- 20. Product repair, parts and compatibility network.

96.3 Physical-market opportunities

- 21. Mall and market digital twins.
- 22. Stall and tenant-management tools.
- 23. Market-wide advertising and sponsorship.
- 24. Event and promotion management.
- 25. Visitor, search and demand analytics.
- 26. Collection-point coordination.
- 27. Market loyalty and offers.
- 28. Local tourism and shopping trails.
- 29. Municipal or association commerce dashboards.
- 30. Vacancy and merchant-mix intelligence.

96.4 Media and advertising opportunities

- 31. Partner-publisher ad inventory.
- 32. Creator affiliate storefronts.
- 33. Live shopping and product demonstrations.
- 34. Local deal and price-alert channels.
- 35. Sponsored buyer-request matching.
- 36. Brand and distributor campaign tools.
- 37. Area and market sponsorships.
- 38. Product-launch media packages.
- 39. Commerce content production network.
- 40. Privacy-safe retail-media measurement.

96.5 Intelligence opportunities

- 41. Price and availability intelligence.
- 42. Demand-gap and stock-out reporting.
- 43. Merchant benchmarking.
- 44. Site-selection and branch-location analysis.
- 45. Product substitution and compatibility intelligence.
- 46. Brand distribution and reseller visibility.
- 47. Informal-market and cluster mapping.
- 48. Consumer-needs trend reports.
- 49. Supply-chain and fulfilment performance.
- 50. Public-value and SME digitisation measurement.

96.6 Platform and developer opportunities

- 51. Commerce APIs for local startups.

- 52. Embeddable product and search widgets.
- 53. Payment and fulfilment adapter marketplace.
- 54. Merchant-site themes and content plugins.
- 55. Certified POS and ERP connectors.
- 56. White-label market or sector platforms.
- 57. Authentication and merchant identity services.
- 58. Trust and verification APIs.
- 59. Product-resolution and catalogue-enrichment services.
- 60. AI commerce tooling for approved partners.

97. Investor interpretation and strategic value

The framework changes the investment case in five ways.

97.1 Lower marginal launch cost

Each new product can reuse identity, graph, search, trust, billing, AI, payments, fulfilment and analytics. Capital is directed to the differentiated customer problem rather than duplicated infrastructure.

97.2 Multiple revenue paths from one asset base

The same verified merchant, place, product and demand graph supports subscriptions, advertising, integrations, intelligence, websites, procurement, partner applications and selected transactions.

97.3 Option value without uncontrolled diversification

The venture-studio and subsidiary gates create strategic options while preserving focus. Weak ideas can be retired as modules. Strong businesses can receive dedicated leadership and capital after evidence.

97.4 Stronger data and distribution moat

Every productive extension can improve the graph, generate outcomes and increase the utility of Shoppage for all participants. This is harder to replicate than standalone marketplace traffic.

97.5 Clear asset ownership

A PlatformCo-style model protects core IP, schemas, contracts, evidence graph and APIs even if operating businesses change, partner or raise separate capital.

97.6 Investor risks to manage

- Platform ambition may outrun actual merchant and buyer adoption.
- Ecosystem governance may become bureaucratic.
- Subsidiaries may distract management or conceal weak economics.
- Partner integrations may create security and support liabilities.
- Internal products may unfairly compete with ecosystem partners.
- Revenue concentration may develop around one major institution or provider.
- Shared infrastructure costs may be misallocated.

Board reporting should therefore include core reuse, platform reliability, ecosystem revenue, subsidiary P&Ls, partner concentration, data-rights incidents and capital deployed by venture.

98. Final framework decision

The final position is:

Shoppage - Zimbabwe National Commerce Media Infrastructure

Shoppage is both a national commerce product family and a reusable commerce framework. Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators and Markets are the flagship applications. The Shoppage Framework is the shared operating system beneath them. Approved subsidiaries, partners and independent companies may build specialised businesses on that framework through governed APIs, plugins, licences and shared services.

The framework must remain practical:

- build the internal platform first;
- prove reuse across the existing five layers;
- use Pemosites as an early extension test;
- expose only stable, rights-cleared interfaces;
- add partners through a controlled beta;
- create subsidiaries only after product-market and organisational evidence;
- keep the core commerce graph, identity, trust, evidence and audit systems unified;
- allow innovation at the edge without fragmentation at the centre.

This structure turns Shoppage from a single application into foundational commercial infrastructure. It also creates a disciplined path for other Zimbabwean companies to innovate on local commerce data and distribution without rebuilding the national commerce layer or surrendering their own specialised business identity.

END OF COMPLETE SHOPPAGE NATIONAL COMMERCE MODEL